1987 宇宙组曲
1987 Cosmic Overture

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避雨指南
How to Find Shelter CO-01

???: 呼……再来一次深呼吸，然后……放轻松……
???: *breathing* Take a deep breath, and relax.

???: 第一场演出最不能失败。这关系着我的、科兹洛夫的、大家的荣誉……
???: This is my debut. I can't fail, not now. I have to do this for Mr. and Mrs. Kozlov and everyone in the circus. I must make them proud.

???: 娜塔莉亚女士教过，重点是让吸进的气流在身体里找到平衡。
???: Mrs. Kozlov told me that I must guide the air through my body until it finds its balance.

???: 左脚，右脚——好。接下来，适当地伸手和观众打招呼。
???: Left, right. Good. Now, wave to the audience and say hello.

???: 啊，糟糕。
???: Oh, no!

???: 不，别着急，我能做到……
???: I can do this. I'm almost there.

先站稳。在一根纤细的钢丝上找到立足之地。
Steady yourself. Find your footing on a strand-thin wire.

它真的存在吗?
Is it even there?

???: 我能应对一切……只要先……
???: I can have this handled. First, I need to ...

???: 我——
???: I ...

???: 宇宙中没有绝对的方向之分，下落同时也能是上升。这取决于你使用的参照体系。
???: There's no absolute direction up there. Up or down depends on the reference you choose.

???: 她有权知道“暴雨”意味着什么。
???: I think she has the right to know what the "Storm" really is.

???: 我们要先抵达九九年之后的世界。
???: We will still need to cross the year 1999.

???: 阿涅娅。回家。
???: Alia. Come home.

???: 库珀花环。
???: Kiperina.

???: 生命体征，平稳。各项指标均有回升。
???: Vitals are stable. Biometrics returning to normal.

发射基地·病房
Medical Ward, Cosmodrome

病床前的拉普拉斯研究员尚未褪去奔波的疲惫。医疗职员揣摩着她的心情，斟酌词句说明目前的状况。
The Laplace researcher still hasn't shaken off the weariness of her journey. The medic examines her closely, weighing her emotions as she explains the current situation.

医疗职员: 我听说您之前不在发射基地，没想到还是第一时间赶回了这里……
Medical Staff Member: I'd heard you'd already left. Never thought you'd be back so quickly.

医疗职员： 既然您这样关心他们，我想您应该能明白我接下来这些话的意思，指针女士。
Medical Staff Member: It's obvious you care about them. So, I'm sure you know what to do when they wake up, Ms. Pointer.

指针点了点头，目光依然落在床边那些医疗仪器闪烁的屏幕上。
Pointer gives a nod, her eyes fixed, scanning the blinking screens beside the bed.

医疗职员： 实验事故造成的外伤并不严重，库珀花环小姐只是需要休息。
Medical Staff Member: She hasn't suffered any serious trauma. All that Ms. Kiperina here needs is rest.

医疗职员： 考虑到她的身体状况，我不建议她立刻离开病房。
Medical Staff Member: But considering her condition, I recommend she stays here a few days longer for observation.

指针没有回应这句话。在几秒钟的停顿后，她开口询问。
Pointer doesn't respond. After a long silence, she speaks.

指针： 辛苦了。其他人的情况怎么样?
Pointer: Thank you. What's the status of the others?

医疗职员： 冷周六小姐要好些，之前还醒来了十五分钟。
Medical Staff Member: Ms. Hissabeth is fine. She was awake earlier, for a few minutes anyway.

医疗职员： 利用这点儿时间，她迅速要求签署了遗体捐献协议书。甚至没忘记让她的兄弟姐妹们也签字。
Medical Staff Member: She signed a donor card. Managed to get all her other siblings to sign it too. Not sure what we'd even do with them.

医疗职员： ……另外两位先生和她做了差不多的事。
Medical Staff Member: That gentleman and that little salamander guy did the same thing when they woke up.

医疗职员： 这倒都没什么，疯子我见得够多了。麻烦的是决定治疗方案。太多细节都要注意，特殊剂量、抗药性……而且我没有任何动物医疗经验，只能申请协助。
Medical Staff Member: Anyway, it's no cause for concern. I've seen my share of lunatics just like them. The real problem is determining treatment. There are so many details to pay attention to when dealing with these special patients: the dosage, their drug resistance ... And I'm not a vet, you know. I had to seek out some professional consultation.

医疗职员： 虽然这么说不太合适，但还好您没有参与这次……勇敢的尝试。不然我连一个帮手也找不着了。
Medical Staff Member: No offense, but I'm glad you weren't part of this ... attempt; otherwise, I might have had to face all of this by myself.

指针的目光从病床上收回。她直视着职员的眼睛。
Pointer faces away from the bed and looks the staff member straight in the eye.

指针： 我不赞成他们，但他们毕竟也算是我的组员。
Pointer: I may not have approved of their taking on this project, but I'm still on the team.

指针： 如果哪天有了规制法案，教会这群家伙重视生命，我一定双手双脚赞成。
Pointer: *sigh* If only the Foundation could devise regulations sufficient to control our staff's recklessness with their own lives.

医疗职员： 举个例子，首先限制苦目糖的使用?
Medical Staff Member: Hmm. Maybe they should consider controlling access to Picrasma Candy?

指针： 噢，这就算了吧。我自己偶尔也会多来两颗。
Pointer: Ugh, forget that. Even I can't help exceeding the recommended dosage sometimes.

医疗职员：下个月我就要调任去康复中心总部了，我会帮你问问那儿的苦目糖平均用量。
Medical Staff Member: I'll be reporting to the headquarters of the Rehab Center next month. I'll let you know their average dosage by then.

医疗职员：但现在，比起这个，我看得先给来探病的人排张时间表……
Medical Staff Member: Anyway, I need to write up a visitors' schedule. We have to make sure our patients get enough rest.

第二位来访者很好地说明了时间表之必要。
The second visitor proves just how necessary a proper schedule can be.

???: 她的情况还好吗？我刚从另一边的病房过来。
???: How's she doing? I just left the other ward and thought I might drop by.

突然响起的声音礼貌而亲切，但依旧让两位职员吃了一惊。
The new voice is polite and warm but still startles them.

指针：您好，北方哨歌女士。
Pointer: Hello, Ms. Windsong.

医疗职员：根据今天的检查结果来看，库珀花环小姐的身体情况已经基本稳定。
Medical Staff Member: Her vitals have stabilized. We're monitoring her recovery, but the initial results are positive.

医疗职员：我们无法确保她何时苏醒。但好消息是，预期时间为这周内。
Medical Staff Member: We can't say precisely when she'll wake up, but it shouldn't take more than a week.

北方哨歌：辛苦了。我会常来探望——严格按照规定行动，尽量少添麻烦，我记着呢。
Windsong: Good to hear. I'll be by to visit them from time to time, following the schedule, of course. Let me know if it's too much trouble.

医疗职员：这间病房还好，隔离室几乎静音。在常规病房内的确需要保持安静。
Medical Staff Member: You're welcome to drop by here anytime. The isolation room is soundproof, but do keep it down when you visit the other wards.

北方哨歌：我理解，我理解。我只是有些担心，而且维拉女士和阿夫西维总是在信里问起大家的近况。
Windsong: Of course. I'm just worried about them, you know. Besides, Vila and Avgust have drowned me in letters asking about the project.

北方哨歌：老师和学生多少都会挂念对方，这也没办法。
Windsong: More importantly, there's a bond between a teacher and her student.

医疗职员：明白。我正好也该去忙其他事了。如果碰上什么问题，就用那边的呼叫按钮找我。
Medical Staff Member: I understand. I'll check in on the others. If you need any help, press that button to call me.

医疗职员：顺带一提，指针女士——祝您的组员一切顺利！
Medical Staff Member: By the way, Ms. Pointer, Godspeed to you and your team!

医疗职员：一群打算上太空的疯子，我觉得还挺酷的。
Medical Staff Member: A bunch of lunatics working together to reach space. Pretty damn cool, I'd say.

这是句意料外的称赞，指针的脸上明明白白地写满了惊讶。
It's an unexpected and unorthodox compliment. The surprise is written all over Pointer's face.

北方哨歌：我也希望一切顺利。
Windsong: Ditto.

指针：……您真的认为我们能成功？
Pointer: Are you being serious? Do you think it's possible we could succeed?

北方哨歌：您瞧，“我们”。您不是已经打算退出这个小组了吗?
Windsong: Listen to yourself, "we." Weren't you quitting the team?

短暂的沉默之后，她们默契地略过了对方的反问。
After a short silence, they decide not to answer either question.

北方哨歌率先迈开步子，指针跟着她来到走廊，回手带上了房门。
Windsong takes the first step, and Pointer follows her into the hallway, pulling the door shut behind them.

北方哨歌：看来您并没有像声称的那样，坚持认为冷周六的想法不切实际。
Windsong: Your comment on Hissabeth's project, you said it was "unrealistic." I don't think you really meant that.

北方哨歌：干脆回来搭把手？我觉得利用传送软盘是个很不错的主意，而且实验失败本就是常事。
Windsong: But, even if you do, why not stay and give them a hand? Their latest ideas for the teleportation disk sound solid to me. This one failure shouldn't be enough to walk away.

北方哨歌：你和冷周六合作过这么久，理应比我更清楚她是不是在做无用功。
Windsong: You've worked with Hissabeth long enough. I'm sure you'd already know if she's pursuing a fool's errand.

指针又一次选择了沉默。但北方哨歌并没有再次与她达成默契。
Pointer chooses silence again. But this time, Windsong presses her concern.

北方哨歌：你到底怎么想?
Windsong: So, what do you really think?

指针：我怎么想不重要。我劝过他们很多次，停下吧，到这里就可以了。
但他们听得越多就越打算坚持。
Pointer: My thoughts are unimportant. All attempts to talk them out of it have failed, and what's worse, the more forcefully I attempt to dissuade them, the more determined they become.

北方哨歌：我只想知道你是否认为冷周六他们必定失败。
Windsong: Alright, so lay it on me: why are they doomed to fail?

指针：难道我必须站在这里一五一十地向你剖析我的想法?
Pointer: I see no reason to expend any energy explaining it.

北方哨歌指向她的身后，那间她们刚刚离开的医务室。
Windsong gestures at the ward behind her.

北方哨歌：我有自己的判断。
Windsong: Whatever. I'll just have to make my own judgments on the matter.

指针：……
Pointer: ...

指针：冷周六是一位很好的研究员，足够敏锐，也向来果断。我从来没有不信任她。
Pointer: Hissabeth is an excellent researcher, sharp and decisive. On those merits alone, she's earned my trust.

指针：但谁来保证计划百分百成功，谁来面对失败的后果？不是进医务室躺几个月、几年，而是——
Pointer: My analysis points to a dangerous level of uncertainty in this project. The price of failure, even optimistically, could be much worse than a few days in recovery. There could be more permanent injuries. They could even ...

她的肩膀在发颤，但她的声音异常的平静和稳定。
Her shoulders shrink in, but her voice remains calm.

指针：这是我的个人想法，我希望自己的同事们能……活下去。
Pointer: My nature compels me to do whatever I can to reduce the danger to our staff, and I want to keep my friends alive.

指针：就算真到了太空，拿到了数据，明白了宇宙是否会被“暴雨”冲刷……
Pointer: What does it matter if we make it into space and discover whether the "Storm" affects the whole universe?

指针：即使宇宙不受影响，我们又能怎么办？逃去一颗新的星球？
Pointer: Say that we determine this phenomenon only affects Earth, then what? We can't leave. We don't have the technology to fly off somewhere else.

指针：如果“暴雨”连我们头顶的群星都会带走，那知道这样的结果又有什么意义？
Pointer: And if instead we determine the "Storm" is indeed universal, and that it will inevitably swallow up the stars, well, then wouldn't it all be pointless?

指针：这个答案并不值得如此追求。
Pointer: Either way, my calculations are clear: the answer is not worth our lives.

北方哨歌：如果你真的这样想，应该把刚刚的话说给他们听。
Windsong: That's how you feel, I get it, so why not tell them?

指针：我在等一个合适的机会。
Pointer: I've been attempting to find the right time to say it.

理线学者耸了耸肩，她已经得知了自己需要的答案。
The ley lines scholar shrugs. She has the answer she came for.

北方哨歌：总之，我这里有个新消息。虽然你很快也会知道。
Windsong: Maybe so. Speaking of things to say, I've got some news, and I thought it was better you hear it from me.

北方哨歌：发射基地将逐步开始清空撤离，最迟半个月后，至少拉普拉斯的所有职员都必须离开。
Windsong: Laplace has decided to evacuate the spaceport. All staff on-site are to be relocated before the end of the month.

指针：撤离？有不少难以搬运的设备，要去哪里？而且你应该清楚这里的很多项目和国家合作开发……
Pointer: Evacuate? Where to? There is critical equipment here that can't be moved in that time frame. Besides, this spaceport was a part of our active partnership with the local government.

她猛然抬起头，北方哨歌没有回避她的视线。
She lifts her head, and Windsong doesn't shy away from her gaze.

指针：……回真正的、不受影响的普列谢茨克分部，北极圈边缘，对不对？
Pointer: Ah, we're moving to our real branch in Plesetsk, aren't we? The one on the edge of the Arctic Circle that's proven immune to the "Storm."

指针：这是“暴雨”应急预案！
Pointer: This is our "Storm" Emergency Plan!

北方哨歌：是的。
Windsong: You've got it.

北方哨歌：拉普拉斯职员回去报到后，可以在休养中心度过一周。那些不属于科算中心管辖的员工，他们将从今天起迎来带薪假期。
Windsong: All Laplace employees are to spend a week in the care center after reporting to Plesetsk. The local staff will be put on paid vacation as is usual.

她们都清楚这场“带薪假期”将何时中止。
They both know exactly when this "paid vacation" will come to an end.

北方哨歌： 冷周六也在等合适的时机。现在她等到了。
Windsong: Hissabeth was also waiting for the right time, and I guess this is it.

北方哨歌： 帮她签名吧。放心，这份不是捐献协议。
Windsong: Sign this for her, will you? Don't worry. It's not a donor card.

一张纸被递到面前。
A sheet of paper is held out to her.

指针： 你要我向路德维希先生提交申请，叫他特批我的组员留下送死?
Pointer: You're asking me to sign this so that my teammates can stay here and die in the "Storm"?

北方哨歌： 不，我只是帮忙转交它。
Windsong: I'm not asking. I'm only delivering it to you.

北方哨歌： 他们相当清楚自己要面对的困难。这不是一次徒有勇气的赌博。
Windsong: But they know what they're doing here.

北方哨歌： 所以我愿意尽举手之劳。
Windsong: That's why I want to help.

指针： ……我现在没心情考虑。之后再说。
Pointer: I need some time. My analysis won't be objective right now.

北方哨歌： 别让你的组员等得太久，这很可能是最后的机会。
Windsong: Sure. Just don't keep your teammates waiting. Our time is short.

指针： ……
Pointer: ...

她把那张纸用力塞进了外套口袋，隔着玻璃看向病床上静静沉睡的女孩。
She places the paper neatly into her pocket, then returns to the glass to watch over the sleeping girl in the hospital bed.

在几个月前，她们还未曾料想到事情会发展到如此境地。
A few months ago, none of them could have imagined it would come to this.

旅行者们
The Voyagers CO-02

电台节目： “不久前，旅行者二号已顺利抵达天王星，完成了人类历史上首次对这颗星球进行的探测活动，并按计划对天王星环系统进行了考察……”
Radio: "Not long ago, Voyager 2 successfully reached Uranus, marking the first-ever exploration of this planet in human history. It conducted an examination of Uranus's ring system as planned ..."

电台节目： “由于探访土卫六造成的临时轨道变动，旅行者一号仍在飞往太阳系边缘……”
Radio: "After a temporary orbital adjustment caused by its earlier visit to Titan, Voyager 1 continues its journey towards the edge of the solar system ..."

电台节目： “它们今后的旅程……”
Radio: "Their future ..."

发射基地·温室办公室
Plesetsk Office, Cosmodrome

冷静的新闻播报声骤然中断。
The staticky but steady voice of the news cuts out.

冷周六： 它们接下来要去哪里，做了什么，都是已经确认的结果，不用听过时的消息啦。
Hissabeth: We already know where they're going and what they're gonna do. Why are you wasting time on old news?

冷周六： 我记得拉普拉斯的资料库里还收藏过 1990 年旅行者一号拍的照片。
Hissabeth: As I recall, we've even got a photo from Voyager 1 taken in 1990. It's stored somewhere in the Laplace archives.

指针： 也有三进制计算机和流星余迹通信技术的研发报告。
Pointer: That's correct. They even have the development reports from Setun and the work done on meteor burst communication tech.

指针： 但资料库里没有记载过那张金唱片的下落，对不对?
Pointer: But none of the archives mention the whereabouts of the Golden Records, do they?

指针： 说不定在哪次播报里就会提到，“根据旅行者一号骤然减少的质量，我们判断，其上搭载的唱片已经被不知名的存在截获……”
Pointer: So there is a chance we'll hear some new clue this time around, like "According to the sudden decrease in Voyager 1's mass, it's been speculated that the Golden Records were intercepted by an unknown entity ..."

冷周六： “截获”听起来像星际海盗。
Hissabeth: "Intercepted," you make it sound like it was stolen by aliens, or space pirates!

指针： 我想海盗应该对一张小小的金唱片不感兴趣。
Pointer: A space pirate? I doubt they would have any interest in some ordinary records.

指针： 说吧，按掉我的收音机是为了什么要紧事?
Pointer: Now why don't you get to the point? What's so urgent that you had to switch off the radio?

冷周六： 简单小事。他们说录像最好不要有太多杂音。
Hissabeth: Oh, I'm making a video. I didn't want the sound drowning out the recording.

冷周六： 现在差不多够安静了——
Hissabeth: Should be quiet enough now.

1986 4 月 普列谢茨克发射基地
April 1986, Plesetsk Cosmodrome

冷周六： 冷周六，拉普拉斯研究中心职员。
Hissabeth, Laplace Researcher.

加入计划的原因？爱好而已。
So, why was I mad enough to join this project? Call it a matter of personal interest.

Правда?
“真的吗?”
Правда?
"Really"?

为了避免你太惊讶，我会做个更详细点的介绍。
Let me introduce myself in a little more detail, in case you're shocked when you get your first look at me.

发射基地·走廊
Hallway, Cosmodrome

小蛇 I： **到地方没有？该死，我讨厌一切爬行以外的交通方式！**
Snake I: **Are we there yet? Drats! This is no way to travel! Let me just slither please.**

小蛇 V： **但你绝大多数时间都在“搭乘交通工具”。**
Snake V: **We don't have a choice. We're stuck with this most unfortunate mode of transportation.**

迪布瓦家族兄弟姐妹中的九分之二。以聒噪为美德。
Introducing two of the nine siblings of the Dubois family, always loudly at odds and proud of it.

或许是天气太冷，其他家伙将所有时间都用来睡觉。感谢他们的沉默，让我还能保留点耐心。
Thanks to the cold weather, the others're still brumating, so they haven't yet tested my patience.

由远及近的脚步声促使他们抬头张望。
Footsteps grow nearer, prompting them to look around for their source.

接待员： 您好，我来接您前往办公室。
Receptionist: Welcome. Let me walk you to your office.

接待员： 请先出示您的工牌……
Receptionist: Your ID card, please.

小蛇 I： **嘶嘶。**
Snake I: **Hiss.**

接待员： 啊，抱歉——！
Receptionist: Oh, my apologies!

冷周六： 我的耐心耗尽了。
My patience just ran out.

小蛇灵活地偏开身子，但它躲得不够快，只能被迫闭紧嘴巴。
The snake twists its body away with agility, but not fast enough. It is forced to clamp its mouth shut.

冷周六： 多谢您为我领路。
Hissabeth: Thank you for showing me the way.

冷周六： 再走快些怎么样？这地方的温度连开口说句话都够呛。
Hissabeth: Why don't we speed up a bit? This place feels as cold as a goddamn morgue. I can barely talk without shivering.

到了目的地，我会再次、再次、再次教他们不要随便吓唬同事。
When we get to the office, I'll warn them not to scare our colleagues for the fourth time.

接待员： 您放心，办公室内的暖气二十四小时开启。拉普拉斯不会忽略这种细节。
Receptionist: Of course. We'll ensure the heat is kept on 24/7 inside your office. Laplace never neglects the little details.

事实上，作为一位爬行动物爱好者，
她正忙着掩饰自己因惊喜造成的失礼。
In truth, as a reptile enthusiast, she's just trying to hide the rudeness of her surprise at seeing the cute snakes.

接待员： 就是这里。您直接敲门就好，指针女士应该正在里面等您。
Receptionist: Here we are. Go ahead and knock on the door. Ms. Pointer should be expecting you.

接待员： 对了，刚才您提到了气候问题，请问您可爱的宠物是否需要恒温箱?
Receptionist: By the way, since you mentioned the cold weather, do you need a thermostat for your lovely pets?

接待员： 我们会在合理范围内尽量满足每位研究员的需求。
Receptionist: We try our best to meet all of our researchers' needs.

冷周六：噢，没事。我的外套参考了一些类似原理，完全够用。
Hissabeth: Oh, we're all good. My coat works as a kind of thermo-regulated insulator. It should be fine.

接待员：好的。另外，发射基地的这处办公场地专为合作研究建设。如果您有事前往拉普拉斯专用办公楼，记得提前提交访问申请。
Receptionist: Understood. And please note that the spaceport here is just a part of our local research collaboration. Laplace's official branch in Plesetsk is actually further north, right on the edge of the Arctic Circle.

接待员：那儿在极圈附近，过去有些远，来往管控也很严格。为避免耽误日程，希望您记住这一流程。
Receptionist: It has a strict security policy. So, you'll need to file an application before visiting. There's no guarantee it will be approved either.

接待员：普列谢茨克发射基地研究所，欢迎您的加入。
Receptionist: Welcome to the Plesetsk Cosmodrome.

接待员刚走出几步，又被细微的声响吸引着回过头。
Just a few steps out, the receptionist turns back, drawn by a faint sound.

鳞片金黄的小蛇朝她吐着信子，似乎还瞧得见它眨了眨眼。
The little golden-scaled snake flicks its tongue at her, and—was that a wink?

接待员：再见，小家伙。
Receptionist: Goodbye, little hissie.

研究员的背影消失在走廊尽头，愉快的说话声再次响起。
The researcher disappears down the hall, and cheerful voices ring out again.

小蛇Ⅰ：**你知道吗，二号？我觉得这地方的人对我们更友好**。
Snake I: **You know what, Two, I think the staff here are more accommodating than most types we meet.**

冷周六：你的素质简直越来越差了。
Hissabeth: Or, are you just being more of a jerk than usual?

冷周六：不准用编号叫我。还有，别惹太多麻烦。
Hissabeth: Now stay out of trouble, and don't call me by my number again.

冷周六：再收到任何关于“实验动物被偷吃”的投诉，我就给你打结。
Hissabeth: Just so you know, I'm perfectly willing to tie you up by the tails if I start hearing about any "missing lab rats."

在家族辩论赛正式打响前，房门及时地敞开了。
The door swings open, preventing the escalation of their family feud.

冷周六：——？
Hissabeth: ...?

指针：我听到外面有动静，原来真有人。
Pointer: I knew I heard someone talking behind the door. Glad my ears don't need tuning.

指针：别杵在门口。你就是那个主动申请调来这里的研究员？
Pointer: Please, come in. Are you the new researcher on this project?

冷周六：看样子，你是我的新同事？
Hissabeth: You've got it. So, I take it you're one of my new colleagues?

发射基地·办公室
Office, Cosmodrome

新同事的态度谈不上欢迎。
The new colleague's attitude seems cold to the touch.

但踏进房间，看清楚所有陈设后，她意识到这点细节已经是最不重要的。
But once she steps inside and takes in the whole setup, she realizes that details like that won't matter too much.

冷周六： 两台设备，两把椅子……两张制式办公桌。
Hissabeth: Two devices, two chairs, and two standard-issue desks.

冷周六： 整个组就只有我们两个?
Hissabeth: Is it just the two of us?

指针： 当然不，记得保持严谨！组里有足足三个人。不过第三个人从来没在公示名单以外的地方出现。
Pointer: I expected you to be more rigorous as a fellow Laplace researcher! According to official records, we have a third researcher on the team, an attache from the local government. In theory anyway, no one has ever seen or heard of them. It's just a name on the noticeboard.

指针： 暂时别算上那位政府派来的协作者——我用这个词完全是出于尊重——这里确实只有两位员工。
Pointer: However, if you insist on ignoring our esteemed coworker—who I mention out of deep respect for our local partners—then correct, it's just the two of us.

指针： 怎么样，也算是个惊喜吧？至少项目经费怎么用只需要我俩做决定。
Pointer: So, what do you think of our setup? It's not so bad. At least, we're in full control of our budget.

指针： 当然也别指望能有多少。
Pointer: Although, I recommend setting those budget expectations low.

冷周六： 行，和我预想中也挺接近，特殊时期的边缘项目……
Hissabeth: Cool, cool. Everything's more or less as I expected—an undervalued project in extraordinary times.

冷周六： 到底是谁想到要用传送术式往航天器上送补给？我真佩服那家伙的想象力。
Hissabeth: What kind of bizarre mind hatched up the idea of teleporting supplies directly into space?

指针： 你觉得这是异想天开?
Pointer: Do you believe our goals are unrealistic?

冷周六： 当然不，充分利用一切知识才是科学研究的秘诀，我一向赞成神秘学与科技的结合。
Hissabeth: Not at all. Only eclectic, let's say. And I've always been a fan of eclectic theories. They are often a stepping stone to true discovery.

冷周六： 这一定会是科学发展的主流趋势，尽管现在还不是，但……
Hissabeth: I'm certain that the combination of arcanum and science will one day make up the core of our civilization. We're not there yet, but ...

指针： 但未来一定会的。或许改变的第一步就是从这个项目开始。
Pointer: It's only a matter of time. Perhaps this project will be the next leap forward.

指针： 要是能改进传送术式的缺陷，解决它单程、不稳定、距离过短的问题，这就不会再是边缘项目。
Pointer: So far, the teleport disk we've developed is functional but unstable. It's a one-way ticket capable of travel only within a short distance. But if we can improve its range and stability, I calculate its value to society to be potentially earth-shaking.

冷周六： 看来我们的合作会很顺利。
Hissabeth: Looks like we'll make for quite a team.

她拿起桌面上堆叠的材料，给自己腾出一小块便于倚靠的空间。
She picks up the stack of files from the desk, clearing a small spot to lean against.

冷周六：为了我们共同的目标，当务之急是先做出些值得填上报告书的东西。
Hissabeth: But before that, we'll have to make sure our project isn't shut down before it can begin, which means we need to cook up something worthwhile to put in our report.

指针：我知道你擅长的是空间材料科学。需要什么，这位专家？我来帮您想办法。
Pointer: To that end, I know you're an expert in aerospace materials. Are there any specific specimens you need? I'll do what I can to source them for you.

指针：考虑到审批流程、运输时间，还有其他一系列影响因素，我今天得提交新的领用单。
Pointer: Oh, but be quick. Our resource applications must be submitted today. The evaluation process and all other little details mean it will take some time to arrive.

冷周六：我想想，也没什么特别的……你怕不怕鱼？
Hissabeth: Let me see. Hmm, no, I don't have any particular needs for now. How do you feel about fish?

这次话题实在转折得太快，即使是惯于处理信息的大脑也无法立刻做出反应。
Even Pointer's keen analytical mind struggles to keep up with the rapid topic change.

指针停顿了足足三秒，还是决定回答这个荒谬的问题。
She pauses a full three seconds before answering.

指针：……不怕。我对你养在头上的小宠物也没有意见。
Pointer: They're fine, as are those pets you've got dangling in your hair.

冷周六：好，看来我的确来对了地方，没人会反对我关于鱼类养殖的这点儿爱好。
Hissabeth: Cool. Looks like I've come to exactly the right place. No nosy layabouts around to moan about my hobbies.

冷周六：至于我头上的生物——这是另一件事，虽然我是没把身份背景贴在脸上，但好歹在档案里……你没看。
Hissabeth: Speaking of those "pets," they're not really pets. I remember mentioning them in my profile. You didn't read it, hmm?

冷周六：“能多个帮手就不错，管他是谁呢！”然后把文件随手摞在废纸堆顶层。我猜对了？
Hissabeth: "Whatever, so long as they can hold their own!" Then you threw the file into the trash. Am I right?

指针：真聪明。我扫了两眼，记得你的研究方向和过往经验。其他东西不重要。
Pointer: It wasn't quite so dramatic, but yes. I briefly scanned it for your field of expertise and experience. Nothing else mattered to me.

冷周六：但也得解释清楚嘛。蛇发女妖和蛇打从出生起就在一块儿，比起宠物，更像同胞的兄弟姐妹。
Hissabeth: Still, you should get to know your new colleagues. I'm a Melusine. We have snakes for hair. So, they're not pets. They're my siblings.

冷周六：——所以你其实多了九位同事，算上我在内。够不够惊喜？
Hissabeth: Technically, you've got yourself a grand total of nine new coworkers. Surprise!

指针：很新奇的知识。可惜我们恐怕发不出九份补贴。
Pointer: That is certainly new information. It's unfortunate that Laplace doesn't pay out their Sharpodonties by head.

冷周六：五份？
Hissabeth: Maybe I can convince them to go in for every two heads?

指针： 正常发放，可以在常规份额上额外增加饮食津贴。
Pointer: I wouldn't predict your chances to be high, but a larger food allowance seems appropriate, given your additional mouths to feed.

冷周六： 加上单间办公室，我需要地方放我的生态缸。鱼类和绿植有助于放松心情。
Hissabeth: Mind requesting me a corner office? I need a lot of space for my fish tank. Pets and plants help me cool off.

指针： 那就推进进度，把报告书写完，申请新办公室——一人一间，怎么样?
Pointer: Whatever you want, let's just finish the report as soon as possible. Then we can apply for additional office space—one room for each of us. Deal?

冷周六： 成交。
Hissabeth: Deal.

协议达成。指针顺势抬起右手，打算来个友善的击掌。
Agreement reached. Pointer lifts her right hand.

小蛇抢先一步探出身子，用头顶轻轻碰了碰指针的掌心。
A snake stretches forward to gently tap her palm with its head.

指针： 合作愉快。
Pointer: Nice working with you.

公共无线电使用记录

Public Radio Usage Log 小径

公共无线电使用记录
Public Radio Usage Log

简中
公共无线电，每人每天五分钟，随便你做什么，留下记录。
……
12:05 把频率恢复正常，听天鹅湖。
18:05 听国外电台，调整了频率以防干扰。
03:05 39，仍未收到宇宙友人的回复。回答吧，回答吧。
12:05 把频率恢复正常，听天鹅湖。
18:05 听国外电台，调整了频率以防干扰。
……
03:05 42，观测到异常极光，一定是宇宙友人的回复。
12:05 把频率恢复正常，听天鹅湖。妄想归妄想，记得恢复设置。
18:05 听国外电台，调整了频率以防干扰。
……
03:05 73，燕鸥的迁徙路径和往年不同，她在影响磁场?
12:08 普列谢茨克不会买第二台无线电了，再弄坏就把你们埋进雪地。
18:05 听国外电台，调整了频率以防干扰。
……
03:05 106，磁场异常来到极圈边缘，我要去见她。
12:00 去米尔内拦截宇宙主义者，然后打断他的骨头，再回收无线电。
18:00 希望他的幻想无线电朋友是真的。
English
Public radio. Five minutes per person per day. Listen to whatever you want, but leave an update in the log.

...

12:05 Restored the frequency to normal and listened to Swan Lake.

18:05 Tuned to a foreign station. Adjusted the frequency to avoid interference.

03:05 Attempt 39, still no reply from the cosmic friend. Answer me ... answer me ...

12:05 Restored the frequency to normal and listened to Swan Lake.

18:05 Tuned to a foreign station. Adjusted the frequency to avoid interference.

...

03:05 Attempt 42, observed an unusual aurora. Must be the cosmic friend, she's responding.

12:05 Restored the frequency to normal and listened to Swan Lake. Wishful thinking aside, remember to reset the settings.

18:05 Tuned to a foreign station. Adjusted the frequency to avoid interference.

...

03:05 Attempt 73, The terns' migration route is different from last year. Is she affecting the magnetic field?

12:08 Plesetsk is not going buy a second radio. Break it again, and we'll bury you in the snow.

18:05 Tuned to a foreign station. Adjusted the frequency to avoid interference.

...

03:05 Attempt 106, the magnetic anomaly has reached the edge of the polar circle. I so want to meet her.

12:00 Off to intercept a cosmic idealist in Mirny, break his bones, and reclaim the radio.

18:00 I hope his imaginary cosmic friend is real. As if.

意义的意义
The Meaning of Meaning CO-03

1987 5 月 普列谢茨克发射基地
May 1987, Plesetsk Cosmodrome

我们的合作的确很愉快，一切都按照计划顺利进行。
Everything from there on went smoothly and according to schedule. It was a genuine pleasure working with Pointer.

至少那时候还是这么回事。
Well, those first days at least.

指针：冷周六，你有没有听昨天的理线学讲座?
Pointer: Hissabeth, did you go to that ley lines lecture yesterday?

指针：我连着检查了十几个小时的数据，根本没空……
Pointer: I couldn't make it. I've been reviewing this data for the last 10 hours.

指针：有可能是原本的术式转写后漏了些字符，也可能是航天系统编译器有问题。天知道到底是什么让模型一塌糊涂。
Pointer: The model is a mess. Something's off. I can't isolate the issue. It could be the system compiler, or the incantation. Or, maybe we missed some characters when we transcoded it.

冷周六：嗯？噢，我前几天在食堂碰到北方哨歌，她的确提过讲座的事，你等等。
Hissabeth: Hmm? Oh, the lecture? Yeah, Windsong mentioned it when we met her at the canteen a few days ago. Hold on.

椅子转了小半圈，窝在里面的研究员站起身伸了个懒腰，放下手里的面包。
The chair swivels halfway, and Hissabeth stands, stretching before setting her bread aside.

一条叼着数据卡的小蛇出现在指针的脚边。
A snake holding a data card slithers up to Pointer's feet.

冷周六：这是海伦娜，她难得睡醒，正好让她跟你打个招呼。
Hissabeth: This is Hélène. She woke up just a while ago. Hélène, meet Pointer.

冷周六：虽然没空自己去听讲座，但我想了个办法，拜托其他人把海伦娜放进口袋捎过去。刚抽空整理过笔记，给你。
Hissabeth: We couldn't all attend the lecture, but I asked someone to take Hélène there to observe. Here are the notes.

指针：每次到这时候我都想感叹意识共享的便捷性！
Pointer: I still haven't stopped being amazed by your siblings' telepathic connection.

指针：就没有什么效果相似的神秘术吗？真不敢想象它会让研究效率提升多少倍。
Pointer: I wonder if there is an arcane skill that might approximate the same effect. Imagine how much faster we'd be able to share information with it.

冷周六：你会先被各种啰嗦的声音吵得睡不着啦。
Hissabeth: It's got its advantages, if you're willing to accept eight different voices oscillating between a party and a brawl every day in your mind.

冷周六耸了耸肩膀，弯腰拾起完成任务的小蛇。
Hissabeth shrugs and scoops up the little snake.

它用比其他兄弟姐妹更快的速度消失在那头蓝发之间。
It shoots up her sleeve, vanishing into her blue hair to rejoin her siblings.

冷周六：别介意，她还是幼崽的时候就容易害羞。
Hissabeth: Hope you don't mind. She's been a bit shy ever since we were little.

指针：早习惯了。笔记过两天还你，我想看看理线学知识是否能应用于航天材料外壳的受力计算。
Pointer: That won't be a problem. I'll get it back to you in a few days. I just want to check if the study of ley lines can help with our aeroshell's force analysis.

冷周六：特地过来就为了这份笔记？留言给我也行的事，应该没那么着急吧。
Hissabeth: Is that all? You could've left a message. No need to go out of your way.

指针：啊哈，我正找人和我分享物资申领单被搁置几个月毫无动静的“惊喜”。
Pointer: Well, and I needed someone to unload a bit on. It's been months since I submitted our resupply application, and there doesn't appear to be any progress.

指针：我看他们不如把“无法直接应用于当下”的项目一锅端掉。
Pointer: This slow starvation for all of us is a waste of effort. They should just cut the cord and scrap all these projects they feel "show no value in the short term."

冷周六：往好处想，至少这两间办公室我们实打实地用上了。
Hissabeth: Look at the silver lining. We're sure to get our new offices.

指针：那是因为这地方的空房间实在够多。
Pointer: Office space, the one thing we have in abundance here.

她烦躁地挥了挥胳膊，找回了平时的语气。
She waves her arms in irritation before slipping back into her usual tone.

指针：先不管那些，你这边怎么样？我能抽空搭把手。
Pointer: *sigh* Anyway, how are things on your side? I'm free for the moment.

冷周六：进度照常，符合预期。你瞧。
Hissabeth: I'm progressing just fine. Take a look.

她走近那张办公桌，冷周六侧身让出道路，摊开桌上的设计稿。
She steps closer to the desk. Hissabeth shifts some space and lays out the blueprints.

指针：那就好，遇见麻烦就随时找我。
Pointer: Excellent. Feel free to let me know if you require any help.

指针：好像一直没有正式聊过——你为什么选了这个项目？
Pointer: You know, for all the time we've worked together, there are still many questions left unanswered between us. I'm curious: why did you choose this project?

和刚见面时不同，这不是某种检验或质疑，只是真正出于关心的询问。
The tenor of their conversation has changed since their first meeting. This isn't a test. It's genuine concern.

这段时间来的共事让她能够，也愿意发问。
Time has built enough trust between them to ask.

指针：我知道也有几个小组在解决清扫术式和植物类神秘术的生活应用问题。大方向而言，他们做的也是“神秘术与科技的兼容”。
Pointer: There are many other teams pursuing the "combination of arcanum and science." I think one of them is presently working on cleaning incantations and plant-related rituals.

指针：最后决定来偏远的普列谢茨克，只是因为你更熟悉空间材料学，更想为航天工程出力？
Pointer: Why choose Plesetsk? Is it that you feel your expertise in material science will be of most benefit here? Or do you have a particular interest in the aerospace industry?

指针：当然，你做得很好，不然我们也没法这么快就申请到单间。
Pointer: Don't mistake my intentions. I'm happy you chose to join our little team. You've performed exceptionally well so far.

冷周六：一定要找个理由的话……我也想知道旅行者号的金唱片会送到哪儿。
Hissabeth: If I had to put a finger on it, I'd say it was curiosity. I really want to know where those Golden Records will end up.

她将设计稿卷了起来，腾开桌面，找到更适合聊天的舒适站姿。
She rolls up the blueprint before settling into a relaxed posture.

冷周六：我提过父母的事，第一次“暴雨”发生前他们在拉普拉斯研究信息技术。
Hissabeth: Remember what I told you about my parents? They were studying information technology at Laplace before the first "Storm" struck.

冷周六的思维时常会过于跳跃，但现在指针已经能跟上这种节奏。她耐心地等待着下文。
Hissabeth's mind has always jumped around, but now Pointer can keep up. She knows to wait for the point to come back around.

冷周六: 我不擅长那个，或者说我早就厌倦了处理太多信息，脑子里有人开会可够烦的。
Hissabeth: I can't wrap my head around that stuff. My whole life has been a constant stream of information. You wouldn't believe how distracting it is to have eight voices in your brain, bothering you night and day.

冷周六: 但网络依旧很有趣。我们九个都喜欢家里的电脑，九双眼睛同时读一篇文章，关注的内容会完全不同。
Hissabeth: Still, all nine of us enjoyed reading. Whenever we found a particularly compelling article, we'd divide it up and each focus on a different part.

冷周六: 看见，记住，就此展开激烈讨论。我们当时热衷于玩这种游戏，简直爱死它了。
Hissabeth: We'd always have a huge brainstorm after we finished. It was a lot of fun actually. *sigh* I miss those times.

冷周六: 我记得那篇关于流星的报道。
Hissabeth: I still remember the day that meteor fell to Earth.

电台节目: “最新数据表明，旅行者一号已成为距离太阳最远的航天器……”
Radio: "Our latest reports are that Voyager 1 has officially traveled the furthest through our solar system of any man-made spacecraft ..."

电台节目: “它以大约 69.419 个天文单位的距离，将先驱者十号抛在了身后……”
Radio: "Surpassing Pioneer 10 by a distance of approximately 69.419 astronomical units ..."

冷周六: 是电视还是收音机里？总之那个声音正说着旅行者探测器的消息。
Hissabeth: I don't remember where I was or what I was doing, but I remember the broadcast was talking about the Voyager 1.

冷周六: 而我们注视屏幕里发光的小点，所有视线都集中在它身上。
Hissabeth: And that all nine of us were staring at the twinkling dot on the screen.

小冷周六: 就连月亮离我们都有快四十万千米远，这颗流星到底是从多远的地方来的?
Little Hissabeth: If the moon is almost 400,000 kilometers away from us, how much further away was this little rock from Earth when it started on its journey?

小冷周六: 这真是不可思议——
Little Hissabeth: Unbelievable ...

Невероятно?
“不可思议的?”
Невероятно?
"Unbelievable"?

冷周六: 在地球之外，在我们头顶闪烁的星星，它竟然也会来到地面的世界。
Hissabeth: We never knew the stars above our heads could actually fall into our world.

冷周六: 宇宙中在发生什么？我们没讨论出结果。
Hissabeth: What was happening up there? For all our brainstorms, we never reached the solid conclusion.

冷周六: 旅行者会到达哪儿，金唱片会送往哪里，群星会何时熄灭?
Hissabeth: Where will Voyager 1 go? Who, if anyone, will find its Golden Records? When will the stars stop shining?

冷周六: 某颗星球上有没有像你和我这样的研究员，在致力于弄清相似的问题?
Hissabeth: Are there researchers out there just like us living on another planet, looking for the same answers?

冷周六：那颗流星带给我们很多疑问，而我喜欢刨根问底，得到答案。
Hissabeth: One little meteor brought us so many questions, and we could never leave a stone unturned.

指针：所以你加入了这个缺少实际意义的项目。
Pointer: I see. That's why you joined this project, despite its lack of immediate contributions to society.

冷周六：航天工程当然有它的意义。
Hissabeth: Nonsense! Our work is critical to the future of aerospace engineering. We've got plenty of contributions to offer.

这回换她抬起手等待一次击掌。
This time, she's the one holding up a hand, waiting for a high five.

指针：……怎么开始安慰我了？我可没对这份工作泄气。
Pointer: Was that an attempt to cheer me up? There's no need. I'm not easily discouraged.

掌心贴着掌心，两只手短暂地重叠。
Palm to palm, their hands meet for just a moment.

指针：你的体温没之前那么低了。
Pointer: Hmm. You've warmed up a bit.

冷周六：这要得益于发射基地贴心的暖气供应，当然还有我对于能量摄入的重视。
Hissabeth: Yeah, thanks to the 24/7 heating, and because I keep all of us well fed.

冷周六：说起来我昨天在镇上找到几家不错的餐馆，要不要去尝尝?
Hissabeth: Speaking of, I'm headed to town to find a restaurant. Care to join me?

冷周六：多亏了新的福利政策，这里值得一吃的东西的确越来越多了。
Hissabeth: There's some decent food in Plesetsk now, thanks to the new policies. Do you want anything in particular?

指针：听你的。
Pointer: Your call.

当时我们都没有仔细想过，物资申领为何会这么艰难。
Back then, we never thought to ask why our supply application had been put on ice for so long.

1987 5 月 普列谢茨克发射基地
May 1987, Plesetsk Cosmodrome

冷周六：——中止项目?!
Hissabeth: They're terminating the project?!

过大的动静让小蛇们都探出头来，冷周六瞧上去像一朵炸开的向日葵。
The noise startles the snakes. One by one, they poke their heads out to join the shock.

可惜这幅画面转瞬即逝，指针甚至来不及启动留影设备。
Too bad the moment's already passed. Pointer doesn't even have time to snap a picture.

拉普拉斯研究员：完全能理解您的心情，女士。但您也应该清楚，“暴雨”过后，基金会和科算中心的首要任务是重建和恢复。
Laplace Researcher: I understand, ma'am, but you should know that our top priority after each "Storm" is to restore the Foundation and the LSCC to full function as soon as possible.

拉普拉斯研究员：在资源和人手都相当紧缺的情况下，中止一些相对不那么紧急的研究项目，这是难免的。
Laplace Researcher: With our current shortages of resources and manpower, that means cutting all non-essential projects.

冷周六： 哪一部分能算是“紧急”？是谁在决定它们的重要性?
Hissabeth: Non-essential? Then what is it that counts as "essential"? Who decided on our priority?!

在小蛇们再次发出愤怒的嘶嘶声之前，有人及时地拉住了冷周六。
Before the snakes can hiss again in protest, Pointer reaches out and grabs Hissabeth.

指针： 我们能做到现在还得感谢路德维希先生，他并没有立刻叫停普列谢茨克的大多数研究。
Pointer: Calm down, Hissabeth. I understand that Mr. Ludwig did his best to keep as many projects running in Plesetsk as he could. We couldn't have stayed here this long if it weren't for him.

指针： 但他也只是这个小小分部的管理者，能做的有限。
Pointer: But he's only a branch leader. He doesn't get to make the top-level decisions.

冷周六： ……所谓的“基础的”“有应用价值”的技术又不会凭空出现。
Hissabeth: They act as if all of their essential and valuable consumer technology just popped up out of nowhere!

冷周六： 航天工程没有用？随便说个简单的——他们吃泡面会没有蔬菜包！
Hissabeth: To think that aerospace engineering has less to contribute than their other projects?! S**t! They wouldn't even have vegetable packets in their instant noodles without us!

拉普拉斯研究员： 无论这个消息让您的心情多糟糕，女士，它就是既有事实。
Laplace Researcher: I'm sorry, but our decision is final.

拉普拉斯研究员： 您还是让我把通知说完吧，我还得去下一个研究室。
Laplace Researcher: Please allow me to finish. As you can imagine, I have several other meetings lined up after this.

指针： 好的，请您继续。
Pointer: Sure. Please continue.

拉普拉斯研究员： 露西女士并不完全赞同这个决定。她希望向普列谢茨克航天基地的研究员们确认一件事。
Laplace Researcher: Madam Lucy has expressed that she is not in favor of this decision. To that end, she asked me to deliver a "lifeline" for your work here.

拉普拉斯研究员： 对于“暴雨”，我们的了解还极其有限。如果能收集更多相关数据，能确认它的影响范围，就能更好地应对它。
Laplace Researcher: As you know, our knowledge about the "Storm" remains extremely limited. Madam Lucy believes we could better manage our circumstances if we could observe it in greater detail, particularly its extent.

拉普拉斯研究员： ——是否有人愿意尝试将监测器送往太空，回收“暴雨”落下时的宇宙数据?
Laplace Researcher: She's seeking volunteers from Plesetsk for a project, one that aims to send a monitor into space in order to collect data as the "Storm" arrives.

指针＆冷周六： ……!
Hissabeth & Pointer: ...!

两种截然不同的反应。
Two completely different reactions.

冷周六： 那些项目被中止的研究员，他们要去哪里?
Hissabeth: What about the other projects? Where will the researchers be assigned if their projects have all been terminated?

指针飞快地看了她一眼，试图给出提醒。但冷周六并没有注意到她在摇头。
Pointer shoots her another look, trying to signal her. But Hissabeth either doesn't notice or doesn't care.

拉普拉斯研究员：等待调任通知，去支援其他小组。不过和航天应该没太大关系了。
Laplace Researcher: Most will be reassigned to other teams. I'm afraid there isn't much manpower to spare on our work here.

拉普拉斯研究员：如果你不打算就这么离开，那只有接下任务。普列谢茨克剩下的研究资源都会留给你。
Laplace Researcher: That's the deal. If you want to stay on this project, then this mission must become your full focus. On the bright side, you'll have full access to all the resources left in Plesetsk.

他转头确认过走廊上没有别人，紧接着凑近一步，压低了声音。
He makes a quick glance down the hallway to check no one else is around, then steps closer and lowers his voice.

拉普拉斯研究员：我知道你们都打算整出点像样的东西，也一直是普列谢茨克最认真的那部分人……
Laplace Researcher: I believe you two to be the most talented researchers in Plesetsk, and I know you want to achieve something with your work here.

拉普拉斯研究员：但这真的不是好差事。你想想，假如有谁成功了，大伙儿的确会敬佩他——然后呢？没这份敬佩也能活着嘛。
Laplace Researcher: Still, I think I should caution you against accepting this task. Sure, if you pull this off, you'd become a legend throughout our organization, but there's only so much value in fame and admiration.

冷周六：如果失败呢？
Hissabeth: And what would happen if we were to fail?

拉普拉斯研究员：我觉得最普通的结果是死。更坏点的结果就很难预料了。毕竟现在谁都不清楚“暴雨”的原理。
Laplace Researcher: I'm afraid your best hope would be instant death, and it may be much worse than that. No one knows for certain what the "Storm" can do, after all.

拉普拉斯研究员：要押上性命不值得。
Laplace Researcher: I'm not sure this is worth your lives.

看见有正提着行李的研究员从走廊另一侧走来，他再度拉开了距离。
Noticing another researcher approaching from the far end of the hall with luggage in hand, he steps back, readopting his cool professional tone.

拉普拉斯研究员：那么我的通知就到这里。请确认相关事项，并在 24 小时内提交回复。
Laplace Researcher: Alright, that's all. I just need you to confirm that you've been informed. You'll have 24 hours to respond to our request.

收下通知材料，指针和冷周六回到只有二人的研究室。
After receiving the official documents, Pointer and Hissabeth return to their office.

在难捱的沉默中犹豫良久后，指针艰难开口。
They say nothing for a long time. The weight of the decision before them deserves their silent consideration. Finishing her deliberations, Pointer clears the air.

指针：冷周六，我知道你一向认同露西女士的观点。但这次毕竟情况特殊，这也并不是专门指定给谁的强制要求。
Pointer: Hissabeth, I know you're a big supporter of Madam Lucy, but I'm sure you agree this mission is a statistical death sentence.

指针：如果你觉得不好拒绝，我……
Pointer: If you're struggling for a way to say no, I'll ...

这些字眼并没能顺利抵达研究员的耳朵。几秒钟后，她才疑惑地抬起头来。
Her words don't seem to have any purchase on her fellow researcher. Hissabeth looks up at her with a puzzled expression.

冷周六：你说什么？——对了，跟你说个好消息。
Hissabeth: Sorry, what? Never mind. I've got good news.

冷周六：我刚才联络了北方哨歌，她能为我们解决一个大问题。
Hissabeth: I just talked to Windsong. She's got a solution to one of our major issues.

冷周六扬了扬手，回答的同时还不忘继续手头的工作。
Hissabeth waves a hand as she answers, continuing her work.

指针：你……你不打算拒绝？
Pointer: Wait. Don't tell me you want to volunteer?

冷周六：为什么？当然不！这可不是能轻易得到的机会。
Hissabeth: Why shouldn't we? This is a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity.

指针：但你知道那会遇到多少困难，面对多大的风险。就像刚才说的……
Pointer: But have you even considered the risk we'd be taking? Like the liaison said.

冷周六：我们有可用的设备，有正在进行中的研究，有共同确认过的目标。
Hissabeth: We'll have all the equipment we need, with a project that's progressing smoothly, working towards an achievable goal for the common good.

冷周六：宇宙真的如此遥不可及吗？如果传送术式能派上用场——
Hissabeth: It is almost like the universe is within our grasp. All we must do is make our teleport disk work.

指针：但我们没有合适的人选能安放监测器。你要上哪去找能在短期训练后适应失重、高压和高温环境的人？
Pointer: It's not that simple. We'd still need an astronaut capable of launching the monitor. Who could we find that would be capable of acclimatizing to a zero-gravity environment under high heat and pressure in such a short time?

冷周六：我正要将好消息的详情分享给你，关于北方哨歌发现的理线学好苗子，一位空中飞人小姑娘。
Hissabeth: That's the good news! Windsong already found us an ideal candidate—an acrobat.

冷周六终于完成了手头的工作——她将稿纸展示给指针，那是后续的工作计划表。
Hissabeth finishes her task and holds out the sheet to Pointer: a follow-up work schedule.

冷周六：我列出了之后要解决的问题——当然，前提是我们接下露西女士的任务。
Hissabeth: Here, I made a list of issues we'll need to tackle. Of course, that's only assuming you'll accept Madam Lucy's mission too.

冷周六：刚到普列谢茨克的时候，我们聊过关于航天探索的话题，你说也想知道宇宙里在发生什么。
Hissabeth: I remember we talked about space exploration when I first arrived in Plesetsk. You said you wanted to know what's going on up there, too.

冷周六：为了那个答案，你愿意面对多大的风险？
Hissabeth: So tell me, what price are you willing to pay for that answer?

???：深呼吸，找到那个平衡点。
???: Breathe. Let the air find its balance within.

???：科兹洛夫先生说过，不用害怕风险。想象自己漂浮在宇宙中——
???: Remember what Mr. Kozlov said: "You must never be afraid of falling." I just have to imagine myself floating in space.

???：——没错。我绝不会再从钢丝上跌落了。
???: That's right. I will not fall from the wire again.

主持人的介绍、热烈的欢呼与掌声从耀眼的光线处传来。
The circus barker's introduction booms above the blinding lights, followed by a wave of cheers and applause.

马戏团员： 接下来登场的是我们乌特恩亚亚马戏团最年轻的空中飞人、钢丝上的舞者——
Circus Barker: Ladies and gentlemen, introducing our fabulous wire dancer, the youngest acrobat of the Utrennyaya Circus—

马戏团员： ——库珀花环！
Circus Barker: Kiperina!

崭新的，美丽的
Beautiful New Things CO-04

1987 6 月 乌特恩亚亚马戏团
June 1987, Utrennyaya Circus

库珀花环，乌特恩亚亚马戏团的空中飞人。
Kiperina, Star Acrobat of the Utrennyaya Circus.

加入计划的原因……像平时一样，做我力所能及的事。
Why did I join this project? Well, I guess I'm trying to help in any way I can, like I always do.

马戏团就像一个小小的宇宙。
The circus is a lot like outer space.

我们在其中演出，塑造接近无重力的、充满想象的、不可捉摸的世界。
It is a performance that exists within an almost weightless world of imagination. Close to reality but, at the same time, unreachable.

我非常喜欢团长描述的生活，也从没想象过它会结束。
I've come to love the life that Mr. and Mrs. Kozlov provided for us there, and I never thought it might end.

马戏团·舞台
Circus Stage

库珀花环： 我来了，团长。您有什么事?
Kiperina: Here I am, Ringmaster. How can I help you?

科兹洛夫正擦拭着座椅上的一小撮烟灰，听到库珀花环的声音，他立刻抬起头来。
Mr. Kozlov brushes a little ash off his seat, but when he hears Kiperina's voice, he bolts up immediately.

科兹洛夫： 平时就不用叫我团长了。阿涅娅，你今天感觉怎么样?
Mr. Kozlov: Oh, Alia. No need to be so formal outside of work. Anyways, how is it you are feeling today?

科兹洛夫： 可别把一切想得太麻烦，你多休息休息，我们大伙儿也不会吃不起饭饿肚子。
Mr. Kozlov: I don't want you to be overwhelmed. Take time for a little rest. Old Kozlov can manage things from here.

库珀花环： 上次摔下钢丝只是非常罕见的意外，我完全可以保证！
Kiperina: Please, it was just a thoughtless accident, and I won't let it happen again, I promise!

库珀花环：最近我都很有精神，很健康，娜塔莉亚女士她们也知道，您可以问问大家我是不是每天都活蹦乱跳。
Kiperina: I've fully recovered. I know you're worried about me, but just ask anyone and you'll know I'm not lying. Even Mrs. Kozlov agreed.

库珀花环：您看，我甚至能给您来场小小的烟花表演。
Kiperina: See. I can even put on my firework show again.

光点在伸出的指尖炸开，短暂地将周围映亮，如同白昼。
Light bursts out from her outstretched fingertip, briefly illuminating the space like it's midday.

像一株进行光合作用的植物那样，捕捉光粒子，储存它们，释放它们。
Like a plant drawing in sunlight, absorbing it, storing it, and then releasing it again.

美丽但缺乏作用的神秘术。
A beautiful, if useless, arcane skill.

科兹洛夫：多漂亮！看来北方哨歌女士教你的神秘术技巧你都记得很牢。
Mr. Kozlov: Oh! More beautiful than ever! It seems you've mastered the techniques that Ms. Windsong taught you.

科兹洛夫：我们的阿涅娅的确是理线学的好苗子！
Mr. Kozlov: There's no doubt our Alia has a budding talent for these ley line things!

库珀花环：您又在提那件事了，我当时已经和那位女士好好说过，我暂时不打算离开马戏团。
Kiperina: Please don't start that again. I already told Ms. Windsong that I had no plans to leave the circus.

科兹洛夫：我知道了，我知道了。喔，对了，有件事我要告诉你。
Mr. Kozlov: I know, I know. Such a loyal star you are. Oh, but there's something I should tell you.

中年人清了清嗓子，想尽力以自然的方式带过这个略显突兀的话题。
He clears his throat, trying to smooth over the sudden topic shift.

科兹洛夫：是这样，我们要去米尔内演出。
听说那个镇子能看到极光，风景相当不错。
Mr. Kozlov: Ahem, um, it's ... we're going to hold a show up near Mirny. They say the night sky is beautiful that far north. Perhaps you might even see the aurora.

库珀花环：突然去那么远的新地方？我们碰上了麻烦吗？
Kiperina: All of a sudden? But it's so far from here. Are we in trouble?

科兹洛夫：都挺好的……不是麻烦，其实……
Mr. Kozlov: No, everything's fine. I-It's just ...

科兹洛夫略显局促地搓着手，他实在不擅长拐着弯说话。
Mr. Kozlov wrings his hands. Subtlety is not his strong suit.

科兹洛夫：其实——阿涅娅，北方哨歌女士联系了我，她的一位朋友想邀请你去米尔内。
Mr. Kozlov: Actually, Alia, Ms. Windsong called me. A friend of hers would like to meet you in Mirny.

科兹洛夫：那位朋友是拉普拉斯的人……我打听过，他们在神秘学交易市场口碑非常好。
Mr. Kozlov: They work for an organization called Laplace. I made inquiries at the arcane market. They have a good reputation.

科兹洛夫：还有人提到他们和圣洛夫基金会的关系，听说基金会正在从外面招揽神秘学家。
Mr. Kozlov: Someone even told me that they were related to the St. Pavlov Foundation—that big organization that recruits all kinds of arcanists.

科兹洛夫：我的年纪可不行啦，但你还年轻。假如——万一你能加入拉普拉斯或者基金会，绝对比跟着马戏团东奔西跑要好得多——

Mr. Kozlov: We are old, Alia, but you, your life has just begun. If you were to join Laplace or the Foundation, you'd live a much better life than any you could have in our little circus.

库珀花环：……您还是想把我送走，是不是?

Kiperina: Do you want me to leave?

科兹洛夫：我们只是去看看。你可能要参加一些训练，但如果不开心，不想继续，可以退出。

Mr. Kozlov: No. No, Alia. We just want to let you have another try. There may be some training involved, but we will not force you to stay. You can quit anytime you like.

科兹洛夫：我希望你能平安、开心地过日子。你摔下去那次，把我和娜塔莉亚都吓坏了，我实在不愿意——

Mr. Kozlov: Natalya and I, we hope you will have a safe and happy life. After that last time when you fell from the wire, we-we just can't bear to—

库珀花环：……如果您希望我去，我会去的。科兹洛夫先生。

Kiperina: Then I'll go, Mr. Kozlov, if that's what you want for me.

感知到眼前孩子话语里的妥协，中年人叹了口气，像往常一样用宽厚的手掌轻轻摸了摸她的脑袋。

Sensing the compromise in the girl's words, the man sighs and pats her head with a broad, fatherly hand.

科兹洛夫：我们不是要赶你走，阿涅娅。这样稳定、安全、舒适的地方，不是什么时候都能遇到。你才十五岁，没有尝过从雪堆里刨土豆填肚子的滋味……

Mr. Kozlov: We don't want you to leave, Alia. But this is an opportunity for you to live in comfort and safety. You're just 15. We don't want you to have to learn what it feels like to scrounge for food in the freezing wild.

他没继续说下去，那并不是美好的回忆，不需要讲给一个孩子。

He leaves it there. Some memories aren't worth retelling—not to a child.

科兹洛夫：我们至少去试一试。你也随时可以回乌特恩亚亚，这里是你长大的地方，当然也永远是你的家。

Mr. Kozlov: Let's just give it a try. What do you say? You will always be welcome to come back to the Utrennyaya when you want. We will never turn you away from your home.

库珀花环：我一直这么想。

Kiperina: I've always known that.

她露出了一个微笑，但并不足以遮掩那份觉得自己无足轻重的失落。

She smiles, but it's not enough to hide the quiet weight of her insecurity.

科兹洛夫：……北方哨歌女士给过你名片，你记得吗?

Mr. Kozlov: Ms. Windsong gave you her card, remember?

库珀花环：那张名片早就不知道去哪里啦。我本来以为他们不会需要照明灯泡。

Kiperina: I forgot where I put it. I figured they wouldn't ever find a need for a living light bulb.

科兹洛夫：阿涅娅——

Mr. Kozlov: Alia ...

库珀花环：科兹洛夫先生，我们做好计划了吗？要带哪些东西去，什么时候动身？还有，从陆地走吗?

Kiperina: So, then have you already planned the route, Mr. Kozlov? Are we traveling overland? When do we set off? And what are we taking with us?

库珀花环：那边的气候怎么样，需不需要另外添衣服?

Kiperina: What's the weather like in Mirny? Should I pack some warmer clothes?

库珀花环： 药箱里的药品也很久没补充了，我待会就去检查。您记得规划动物们的运输……
Kiperina: Oh, it's been a while since the last time we restocked the medical kit. I'll check it later. We need to prepare for the animals' transportation.

科兹洛夫： 好，我都记着。你这孩子，总是很有主意……
Mr. Kozlov: Of course, of course, it's all in hand already. Our Alia, always such a self-starter.

科兹洛夫咕哝着转过身。比起抱怨，他的语气更多地呈现出一种自豪。
Muttering, Mr. Kozlov turns away. It sounds more like pride than complaint.

科兹洛夫： 拉普拉斯的先生女士们眼光可高着呢！说到底，还是我们的阿涅娅够出色，做什么都仔细得很……
Mr. Kozlov: Laplace sets a very high standard for its staff! Our Alia could only have been chosen if she were very special. Just see how she pays attention to each little detail.

有主意的小姑娘等待着科兹洛夫的身影彻底消失。
The clever girl waits until Mr. Kozlov has disappeared.

她很少撒谎，所以偶尔为之的谎言也几乎不会被揭穿。
She rarely lies, so, on the rare occasion she needs to, no one ever suspects.

名片还在她这儿，被收在衣服的内袋里。
The card's still with her, tucked in the inside pocket of her coat.

她说不清自己是否有一瞬间想要前往更远的、更辽阔的土地。
She isn't sure yet whether she really wants to chase after a faraway, wider world.

库珀花环： 北方哨歌。理线学学者。
Kiperina: Windsong. Ley Lines Scholar.

库珀花环： 还是不明白这门学科要学习什么，工程类？数学？根本打听不到相关的消息……
Kiperina: I still don't get it. What even is "The Study of Ley Lines"? Is it like Arcanist Engineering? Or Math? I've never seen or heard of anything like it.

库珀花环： 等见到了她，去学习理线学，我是不是就要离开乌特恩亚亚？
Kiperina: If I start to study these ley lines, does that mean I'll have to leave Utrennyaya forever?

库珀花环： ……科兹洛夫先生已经不需要我参加演出了吗？
Kiperina: That I won't be with Mr. and Mrs. Kozlov and the circus anymore?

她无法立刻得知答案，只能选择先回房间睡个好觉。
She's still waiting on an answer from her mind, her heart, somewhere. So for now, she'll go back to her room and sleep in it.

马戏团·休憩帐篷
Circus Tent

库珀花环： 乌特恩亚亚的顶棚……是娜塔莉亚女士装饰的，她说那是宇宙的样子。
Kiperina: Our circus's big top was decorated by Mrs. Kozlov. She said that she wanted it to reflect the beauty of the stars and the weightlessness of outer space.

库珀花环： 我离开乌特恩亚亚之后，还能再见到这么好看的景色吗？
Kiperina: Such a beautiful view. Will I ever be able to see it again if I leave here?

库珀花环： 去见大家期望我见的人。然后一切都会变得更好……是这样吗？
Kiperina: I suppose I must meet these Laplace people, if that is what my family wants me to do. This way, we'll all be able to live a better life, right?

她慢慢闭上眼睛，想象着许多光点从眼前丝绒幕布般的黑暗中浮现。
She lets her eyes close, picturing tiny specks of light emerging from the velvet darkness behind her lids.

库珀花环： 一颗……两颗……大熊座，小熊座……
Kiperina: One star ... two stars ... Ursa Major—the Great Bear, and the Little Bear ...

库珀花环： 米尔内……真奇怪，马戏团应该没去过那里，但我却能想象出那里的星空。
Kiperina: Mirny ... I don't think we've ever been there before, but I feel like I already know what the stars look like from there. How strange.

库珀花环： 那些遥远的星星，也会迷失、也会流浪吗?
Kiperina: I wonder if the stars ever wander away from the sky. Will they all disappear one day?

库珀花环： 它们做的梦……又是怎样的呢……
Kiperina: What are their dreams like?

女孩渐渐沉入梦乡。在梦中，她带着一颗闪烁的星星，踏进了那座名为米尔内的小镇。
She drifts off to sleep. Soon, she finds herself walking through Mirny, holding a sparkling star in her hand.

更北边的小镇，能见到极光的小镇。至少那应该是个美丽的地方。
Mirny is a place in the far north where you can see the aurora. She hopes it's as beautiful as it is in her dream.

Красивая?
“美丽的?”
Красивая?
"Beautiful"?

米尔内驻军 Ⅰ： 在那边！跟紧点，那到底是什么玩意?
Mirny Soldier I: Over there! Keep up! What the hell is that?!

???: ……

???: ...

米尔内驻军 Ⅱ： 该死，是熊？这么灵活的熊?
Mirny Soldier II: Damn, is that a bear? But it's so fast!

米尔内驻军 Ⅲ： 它到底从哪儿进来的？难道附近还有能穿墙的魔精?!
Mirny Soldier III: How did it get in here? I've never heard of any kind of critter around here that can pass through walls like that!

???: ……

???: ...

米尔内驻军 Ⅱ： 我跟上了！就在这里！快——
Mirny Soldier II: I caught it! Over here! Help, quickly!

追在身后的脚步彻底远去。
The sound of her pursuers fades into the distance.

必须摆脱周围的黑暗，前往有光亮的地方。
She must escape the darkness around her and move toward the light.

有光的地方，就有活物，有其他声音。
Where there is light, there is life, and other voices.

电台节目： “旅行者二号的拍摄平台已顺利修复，将依照原定计划继续前进，以对天王星进行探测……”
Radio: "Voyager 2 has successfully repaired its imaging platform and will proceed according to its originally scheduled exploration of Uranus ..."

电台节目：“旅行者一号仍在向太阳系外飞行，根据预测，大约七万年后，它会掠过半人马座比邻星……”

Radio: "Voyager 1 continues its journey to the edge of the solar system and beyond. According to our projections, it is expected to pass by Proxima Centauri in around 70,000 years ..."

库珀花环：呃……

Kiperina: Mmm.

从毯子里探出的手摸索一阵，终于成功按下了收音机的开关。

A hand slips out from under the blanket, fumbling around until it finally finds the radio's switch.

库珀花环：又做了那种奇怪的梦。明明已经来到米尔内一段时间了，梦里的场景却越来越清晰了……

Kiperina: The same strange dream again. It's gotten more and more detailed since we arrived in Mirny.

库珀花环：别总想着它，得想点儿其他的。团长和北方哨歌女士约定了一周后再见面，在此之前，我还是要认真准备好演出。

Kiperina: I need something to distract myself. Ms. Windsong and Mr. Kozlov made an appointment to meet next week. Until then, I should continue to prepare for our show.

库珀花环：今晚就是乌特恩亚亚在米尔内的第一场马戏表演，在这个新地方……

Kiperina: Utrennyaya is making its debut in Mirny tonight. It's a new beginning.

她稍稍探出脑袋，向帐篷外看去。

She peeks her head out just a little, peering past the tent flap.

马戏团的帐篷对面是一家小餐馆，远远传来的喧闹令她安心。米尔内的街巷总回荡着士兵巡逻时整齐的脚步，这在别处也很少见。

Across from their circus tent stands a small restaurant, and the distant sounds of conversation put her at ease. The streets of Mirny echo with the steady rhythm of patrolling boots.

尽管还没有见到大家所说的极光，但这些独特的体验足以叫她的心脏怦怦直跳。

She hasn't seen the aurora yet, but even so, the novelty of it all makes her heart race.

库珀花环：呼……待会儿我得打起精神，好好表现。

Kiperina: *deep breath* I just need to cheer up and do my best.

库珀花环：第一场表演，必须给每个观众都留下好印象。

Kiperina: I guess it's also my debut in Mirny. And first impressions are everything.

库珀花环：也许我赢得足够多的喝彩声，科兹洛夫先生和娜塔莉亚女士就会改变主意……

Kiperina: Maybe Mr. and Mrs. Kozlov will change their minds if I can win over the audience.

她踏出帐篷，准备迎接自己在米尔内的首次演出。

She steps out of the tent, ready for her first performance in Mirny.

马戏团员：接下来登场的是我们乌特恩亚亚马戏团最年轻的空中飞人、钢丝上的舞者——

Circus Barker: Ladies and gentlemen, introducing our fabulous wire dancer, the youngest acrobat of the Utrennyaya Circus—

马戏团员：——库珀花环！

Circus Barker: Kiperina!

???：……！

???: ...!

就在这里。

Right here.

朝着光亮的地方前进，她见到许多发出声音的生物。

Heading toward the light, she sees many creatures making noise.

所有声音似乎都指向她的头顶，为了瞧得更清楚，她努力地穿过人群，高高仰起头。
The sounds seem to rise above her head. To see more clearly, she pushes through the crowd and looks up.

欢呼与呐喊，掌声与心跳。它们如同行星环绕着高空的身影。
Cheers and shouts, applause and heartbeats—they circle the figure above like planetary rings.

在身影周围绽开了许多光点，其中一小部分令她感到熟悉。那些粒子诞生于她故乡的星云。
Points of light burst around the figure's silhouette. A few of them feel familiar. These particles were born from the nebula of her home.

她观察四周，在这片喧哗中露出微笑。地球是多么热闹而美丽的地方啊。
She looks around, smiling in the middle of the noise. Earth is such a lively and beautiful place.

吸气，在钢丝上腾跃，回身，抬手致意，吐气。
Breathe deep. Leap onto the wire. Twist, raise a hand in salute, and then exhale.

观众的欢呼为这套动作打出十分。
The audience erupts into applause—a perfect score for her routine.

库珀花环：——像这样做到完美，真的就能留下来吗?
Kiperina: Will they let me stay if I keep giving perfect performances like this?

压在心底的疑惑伸出了触角。
The doubts buried in her chest begin to stir.

钢丝上的库珀花环恍然回望，突然发觉现在无论往前、往后，都是空无一人。
On the wire, Kiperina looks back, only to realize there's no one ahead of her nor behind.

——我该前进，还是后退?
Should I move forward or back?

她下意识攥紧手掌，向着欢呼声投去视线。
Instinctively, she clenches her fist and follows the cheers with her eyes.

从高空望下去，几乎不可能认得清哪张脸。
From these heights, it's hard to recognize anyone.

就算是再熟悉的朋友，都会融入这片遥远的洪流。
There are no friendly faces, no family. She's alone on the wire.

如无意外，本该如此。
And that's how it's supposed to be.

???: ……!

???: ...!

就像那个梦境一样。一颗闪烁的星星为她指引了方向。
Just like her dream. A flickering star points the way forward.

——别停留在这儿。前进，这也是大家所期望的。
Don't stand still too long. They all want you to move on. They all want to see how far you'll go.

她稳了稳心神，再次迈步。
She steadies herself to take another step.

向前走。
Move forward.

演出结束，观众们都已离场。中年人边收拾着舞台的布景和道具，边向女孩传达自己的骄傲。
The show is over, the audience gone. Mr. Kozlov packs away the stage props, his voice booming with pride.

科兹洛夫：刚才我和娜塔莉亚在后台还担心呢，但最后的效果完全超出我们的预料！
Mr. Kozlov: Natalya and I were a little worried for you back there, but it seems our worrying was for nothing. The show was even better than we hoped.

科兹洛夫：你做得太好了，阿涅娅！这是近段时间以来观众反响最好的一次，来米尔内真是个正确的选择！
Mr. Kozlov: You did such a good job, Alia. The audience was thrilled! I knew we came to the right place.

科兹洛夫：今晚可得让娜塔莉亚做顿丰盛的好好犒劳一下你。也庆祝我们的阿涅娅马上能和拉普拉斯的先生女士们共事了！
Mr. Kozlov: I'll ask Natalya to prepare us a proper banquet tonight, something to reward our darling Alia and celebrate your new job at Laplace.

库珀花环：这还是说不准的事呢……不过我会努力的。
Kiperina: We still don't know about that yet, but I'll try my best.

科兹洛夫：我知道的，你只要下定决心，什么都能做到！好了，好了，我得和娜塔莉亚好好商量一下今晚的菜谱……
Mr. Kozlov: I know you can do anything once you make up your mind to do it. And now, I must go discuss tonight's food with Natalya.

中年人拿着道具絮絮叨叨地走远了。库珀花环环顾四周，发觉这里只剩下了两个小小的身影。
He walks off, still rambling, with the props in hand. Kiperina looks around. The massive tent now holds just two small figures.

一个是她，另一个是刚才的女孩。
One is her, and the other is the girl from before.

库珀花环：……
Kiperina: ...

女孩似乎还沉浸于演出中。她仰望着舞台，眼神和库珀花环在高空中捕捉到的一样明亮。
The girl seems lost in the performance. She stares up at the stage, her eyes just as bright as the star that guided her to the other side of the rope.

库珀花环：或许她只是想多休息一下？或者，她在等人……
Kiperina: Perhaps she's taking a break? Or waiting for someone.

乌特恩亚亚从不拒绝观众的停留，库珀花环也不擅长和陌生人打交道。
She knows that Utrennyaya never turns away lingering audience members, but talking to new people has never been her strength.

但刚才的演出让她觉得，虽然还不明白之后会如何，但有时尝试向前一步也不错。
Still, the show reminded her—sometimes it's worth taking that step forward, even if you don't know what comes next.

她不再犹豫，向着女孩走去。
She doesn't hesitate this time.

库珀花环：……您好？
Kiperina: ... Hello?

时间简谱
A Score of Time CO-05

电台节目：“我们认为，旅行者一号也许将永远在银河系漫游……”
Radio: "We believe Voyager 1 will continue to explore the galaxy on and on ..."

电台节目：“它将带着人类探索的证明前往星空深处，很可能会比地球上的生灵存在得更为长久……”
Radio: "Traveling into the depths of the universe, carrying with it humanity's spirit of exploration, it is likely to persist longer than life on Earth ..."

收音机的播报总能吸引这位新朋友的注意力，她这几天都花上相当多的时间研究这个小方盒子。
The radio catches her new friend's attention in an odd way. She's spent the past few days fascinated with the little musical box.

直到有其他声音盖过播报声。
Until another voice cuts through the broadcast.

库珀花环：明天天气怎么样？如果是晴天，去散步的时候就能走得稍微远一些。
Kiperina: What will the weather be like tomorrow? Maybe we can take a longer walk if it's sunny.

库珀花环：你还没有见过米尔内的钻石矿对不对？
Kiperina: You haven't seen the diamond mine here in Mirny, have you?

女孩儿摇了摇头，把收音机放到旁边，等待库珀花环的下一句话。
The girl shakes her head, sets the radio aside, and waits for Kiperina to speak.

为了更好地继续这场对话，库珀花环蹲下身。现在她们的视线平齐了。
Kiperina kneels down. Now, they're eye to eye.

库珀花环：你回忆起什么了吗？我试着打听你的家，但大家都说对你没有印象。
Kiperina: Is anything coming back to you? I asked some people around about you, but no one had any clue.

库珀花环：不过别担心，我们大多数人都是科兹洛夫团长收养的孩子。就算你继续在这里停留，他也不会介意的。他从不拒绝真正需要帮助的人。
Kiperina: Don't worry. Most of us in the circus were adopted by Mr. Kozlov, so he won't mind if you stay with us. He always gives a hand to those in need.

库珀花环：而且，我明天会去和一位很厉害的女士碰面。她见识很广，也许她听说过你。
Kiperina: And I'm going to meet an extraordinary lady tomorrow. She knows a lot. Maybe she will know who you are.

???：……

???：...

库珀花环惯于处理这样的茫然，她还记得那些无法回家的孩子刚来到马戏团时，是怎样在她和娜塔莉亚女士的安抚下露出笑容的。
Kiperina is used to this kind of blank stare. She's seen it on the faces of children that were lost while they were at the circus—how Mrs. Kozlov had comforted them, and kept them entertained until the smiles returned to their faces.

她站起身子，往后退开一两步，向眼前的女孩儿伸出手。
She stands up, steps back, and reaches her hand toward the girl.

库珀花环：对了——你瞧。
Kiperina: Hey, look at this.

指尖绽开的小小光亮为房间增添了一缕暖色。
A soft glow blooms at her fingertip, warming the tent with its light.

库珀花环：这是我的神秘术，虽然派不上什么用场，但是不是还挺漂亮的?
Kiperina: It's my arcane skill. It's not very useful, I know, but don't you think it's pretty?

库珀花环：他们都说像星星一样。
Kiperina: People say it looks like the stars.

???：……嗯。
???: ... Mhm.

细微的亮光让女孩儿露出笑意，她看上去放松了许多。
The tiny light served its purpose. She seems far more at ease now.

库珀花环：如果你喜欢，我还可以再给你表演这个。
Kiperina: I could do it again if you like.

库珀花环：我们再试试——你能不能拼出自己的名字?
Kiperina: Let's try something. Can you spell your name?

女孩儿打量着被推到眼前的积木块。她不知道如何写出这颗星球上的文字，于是无从分享自己的故乡与名姓。
The girl eyes the colorful, crooked row of blocks placed in front of her. She doesn't know anything about the writing of this planet, so there's no way to share her name or where she's from.

这些生物需要一个称呼来达成交流。她明白了。
But this creature wants a name to communicate with her. She understands that much.

积木块组成了一条歪歪扭扭、颜色缤纷的轨迹。
The blocks form a messy, colorful path. A logic forms in her mind.

库珀花环尝试着将自己认识的词汇从这片彩色中打捞起来。
Kiperina searches for something familiar among the colors.

库珀花环：……航行……者?
Kiperina: Long journey ... traveler?

库珀花环：总觉得这是你刚从收音机里挑的词……
Kiperina: *sigh* Sounds like you just picked these words up from the radio.

???：……
???: ...

库珀花环：你也像它们一样走过很长的路，才来到米尔内吗?
Kiperina: Did you go on a long journey to reach Mirny?

库珀花环：唔……我想想，科兹洛夫先生是怎么给我们起演出用的名称来着?
Kiperina: Hmm. How was it that Mr. Kozlov decided on our stage names? Give me a second.

库珀花环：“漫长的旅程”和“旅行”，合并起来——
Kiperina: "Long journey," we could call that a "voyage." That would make you, who traveled a long journey, a ...

库珀花环：——“远旅”。
Kiperina: Voyager.

库珀花环伸出手，比划出她想象中旅行者号的飞行轨迹。
Kiperina stretches out her hand and traces the imagined path of the Voyager probe.

女孩儿思索了片刻，然后也学着伸出手。
The girl watches for a moment, then imitates the gesture.

远旅：……库珀花环。
Voyager: Kiperina.

手指调转方向，她指了指自己。
She twists her finger and points to herself.

远旅： 远旅。
Voyager: Voyager.

库珀花环： 你有了一个“乌特恩亚亚”风格的名字，现在你也是马戏团的一员啦。
Kiperina: Now that you have a stage name, you are now an official member of the Utrennyaya Circus.

库珀花环： ……咦?
Kiperina: Hmm?

远旅忽然转头望向帐篷门口，没过几秒，脚步声和亲切的呼唤声一同响起。
Voyager spins herself toward the tent's entrance. A moment later, footsteps and a familiar, friendly voice arrive together.

娜塔莉亚： 阿涅娅，你带过来的小姑娘呢？我见她总盯着动物笼子看，就从里头给她捉了只兔崽。
Natalya Kozlov: Alia, where's that girl? The one who was staring at the animals before? I brought a bunny around for her.

娜塔莉亚： 科兹洛夫让我来照顾她，你明天还得和拉普拉斯的先生女士们见面，是不是?
Natalya Kozlov: I suppose I'll be looking after her now, because you're meeting those Laplace people tomorrow, right?

娜塔莉亚： 你得好好休息。就听我的，去镇上吃一顿，早点儿睡。
Natalya Kozlov: You need a rest, Alia. Now do as Mama Kozlov says: go have a nice meal at the restaurant in town and then straight to bed early.

库珀花环： 娜塔莉亚女士！我不需要——
Kiperina: Mrs. Kozlov, I don't need to ...

娜塔莉亚： 好啦，今晚我可没煮你那份炖菜。快去吧，科兹洛夫都给餐馆付过钱了。
Natalya Kozlov: Hush, just go. I didn't cook anything for you tonight. We've already paid the restaurant.

远旅在门和自己的朋友之间来回瞧了几次，最终还是选择了那只毛绒绒的兔子。
Voyager's head twists, unsure of where to look between the door and her new friend, but in the end, she chooses the fuzzy rabbit.

帐篷里重归安静，只剩下满脸无奈的库珀花环。
The tent falls quiet again, leaving Kiperina alone, looking helpless.

库珀花环： ……
Kiperina: ...

库珀花环： 我早就不是需要被过度关心的小孩子了……
Kiperina: I'm not just a little kid that you need to take care of.

库珀花环： 好吧，去餐馆，然后回来多做一个小时训练。
Kiperina: Fine. I'll go, and after that, I will train for another hour.

库珀花环： 对……就这么办。
Kiperina: Yes, that's for the best.

冷周六： 就这么办，老板。
Hissabeth: That's all. Thanks.

小镇餐馆
Restaurant, Town

研究员合上菜单，把它推往柜台对面。
She closes the menu and slides it across the counter.

冷周六：不好意思，我点完了。继续说说？你在米尔内捡到了一位小朋友，然后呢?
Hissabeth: Sorry, it sometimes takes us a while to decide on an order. So, you were saying you found a strange girl here in Mirny, and then?

冷周六：你手上的仪器很别致，这是北方哨歌留下的?
Hissabeth: Hold on! That special device you're holding. Did you get it from Windsong?

库珀花环：是的。来米尔内之前，我不小心在一场表演中摔下了钢丝，那时北方哨歌女士恰好在现场。
Kiperina: Yes. Before I came to Mirny, I fell from the wire during a show, and Ms. Windsong happened to be there.

库珀花环：虽然记不清具体细节，但北方哨歌女士说，是我的神秘术保护了我不摔伤。
Kiperina: I don't remember the details, but she said my arcane skill was able to protect me.

库珀花环：她帮助我收起了身体周围的光幕，还试着分析了神秘术的原理。虽然我最后仍然没听懂。
Kiperina: She helped me draw out the aura from around my body and analyzed how it worked. Though I didn't understand that part at all.

库珀花环：但我记住了她用的方法，理线学。她借给我的测量仪也的确让我更容易控制自己的神秘术。
Kiperina: But the name of her theory is still clear in my mind—The Study of Ley Lines. She gave me this device before she left. She said it would make it easier to control my arcane skill.

库珀花环：再加上，团长也希望我能答应邀请……所以我决定明天还是去和她见一面。
Kiperina: Mr. Kozlov wants me to give it a try again, so I've decided to go see her tomorrow.

冷周六：挺好，她是个很不错的学者。虽然理线学基本上是纯理论内容，但实践研究也离不开理论支持。
Hissabeth: Cool. She's a great researcher. The Study of Ley Lines is still highly theoretical, but as we say at Laplace, theory often lays the foundation for practice.

冷周六：你要是真打算加入拉普拉斯，我也能给你写推荐信。
Hissabeth: If you do decide to join us, I'd be happy to write a reference letter for you.

库珀花环：您也是拉普拉斯的研究员?
Kiperina: You're a Laplace researcher?

冷周六：我看起来不像？奇怪，那群家伙总说我打扮得很符合他们的刻板印象，怪胎科学家之类的。
Hissabeth: You didn't already guess? Hmm. My colleagues often say I dress, you know, like a mad scientist.

库珀花环：不，我还以为你们不会来吃这种普通的路边餐馆……
Kiperina: I guess it's that I never thought I would meet a scientist eating at a little restaurant like this.

冷周六：拜托啦，搞研究的也是活物，得吃饭睡觉——
Hissabeth: Oh, please, I'm sure you're aware that scientists are living things too. We need to eat just like everyone else.

几条小蛇从冷周六的头发里探出身子，跟着她的笑声点了点头。
A few little snakes poke out of Hissabeth's hair, nodding along with her laughter.

其中一条仰着头，让库珀花环抚摸它的脑袋，鳞片的触感光滑且冰冷。
One tilts its head up, letting Kiperina stroke it. Its scales feel smooth and cold.

冷周六：你真的不怕他们。
Hissabeth: Looks like you meant it when you said you're good with animals.

库珀花环：我和动物们相处的时间久着呢。马戏团里有一只我自己养大的小熊。
Kiperina: I spend a lot of time with them in the circus. I even helped raise one of our bear cubs.

库珀花环走进店里不久，这位研究员就也进了门，径直坐在她旁边。
Kiperina hadn't been in the restaurant long before Hissabeth walked in and sat right beside her.

一条小蛇率先好奇地打量起库珀花环，她也友善地和这条小蛇打了个招呼。
One of the snakes takes the lead in inspecting Kiperina, who greets it kindly in return.

借着这份契机，她们很快找到了共同话题。
That's all it takes for the two to find common ground.

冷周六：回到我最开始的疑问，你为什么要坚持做空中飞人？
Hissabeth: You know you haven't answered my question yet. Why do you choose to be an acrobat?

冷周六：在高空靠一根这么细的线行走，你不会害怕？还是说你觉得干这行很酷？
Hissabeth: Don't you find it scary to walk on a wire all the way up in the air? I suppose it is a really cool job, though.

库珀花环：嗯……我承认这是很酷。但我喜欢的其实是从空中往下望，那是平时无法体会的视角。
Kiperina: Well, it is cool, I have to admit. But what I really like about being up on the wire is that, when you look down, you get to see a view that no one else gets to in their daily life.

库珀花环：所有人看起来都一样。就像我在宇宙里，和无数相似的星星一同漂浮。
Kiperina: When I stand on the wire, the audience below look just like stars, and it feels like I'm floating in space with them.

库珀花环：那不是很棒吗？不用担心是否能派上用场，只是维持住自己的光就好。
Kiperina: Isn't that great? In that moment, I stop worrying about my performance and forget all expectations. I can just be in the moment, shining like a star.

冷周六：噢……的确。真有意思，我之所以跑到这个荒凉的鬼地方，就因为也有类似的念头。
Hissabeth: Oh, intriguing. You know, in a way, I came all the way out here because I had the same thought.

冷周六：我要和最聪明的大脑们在一块儿，那些闪耀的、人类和神秘学家的群星。
Hissabeth: I wanna work with the smartest minds in the world, whether humans or arcanists. They're also like the stars in a lot of ways, each one bound to go down in history.

冷周六：我也想弄清楚头顶这个罩子外头有些什么玩意。
Hissabeth: And I'm trying to find out what really exists beyond the limits of the sky.

库珀花环：你的兄弟姐妹也这么想？这些小蛇们……啊，它们睡着了。
Kiperina: Do all your siblings share the same feeling? They're such neat little snakes. Oh, it looks like they have fallen asleep.

冷周六：我们从未改变想法。
Hissabeth: We've always been on the same page when it comes to these things.

研究员转过头，库珀花环注意到她的瞳孔收成一条细线。
Hissabeth turns her head. Kiperina notices her pupils narrowing to a slit.

冷周六：你的神秘术和我预想中差不多。
Hissabeth: Your arcane skill is exactly as I expected.

冷周六：储存光，捕捉高能带电粒子，极光……原理类似于等离子防护罩……
Hissabeth: It captures photons from the aurora and stores them as latent energy; then, when it's deployed, it appears to form a kind of prismatic plasma barrier.

库珀花环：什么？
Kiperina: Wh-What?

冷周六：有空我会给你解释那些理论。太复杂了，一时半会讲不明白。
Hissabeth: I'll explain next time. It's complicated. It could take hours to get it into your head.

冷周六：好了，我大概清楚了。这里有一个适合你的机会，你要不要试着够到它?
Hissabeth: Still, it is most obvious to me that you are exactly the person we want for this opportunity. What do you say? Will you give it a try?

库珀花环：……?
Kiperina: ...?

冷周六：一个真正前往宇宙中的机会。
Hissabeth: An opportunity to reach the stars.

库珀花环：——!
Kiperina: ...!

库珀花环：您——您是北方哨歌女士的那位同事？邀请我来米尔内的人?
Kiperina: You mean you're the colleague Ms. Windsong mentioned? The one who invited me to Mirny?

库珀花环：我应该早点意识到……这是您设计的测验？可是，我刚才真的把您当做一位聊得来的……朋友……
Kiperina: I should've known. Was this a test? I thought you were a friend I could talk to.

冷周六：那就太好了，你能觉得我算“朋友”，这可是我近几个月听过最好的夸奖。
Hissabeth: A "friend"? Superbe, that's the best compliment I've received in months.

冷周六：谁会费尽心思设计这种测验？只是碰巧我俩都有不错的用餐品味而已。
Hissabeth: Relax, this wasn't a test at all. We just happen to share the same taste in food.

冷周六：不过，为了这个奇迹般的巧合，你也该认真考虑一下邀请。
Hissabeth: But I do hope you'll consider our offer seriously, in the spirit of the good time we had together.

库珀花环：去宇宙里？您想要让我试着做一位……宇航员……?
Kiperina: Are you serious though? You really mean you want me to become an astronaut?

这份邀请听起来过于遥远，即使在最不切实际的梦境里，她也没有想过。
The invitation seems too far-fetched. Even in her wildest dreams, she could never have imagined it.

冷周六：是的。
Hissabeth: Exactly.

但冷周六的确认非常郑重。与此前闲聊时的态度截然不同。
But Hissabeth's response carries a rare weight, different from her usual casual tone.

冷周六：你仍然可以明天再答复。
Hissabeth: Don't rush to a decision. We can wait till tomorrow.

冷周六：算着时间，我正等的那批材料也该在明天送到。或许那位送货的职员还能顺路给你捎点小礼物。
Hissabeth: In fact, the materials I've been expecting should arrive tomorrow as well. Maybe the delivery guy will bring you a small gift along the way.

库珀花环：不用这么麻烦的，我也没有给大家准备什么东西……
Kiperina: You don't have to. Sorry, I didn't prepare any gifts.

冷周六：别紧张，你们的家乡都在这片土地上，应该能好好相处。而且他的名字和你一样有趣，怎么说来着……对了。
Hissabeth: Don't be silly. It's just a friendly gesture. I believe you come from the same region, so I'll bet you two will get along quite famously. And he has an interesting nickname too. It was, umm, oh, right—

“命名日”。
Name Day.

奇遇的预感
An Unexpected Encounter 小径

奇遇的预感
An Unexpected Encounter

简中
视线被光芒包围了，但没有痛感，周围的惊叫声和脚步声也一清二楚。
科兹洛夫与娜塔莉亚的脚步声最先传来，他们的声音比自己的心跳声还要熟悉。
山羊蹄声是以利亚带来的，他的骑术表演才进行到一半。
格外轻快的跳步声属于弗拉西奥斯，那是他练习杂耍留下的习惯。
“各位不必惊慌，她的神秘术把她保护得很好。”以及一道陌生的声音，那应该属于观众，有观众走上了舞台，“放松些，姑娘，不要想太多，告诉我你现在能看到什么?”
“非常不可思议，我看到星星，一颗流星正向我飞来。”
陌生的声音在她身旁蹲下，眼前的光芒稍微暗淡了些许。“现在我要用理线学的方式解除你的神秘术，不要紧张，随便和我说些什么，你有哪些兴趣爱好?”
“可能算不上喜欢，但我常听收音机和天气预报……我还常常在陌生的地方探险，为了不迷路，我会记住路上所有奇形怪状的树和石头的位置……那颗星星还在闪烁，这不正常，对么?”
“别担心，或许今天的一切都是为了让你遇到这颗星星。让我们继续聊天，想不想跟我研究理线学？你有这个天赋……”

English
Surrounded by light but feeling no pain. The screams and footsteps around her are crystal clear.

The first footsteps she hears are Kozlov and Natalya's. Their voices are more familiar than her own heartbeat.

The clatter of goat hooves belongs to Elijah, still midway through his riding performance.

The particularly light, quick footsteps are Fracios's, a habit left from his juggling practice.

"Everyone stay calm. Her Arcanum has protected her very well." A strange voice. Must be an audience member stepping onto the stage. "Relax, girl. Try not to think too much. Just tell me, what you see right now?"

"This is unbelievable. I see a star, a shooting star is flying right toward me."

The stranger crouches beside her. The light dims just a little. "I'm going to use Ley Lines to dissolve your Arcanum. Stay relaxed. Talk to me about anything. What hobbies do you have?"

"Maybe they're not really hobbies, but ... I like to listen to the radio and weather reports. I also like exploring strange places. To keep from getting lost, I memorize all the unusual-looking trees and rocks along the way ... That star is still twinkling. That's not normal, right?"

"Don't worry. Maybe everything today happened just so you could meet that star. Let's keep talking. Would you like to study Ley Lines with me? You have a real talent, I'm sure of it ..."

伟大的乌特恩亚亚马戏团

The Great Utrennyaya Circus 小径

伟大的乌特恩亚亚马戏团
The Great Utrennyaya Circus

简中
我们有最棒的舞台以及地球上的每一片雪。
我们是全世界最热情的马戏团。
以利亚可以让任何动物变成世界第一的骏马。
弗拉西奥斯的表演绝对能让你笑掉大牙。
还有库珀花环，我们娇小可爱的高空行者，她脚下的钢丝细到没有人瞧得见。
科兹洛夫团长将他一生的名誉都折叠在小小帐篷中。
现在起到下个月，新世界永远欢迎你！
English
We have the best stage on Earth, each show as unique as a flake of snow.

We bring the most spirited performances in the world.

Elijah can turn any animal into the finest steed alive.

Fracios's performances will make you laugh until you cry.

And Kiperina, our tiny and adorable aerialist, walks on a wire so thin no one can even see it.

Ringmaster Kozlov has folded his entire life's reputation into this little tent.

From now until next month, this new world welcomes you!

比旅程更险恶的 · 1/2

What's Worse than the Journey · 1/2 CO-06

骨头船舶、精巧的彩蛋、生锈的零件与边角泛黄的稿纸。
Ship models made of bone, delicate painted eggs, rusted parts, and yellowed scraps of draft paper.

众多陈旧物件被陈列在一块儿，出乎意料地达成了某种和谐。
Old pieces hastily thrown together somehow form an unexpected harmony.

基金会分部·储藏间
Storeroom, Foundation Branch

命名日： 136 号，来自……科雷马山地。
Name Day: No. 136, from near the Kolyma Mountains.

命名日： 讲述了“极地之星”的传说……某种突然发作的集体癔症。科拉半岛也有过类似记载。
Name Day: Tells the tale of the Polar Star icebreaker. The crew suffered some kind of mass hysteria. The same thing happened later in the Kola Peninsula.

基金会职员为这份笔记贴好标签，写上编号，最后仔细地收进抽屉。
He labels the notebook, writes down its number, and stores it away.

命名日： 这次的目的地离北极圈很近，运气好的话也能看到极光吧?
Name Day: Our destination is close to the Arctic Circle. With any luck, we should get a great view of the aurora.

1987 6 月 基金会远东分部
June 1987, Far East Branch of St. Pavlov Foundation

命名日，基金会调查员。目前供职于远东分部。
Name Day, Investigator for St. Pavlov Foundation. Currently serving for Far East Branch.

加入计划的原因……这可是工作。
Why did I join this project? Well, it is a job, and I like to do as I am told.

命名日： 涅瓦河，斯维里河，然后到奥涅加湖……走水路还挺快的，兴许还来得及捎点小礼物。
Name Day: Neva River, Lake Ladoga, Svir River, then Lake Onega ... It takes less time to travel by water. Maybe I can even buy a small gift along the way.

命名日： 米尔内除了钻石矿还有别的特产吗？噢，说不定回程可以顺路去彼得罗扎沃茨克。
Name Day: What sort of specialties does Mirny have other than diamonds? Oh, maybe I can stop by Petrozavodsk on my way back.

年轻人尝试着从地图上寻找出一条合适的线路。
He examines the map, plotting out a workable route.

命名日： 剩下的一点路得靠腿走了。普列谢茨克，那地方最多的就是雪地，除了雪什么也没有。
Name Day: Looks like I'll have to walk the rest of the way after landing. Ah, Plesetsk, a place of boundless snow and not much else.

好在他很熟悉该如何穿越整片茫茫白色。
Fortunately, endless white fields of snow are something with which he has a wealth of experience.

在极北之地追逐星星？把监测器送到星空中监测“暴雨”？
听起来倒很不错。
Trying to reach the stars in order to monitor the "Storm" from space, huh? Sounds like a good gig, even if it does mean being stationed at the northernmost frozen tip of the world.

或许只是他们众多研究里又一个徒劳的尝试。不过有人试试也挺好。
Maybe it will go nowhere, but what would we be without a little pioneering spirit?

在传说中，流星可以象征厄运将至，也可以预示即将到来的幸运。
In legends, a meteor may signal incoming disasters or foreshadow good fortune.

就像“永恒的灵魂”一样，这全都取决于看到它的人愿意相信哪种解释。
Like the "eternal soul," it all depends on what the viewer chooses to believe.

Вечный?
“永恒的?”
Вечный?
"Eternal"?

小命名日： 穿过这片雪地，对面就是……列宁格勒……
Little Name Day: Leningrad is just on the other side of this snowfield.

小命名日： 希望这颗星星会带来好运。
Little Name Day: I'll let that meteor guide my way.

最后他的确抵达了列宁格勒。
In the end, he made it to Leningrad.

命名日： 好吧，基金会的活儿总有这么多，很难说这是好运还是厄运……
Name Day: The Foundation never gives me a break, which I guess makes me equal parts lucky and unlucky.

???: 命名日先生?
???: Mr. Name Day?

命名日： 噢，我在——稍等！
Name Day: Yep. Hold on!

门扉敞开后，教师的脚边不出意料地跟着一团雪白的毛绒。
As the door opens, a bundle of energetic fluff appears, orbiting at his teacher's feet as expected.

维拉： 我听说你们今天就要出发执行新任务，要往更北边走，对吗?
Vila: I heard you were leaving for the north on a new mission. Is that true?

命名日： 只是个送东西的活儿，分部人手还是不太够，我一个人去。
Name Day: Just for an errand. The Far East Branch is short on staff right now, so I'm going all on my own.

命名日： 北方哨歌女士应该正在那儿做实地考察。有没有什么需要捎带的东西?
Name Day: Ms. Windsong should be on a field trip there. Is there anything you'd like me to give her?

阿夫西维： 是比来亚什基更北的地方吗？维拉和我能去那儿吗?
Avgust: Where is it? Is it north of Rayashki? Could I come visit there with Vila?

孩子的话语总是更为直接，熟悉的地名引发了一两秒沉默。
Children speak more directly, but the mention of a familiar place brings a few seconds of silence.

命名日： 这个……如果你好好完成课程，维拉女士也有足够的时间，你可以去任何安全的地方……
Name Day: Well, so long as you finish all your classes and get good grades, I'm certain you'll be able to go anywhere with Ms. Vila, as long as it is safe.

命名日： 但我没法保证未来的事儿。所以——阿夫西维同学，你有什么想要带去的东西，或者想要收到的礼物吗?
Name Day: But things could change. I can't promise anything. Except maybe a little souvenir when I get back. Now, Avgust, do you have anything you want me to give Ms. Windsong?

阿夫西维： 我有，维拉也有。我写了很多字，没有人讲睡前故事的时候，北方哨歌可以读它们。
Avgust: Yes, and Vila does too. I've written lots and lots of things. Comrade Windsong can read them when no one is there to tell her a bedtime story.

阿夫西维： 还有这个，来自长得最高、站得最直的一群向日葵哨兵!
Avgust: And this, from my tallest and most spirited sunflower guards!

小男孩费力地摸索着外套口袋，找到了他珍贵的收藏。
He fumbles through his coat pocket and pulls out his most prized possession.

阿夫西维： 不用给它们浇太多水，要晒太阳。
Avgust: You must not water them too much, and they should be placed somewhere under the sun.

一只手轻轻交出了信封，将它搭在种子旁边。
Vila passes an envelope over, placing it next to the seeds.

维拉： 我的确想拜托您为北方哨歌同志带一封信。
Vila: I'd like this to be delivered to Ms. Windsong.

维拉： 上次她在来信中提到，自己也尝试着当了回老师，发现教孩子们真是件不简单的事。
Vila: She said in the last letter that she had started to teach again, and it was more difficult than she remembered.

维拉： 我在信里写了些简单的教学经验，希望能帮上她。
Vila: I wrote a little bit about my own experience teaching. Hope it helps.

维拉： 如果您有什么好办法，也可以和她聊聊。尼娜、彼得森、帕索诺……都会时不时问起您，想知道您还会不会来和他们玩耍。
Vila: And please talk to her if you have any ideas. You're so good with kids. Nina, Pyotr, and Pasono ask about you all the time, always wondering when you'll visit again.

阿夫西维： 我没有问，我知道浣熊先生很忙。维拉也很忙，维拉每天都在涂涂画画，和白色衣服们说话……
Avgust: I didn't ask. I know how busy you are, Mr. Raccoon, and so is Vila. Every day, she's either painting something or talking to the white clothes.

命名日： 运气好的话，这趟任务结束我就能闲一阵子。我会来找你们玩，给你们变小玩意儿，怎么样？
Name Day: With any luck, I'll be free for a while after this mission. I'll come back and do some magic for you kids. What do you say?

年轻人蹲下身，朝那朵摇晃的向日葵伸出手指，勾了勾它的叶片。
He crouches and hooks his finger around the leaf of the wobbling sunflower.

命名日： 说好了？
Name Day: Deal?

阿夫西维： 一位真正的好同志从来都不违反约定！
Avgust: A good comrade must always keep his word!

毛绒绒的帽子上下摇晃了两次，看得出孩子正严肃、用力地点头。
The fuzzy hat bobs up and down twice—an earnest and sincere nod.

话题重新回到两位成年人之间。
The conversation shifts back to the two adults.

命名日： 听上去您最近的工作还挺顺利？基金会的课本不算复杂，但我想备课也得花不少工夫……
Name Day: Sounds like you've been doing well recently. The Foundation's textbook is an easy read, but I really hadn't expected just how effortlessly you'd be able to make your lesson plans.

维拉： 总不会比外勤任务更麻烦。不过您应该记得现在的任务要求——安全为先。
Vila: Lesson plans are nothing compared to field missions. Just keep this in mind during your errand: your safety is our first priority here.

命名日： 当然。而且外头现在恰好是个还算熟悉的时代……
Name Day: Of course, but the good news is I'm quite familiar with this era.

在这时代里，这座城市还没有改回“圣彼得堡”的旧名。
Though in this era, the city hasn't yet reverted to its old name—Saint Petersburg.

但涉足类似的话题，就难免也会提及那座消失在雪中的小镇。
Talk like this always seems to circle back to that little town swallowed in snow.

现在还不是合适的时机。
But now's not the time for that.

命名日： ……总之，信和种子我一定会带到北方哨歌女士手里。
Name Day: Um, anyway, I'll make sure Ms. Windsong receives Avgust's seeds and your letter.

维拉： 非常感谢。虽然有些啰嗦，但您独自执行任务，还是多加小心。
Vila: Thanks a lot. I don't want to make our goodbyes here too long-winded. Just take care, especially since you're going to be all on your own.

命名日： 其实准确来说，也不算真的只有我“一个人”……
Name Day: Well, I won't exactly be "all on my own."

旅途雪地
Snowy Field

含章鼎： 还有多远？我觉得我们马上就到了，我简直已经看到拉普拉斯建筑那种特别的金属房顶了！
Han Zhang: Hey, so, any idea how far off this place is? I think we must be pretty close. I can almost see that unmistakable Laplace metal roof!

含章鼎：我打算在米尔内简单做点生意，他们的金刚石能卖出好价钱。尤其是卖给东方分部那群家伙——

Han Zhang: I've actually got some business lined up in Mirny. Those diamonds of theirs are certain to fetch a tidy profit back in the East Branch.

命名日：我真后悔答应让你出来透气。能不能打个商量？你，安安静静地扮演货物，我，把你送到地方，剩下的话你可以找那个需要你帮忙的家伙念叨。

Name Day: I should've never let you out. Can we make a deal? You stay quiet, and I'll get you safely to our destination. Then, you can say whatever you've got to say to whoever made the mistake of inviting you here.

命名日：唉……你实在话太多了，他们不肯跑这趟肯定也有这原因！

Name Day: *sigh* You know you really, really, really like to talk? I'm beginning to understand why no one else would take this job!

含章鼎：难道你见过不擅长说话的商人？而且路上要是没点声响多无聊。

Han Zhang: Whoever heard of a merchant who doesn't like to talk? Ha. Admit it, you'd be bored to tears if I were not here.

含章鼎：——?!

Han Zhang: ...?!

喋喋不休的小生物被罩进了外套底下，连带着盖住了它细碎的说话声。

The chatty salamander is tucked under Name Day's coat, its muttering smothered along with it.

命名日：安静。

Name Day: Quiet.

含章鼎：真稀奇，这地方也能碰到土匪打劫……

Han Zhang: Bandits—in the Arctic Circle? That's new.

附近的雪堆恰好能充当掩体，将基金会职员的身影挡得严严实实。

Nearby snowbanks serve perfectly as cover, shielding Name Day from view.

投机者 I：怎么没见着人？刚还瞅见那小子往这走。

Robber I: Where is he? I saw someone coming this way.

投机者 II：再往前他进不去，那是个什么军事基地吧，总有带枪的守着。

Robber II: We can't let him get any further. There's some kind of military base up ahead. And it's heavily guarded.

投机者 II：费了老大劲跟这段路，别啥也没捞到！我看那个神秘学道具还值点钱。

Robber II: Think how far we've gone. We can't go home empty-handed. That arcane item they've got is probably worth a few Sharpodonties, don't you think?

含章鼎：**的[友善的东方粗口]，我是活的！我活得好好的——

Han Zhang: &%#*! (curses from the east) "Item." Hey! I'm a living, breathing creature!

命名日：别和我说。对他们喊这句话，让他们听清楚。

Name Day: You don't need to yell at me. Say it to them if you like!

太沉重的雪压断了树枝，他从地面找到正好合手的一段枝条。

A branch heavy with snow snaps and is broken into a stick that fits his grip comfortably.

含章鼎：喂！你确定?！我要大声喊他们过来吗?！我得说什么?！

Han Zhang: What? Are you sure? Never mind. What should I yell?

命名日：随便什么，能吸引他们的注意就行。

Name Day: Anything. I just need you to draw their attention.

命名日： 我不能让他们一直跟到普列谢茨克附近去。
Name Day: I'm not letting them anywhere near Plesetsk.

投机者 I： 往这走！这边有动静，快点！
Robber I: This way! I hear something. Keep up!

雪堆上突兀地闪出一点深色，模样古怪的金属器皿吸引了所有视线。
A dark shape juts out of the snow—the odd appearance of the strange metal vessel draws every eye.

含章鼎： 呃——打劫！！留下买路财！！
Han Zhang: Errrr. Ro-Ro-Robbery! Hands up, and give me all your cash!

刀锋适时地抵住了那只向金属器皿伸出的手。
Name Day's blade lands right in time, stopping the hand reaching for the vessel.

命名日： *Cа́бля。
Name Day: *Čабля.

你听说了么?
Have You Heard? 小径

你听说了么?
Have You Heard?

简中
“那小子好像失踪了，你有他的去向么?”
“谁?”
“那个话很多的，喜欢罗马传说的那个。”
“你在描述你自己么?”
“命名日，我在说命名日。”
“你比我和他走得更近，为什么要来问我?”
“我只是和他聊过一些罗马传说。”
“我和他的交流也仅限于日耳曼民俗，他总是保持着最佳的社交距离。”
“胡扯，他最讨厌日耳曼人了。”
“不用把你自己的标准强加在所有人身上，他很喜欢日耳曼人，我们聊了很多。”
两名基金会员工在食堂互相瞪视，即将为一个自以为了解的人大打出手，直到第三人坐在二者中间。
“你们在说命名日么？他请了两个月的假期，我想是度假去了。”
“这工作狂居然度假去了，我还以为他的生活除了收集些小玩意就是工作。”
“他去哪度假了?”
“不知道，我们只是一起执行了一次任务的关系，但他人还不错。”
“他有没有和你聊过别的?”
“我们聊过一些民俗传说。”
“罗马?”
“日耳曼?”
“哥特人。”

English
"That kid seems to have disappeared. You know where he went?"

"Who?"

"The talkative one. Obsessed with Roman myths."

"Are you describing yourself?"

"Name Day. I'm talking about Name Day."

"You were closer to him than I was. Why ask me?"

"The only thing I ever talked with him about was those myths."

"Huh, our conversations were usually limited to German folklore. He seems to always keep people at a distance."

"Nonsense. He hated German mythology."

"Stop projecting. As far as we talked it seemed like he loved German culture. We talked about it all the time."

Two Foundation staff glare at each other in the cafeteria, on the verge of fighting over a man they thought they knew, until a third person sits down between them.

"You're talking about Name Day? He took two months off. I think he's on vacation."

"That workaholic actually went on vacation? I thought his life was nothing but work and collecting trinkets."

"Where'd he go?"

"No idea. We only worked together on one mission, but he was a decent guy."

"Did he ever chat with you about anything else?"

"We talked about folk legends."

"Roman?"

"German?"

"Gothic."

比旅程更险恶的 · 2/2

What's Worse than the Journey · 2/2 CO-06

基金会职员随手丢开了那段树枝，从地上抓起一把雪。
Name Day tosses aside his stick and scoops up a handful of snow.

歪歪斜斜的脚印逃往远处，这些投机者仅剩的优点就是懂得放弃。
The robbers' footprints trail away into the distance. If they had one redeeming trait, it was knowing when to cut their losses.

含章鼎： 你手上不是本来就有刀吗！
Han Zhang: What were you waiting for with that knife?

命名日： 噢，那是收藏品，不是武器。
Name Day: Oh, well, it's more of a collectible than a weapon.

命名日： 现在你明白为什么需要找人亲自送货，而不是把你丢上哪趟车捎过来了？
Name Day: But I guess you understand now why they sent me to escort you instead of hiding you in the back of some truck, huh?

含章鼎： 也没见到有车往这种地方跑……刚刚你用了神秘术？为什么不直接变把枪？
Han Zhang: I didn't see a single truck heading for Plesetsk on our whole journey here. By the way, was that knife thingy part of your arcane skill? Why don't you just make a gun instead?

含章鼎： 那些铁块已经过时了，小子，科技发展了——现在是热兵器的时代！
Han Zhang: Times have changed, friend. Blades are out of date. You should give yourself an upgrade and start blasting!

命名日： 变不了，有这种水平，我现在就会在芝诺。
Name Day: Nah. I'd probably be serving with Zeno if I was any good with guns.

命名日： 听过芝诺那位传奇飞行员的新鲜事迹吗？“巴伦支海手术刀”。
Name Day: Have you ever heard of that legendary pilot from Zeno, the Barents Witch?

命名日： 很遗憾，这么酷的家伙不会来护送一只聒噪的蝾螈。而我最多变点手边的垃圾，来点废物利用。
Name Day: If you were really important, then you would get a guard like that. All that being a noisy little salamander gets you is a guy that can turn trash into knives.

含章鼎： ……这简直是我见识过最没用的神秘术。
Han Zhang: Ah! That's nearly the most useless arcane skill I've ever heard of.

含章鼎： 除了我自己的神秘术以外。好吧，我们扯平了。
Han Zhang: I say "nearly" because it's still better than mine. So, I'm not in a position to criticize.

命名日： 你的神秘术是什么？
Name Day: What does your arcane skill do?

小蝾螈的轮廓晃了晃，骤然消散成一捧香灰，又迅速地凝聚回原貌。
The salamander's silhouette flickers, crumbling into a puff of ash, then, in the blink of an eye, reforms itself.

含章鼎： ……像这样？
Han Zhang: That's it.

命名日： ……很有特色。
Name Day: It's certainly ... something.

接下来的路程终于迎得了暂时的安静。
The rest of the journey is at last blessedly quiet.

目的地越来越近，建筑物的轮廓逐渐清晰，有人已经提前在雪地里等候。
Their destination draws near. The outlines of buildings take shape, and someone is already waiting in the snow.

命名日： 北方哨歌女士。
Name Day: Ms. Windsong.

所谓的航天基地也并没有想象中那样高大。
The so-called cosmodrome isn't nearly as grand as imagined.

在这样辽阔的土地上，任何生物和建筑都显得相当渺小。
Surrounded by the vast expanse of white, people and buildings alike feel small.

北方哨歌： 你们好，两位先生。
Windsong: Hello, gentlemen.

北方哨歌： 欢迎来到普列谢茨克。
Windsong: Welcome to Plesetsk.

园圃与花园
The Wilds and the Garden CO-07

北方哨歌：你们到得比预计时间更快，我想指针和冷周六会相当开心。
Windsong: You arrived earlier than expected. Pointer and Hissabeth will be happy to know you got here safely.

北方哨歌：噢，指针就是那位介绍我去拉普拉斯的职员，你应该见过她……在来亚什基。她正在帮忙招待几位重要的访客，晚些我们再去找她。
Windsong: Oh, FYI, Pointer was the researcher who introduced me to Laplace. You might have met her before in Rayashki. She's occupied with a few important visitors right now. We'll talk to her later.

北方哨歌：至于冷周六，我觉得亲自见个面会比我来做介绍更快。
Windsong: As for Hissabeth, you can meet her in person and save me the trouble of an introduction.

她推开了眼前的房门。
She pushes open the door.

与此同时，在大楼另一侧，指针也推开了办公室的门。
Meanwhile, on the other side of the building, Pointer enters through another door.

指针：离约定时间还有一个多钟头，你们来得这么早？
Pointer: Our appointment was set for an hour from now. You're a bit early, sir.

指针往旁边让开身子，示意身后的两个人先进门。她打量着那个沉默的小姑娘，没有从对方身上看出什么特别之处。
Pointer steps aside, motioning for the people hurrying behind her to go in first. She studies the quiet girl, not finding anything particularly unusual.

科兹洛夫：马戏团今天不算忙——重要的事总是早做准备才好。您放心，我们也没等多久……
Mr. Kozlov: There wasn't much work to do today. And Alia always has everything prepared ahead of anything important. I-It's nothing to worry about.

指针：坐吧，挑哪把椅子都行。北方哨歌和冷周六应该会准时过来。
Pointer: Please take a seat. Windsong and Hissabeth will join us later.

指针：有什么问题都可以先和我聊聊。
Pointer: If you have any questions, feel free to ask me.

库珀花环：麻烦您了。您可以称呼我库珀花环，我想向您询问一件事。
Kiperina: Thank you, ma'am. Please call me Kiperina. I have something to ask you.

先开口的竟然是这个小姑娘，这让指针略微感到意外。她调整了自己的表情，带上少量柔和的笑意。
Kiperina is the first to speak, surprising Pointer. She adjusts her expression, adding a hint of warmth to her smile.

指针：叫我指针就行。请说吧。
Pointer: That's fine with me, Ms. Kiperina. My name is Pointer. So, what would you like to know?

库珀花环：如果我愿意参加训练，接受成为宇航员的邀请，我会得到相应的……无论是卢布还是别的任何东西吗？
Kiperina: If I take the offer and complete all the required training, what will I get in return? Do you pay in ruble or something equivalent?

库珀花环：我还想确认，假如发生任何意外，是否可以确保这些东西能送到我的家人手上？
Kiperina: And I'd also like to know if my family will receive my pay in case anything happens to me.

指针抬头重新端详着眼前的人。她读得出科兹洛夫脸上的担忧，但没有立刻为库珀花环的神色找到合适的分类。
Pointer looks up and examines the girl once more. She can read the worry in Mr. Kozlov's face, but she still can't quite place the look on hers.

介于勇气和恐惧之间。这样的划分对指针而言太过精微。
Somewhere between courage and fear. Too fine a line for Pointer to draw.

植物与机器平分了不多的空间，室内比开着暖气的走廊温度更高。
Plants and machines crowd the limited space, struggling for a balance somewhere between jungle and office floor. It's warmer here than in the hallway outside.

年轻人往旁边瞧了一眼，北方哨歌没有要开口的意思。
Name Day glances sideways, but Windsong has no intention of speaking.

命名日：……打扰了，有人在吗?
Name Day: Hello? Is anyone there?

命名日：从基金会远东分部调用的材料已经安全送到。
Name Day: The materials you sent from the Far East Branch have arrived safely.

命名日：请及时检查，清单上的所有东西都在这儿了。
Name Day: Everything you asked for on your list is there. But you should check it over as soon as possible.

他在桌面上找到一块空隙，从口袋里捞出那个金属物件。
He scrounges around for a clear spot on the desk and pulls a metal vessel from his pocket,

小蝾螈团在里头睡得正香，直到有人戳了戳它的脑袋，抖落一捧灰尘。
revealing a little sleeping salamander roused from its slumber by a tap on the head that sends a puff of ash into the air.

命名日：醒醒，现在是工作时间。
Name Day: Hey. Wake up. You're at work.

研究员从众多机器后闪出身影，首先和北方哨歌打了个招呼。
Hissabeth emerges from behind the machinery and offers a brisk wave to Windsong.

冷周六：嗯？你今天这么早就从矿坑回来，是打算给远道而来的同事办个欢迎会?
Hissabeth: Windsong? Back from the mine already? Are you going to throw a welcome party for our new colleagues?

北方哨歌：矿坑的调查可以先放一放，事情还是有重要与次要之分。
Windsong: The mine can wait, but I can't. Those materials are top priority.

接着，研究员的目光转向眼前的年轻人。
Now Hissabeth turns her attention to the young man in front of her.

冷周六：多谢，应该有人跟你提过，我是冷周六。
Hissabeth: Thanks. You might have heard of me. My name's Hissabeth.

冷周六：我们的计划书你应该也读过？我就不多废话了。指针还在忙，待会儿你会见到她的。
Hissabeth: You've read our proposal, haven't you? It'd save me a lot of trouble if you had. I'll catch you up with Pointer as soon as she's available.

基金会职员盯着那几条探头探脑的小蛇，发誓自己看见其中一条在吐信子。
Name Day finds himself staring at the curious little snakes poking out, swearing he saw one flick its tongue.

他没法犹豫太久，还是选择了按社交礼节走完整套流程，握手，然后自我介绍。
There's no time to hesitate. He decides to follow proper etiquette—handshake, then introduction.

命名日：命名日，远东分部调查员。
Name Day: Name Day, Foundation Investigator for the Far East Branch.

命名日：我能不能先提个问题?
Name Day: Mind if I ask you a question?

冷周六：请讲，我们提倡自由发言，这又不是审讯现场。
Hissabeth: Go on. But this is an office, not an interrogation room.

她轻松地四处打量着，瞧见桌面多出的摆件，也轻轻敲了敲小蝾螈的脑袋。
She looks around with an airy glance and, spotting the extra object on the desk, gives the little salamander a second gentle rap on the head.

命名日：——为什么要偷运卢恩矿石?
Name Day: Why did you ask me to smuggle in this runium?

冷周六：哈?
Hissabeth: What?

命名日：我没有别的意思，这么点数量……大概两三块？其实不算严重。
Name Day: Don't get me wrong. I didn't report it. It's just ... it's odd. You didn't ask for much, just a few pieces.

命名日：虽然它现在不属于能随意取用的资源，但正常提交申请书也就是流程长一些……
Name Day: It is a rare resource, I grant you. But I think you could've gotten this amount with no trouble by submitting an application. All you'd need to do is wait for a few weeks.

命名日：有必要为几块矿石冒风险吗?
Name Day: Was it really worth the risk?

冷周六：当然有。因为我们没有多余的时间用来等待。
Hissabeth: Yeah, because we don't have a few weeks to spare.

北方哨歌：“时间”现在就像这些从远方送来的向日葵种子一样宝贵。
Windsong: Saving every bit of time we can is vital. It is as precious as this bag of sunflower seeds from a distant land. You don't find them often in these parts.

北方哨歌：接着。
Windsong: Here.

理线学者扬起手，将小布袋抛向研究员。
She lifts her hand and tosses Hissabeth a small cloth bag.

北方哨歌：我的那份已经拿走了，你也可以在办公室里种一些。
Windsong: I've already taken my share. Why not plant some of these in the office?

北方哨歌：向日葵很容易养活，它们或许会追着白炽灯太阳移动脑袋呢。
Windsong: It won't take too much effort. If you're lucky, you'll get to see them turn their heads towards the light bulbs.

研究员从袋子里取出她真正想要的东西。
Hissabeth pulls out exactly what she was hoping for.

稀有的神秘学能源被随手抛起，又稳当地接住。
Rare arcanum energy, tossed carelessly into the air but caught with practiced ease.

冷周六：要找到一个见过卢恩矿石，能顺理成章送它们过来，还会同意这件事的家伙，还挺不容易的。
Hissabeth: Actually, Mr. Name Day, you're the perfect man for this job. You knew what you were smuggling, you had the perfect excuse to come here, and you were kind enough to help. It was quite the effort to track you down, you know.

冷周六：路上有没有碰见麻烦?
Hissabeth: So, how did the trip go? Any trouble?

命名日：说不准他们是看中了矿石还是那只聒噪的“工艺品”。
Name Day: You bet there was. Though I'm still not sure what those bandits were after, the runium or our noisy "arcane item."

冷周六：到处都缺资源，就得从市面上、从外边尽可能地收集，不管用不用得上……
Hissabeth: There's a shortage of supplies everywhere nowadays. People take what they can, whether they need it or not.

冷周六：就算让那些人得手了，东西最后大概率还是会流回基金会或者拉普拉斯吧。
Hissabeth: Even if they managed to take the cargo, it'd probably just end up in another branch of the Foundation or Laplace.

冷周六：你这趟外勤可是帮忙省了一大笔采购经费。
Hissabeth: Anyway, you saved us a lot of time and resources.

命名日：有的东西花再多经费也买不到。还没听说哪儿发现了能替代来亚什基的矿场。
Name Day: Just bear in mind, this runium is not something that you can replace even with Sharpodonties.

冷周六：我会省着用。替我谢谢维拉女士。
Hissabeth: Thanks. We'll use it sparingly. Please send my gratitude to Ms. Vila.

冷周六：第二件事，轮到我提问了。
Hissabeth: And one more thing.

冷周六：你打算留下帮忙吗?
Hissabeth: What would you say if I asked you to stay?

冷周六：请你偷运矿石用的是北方哨歌的关系，现在是我的个人请求。
Hissabeth: Don't worry. I won't play the Windsong card. It's only a personal request.

冷周六：如果有基金会的人参与，很多需要走流程的事儿都会方便些。
Hissabeth: We could save a lot of time with our procedural work if we had a Foundation Investigator on the team.

冷周六：对你而言，这也是一个很好的机会——如果我们的小队最后取得成功，你的名字当然会被写在表彰名单上。
Hissabeth: And it could be a great opportunity to earn a reputation. Imagine the prestige if the project ends up a success.

命名日：……
Name Day: ...

基金会职员咽下了刚要说出的话。他不打算对自己来这里的理由多做解释。
He swallows his words, not intending to explain his reason for being here.

冷周六给出的理由也不错，方便理解，也不会涉及太多私人信息。
Hissabeth's version works just fine—easy to understand, and not too personal.

命名日：你们现在进度如何?
Name Day: Are you making any progress?

冷周六：如你所见，真是穷得叮当响，最新进账就是这些矿石。
Hissabeth: As much as we can, but we don't have a single Sharpodonty to our name, and this runium is the sum total of all the supplies we've received recently.

冷周六：研究基地余下的大部分资源会留给我们，可那本来就没多少。不过好消息是航天飞船不用自己从头造，燃料也是现成的，启动按钮谁都会按——我们缺人。
Hissabeth: They told us we could use all the resources left in Plesetsk, but that amounts to jack all. Thankfully, we still have half a rocket, fuel, and a launch button. Still, to make up for the supply shortage, we need additional manpower.

冷周六：当然，还有一个能令你安心的好消息。我们已经找到了一名合适的宇航员。
Hissabeth: Oh, but there's some good news: we don't have to worry about finding our astronaut. We already have a perfect candidate.

指针：我们非常需要一位宇航员。
Pointer: We're in dire need of an astronaut.

指针：能够用于训练的时间并不多，绝大多数人选都不可能短期内适应失重环境，更无法承受高温和高压。
Pointer: There isn't enough time for anyone to finish the full training course. No one would be able to acclimate to a zero-gravity environment in such a short time, not to mention the high pressure and heat.

指针：但库珀花环小姐的神秘术或许能帮助她做到这件事。
Pointer: But you may be the exception, Ms. Kiperina. Your arcane skill may allow us to work a miracle.

指针：不仅仅是经济补贴，我们也能为你提供担保，为你争取一张拉普拉斯的正式员工证。
Pointer: So, if you take the offer, we'll provide you with a salary and try to get you a permanent position here at Laplace.

指针：冷周六已经在着手准备这件事，她找了基金会人员来帮忙，好加快审批进度。
Pointer: Hissabeth is already working on it. She has a contact in the Foundation who can help with the procedures.

库珀花环：我没有别的问题了。
Kiperina: Alright then. I have no more questions.

指针注意到，即便听完了这些详尽的解释，女孩脸上的忧虑也没有丝毫减少。
Pointer notes that, despite their thorough explanation, the girl seems no less worried.

库珀花环：但我还是要说明，我并不像你们想的那样厉害，我的神秘术仅仅能用于照明。所以……
Kiperina: But, just to be clear, I don't think my arcane skill is as useful as you believe. It only makes a little firework show.

科兹洛夫：您知道，这个年纪的孩子都很容易害羞——您这样夸奖她，阿涅娅肯定不好意思。她是愿意尝试的，让她先参加训练，您就知道她很可靠！
Mr. Kozlov: Heh, she's being modest. You know how children are when they receive a compliment, but I tell you she is more than willing to take your offer. Please give her an opportunity. You'll see how reliable she is!

科兹洛夫：对了，我们马戏团里还有个新来的小姑娘，她或许也能试试……
Mr. Kozlov: By the way, another little arcanist girl joined our circus recently. Do you think she could stay with you too?

指针：并不是每个人的神秘术都合适。
Pointer: That's not really how this works. Not everyone's arcane skill works in the same manner.

科兹洛夫：她也能和阿涅娅做个伴儿，您想想，她再怎么说也还是玩洋娃娃的年纪——
Mr. Kozlov: But she would keep Alia company. Please, madam, Alia is still just a child who plays with dolls.

库珀花环：我很早就不这么做了，科兹洛夫先生！
Kiperina: Mr. Kozlov, stop! I haven't played with dolls in ages!

库珀花环：……我已经是个大人了。
Kiperina: I ... I'm already grown up!

指针：……
Pointer: ...

看见进门以来就不动声色的女孩终于有了些外露的情绪，指针觉得自己终于触摸到了问题的核心。
Seeing emotion break through the girl's steady silence at last, Pointer feels she's reached the root of the issue.

指针：我们可以考虑。您方便把提到的人选带来吗?
Pointer: We'll take a look at what she can do. Would you be able to bring her here now?

科兹洛夫：当然方便！我现在就去。
Mr. Kozlov: Of ... of course. I'll be right back.

他跑出办公室的速度相当快。库珀花环犹豫着在椅子上调整姿势，坐得更加端正。
He bolts up and out of the office. In his wake, Kiperina hesitates, shifting in her seat, until at last sitting up straighter.

指针也收起了笑容。她觉得接下来的对话中并不需要这种社交技巧。
Pointer's smile fades. There's no need for social niceties in what comes next.

指针：——现在，你可以说出你的真实想法了。
Pointer: Alright, we're finally alone. Now, how about you tell me what you're actually thinking?

冷周六：最大的技术难题尚未解决，不过我有九成把握。
Hissabeth: Our biggest issue remains unsolved, but I'm most certain we can resolve it.

冷周六：情况好坏参半——整体向好。
Hissabeth: The entire project is a mixed bag right now, but I'd say more good than bad.

冷周六：假设这位睡着的朋友能按照预想提供帮助，情况就会继续往“好”倾斜。
Hissabeth: If our little sleepyhead in that pod there can provide what we need, our situation should improve dramatically.

她摇晃那枚四足小鼎，让小蝾螈体会了一把失重的感觉。
She tips the little vessel, giving the salamander a brief experience of zero gravity.

含章鼎：我……我梦到自己在月球……砍树……
Han Zhang: I was dreaming of cutting a tree on the moon.

含章鼎：有什么一定要我参与的活儿吗？如果没事，请你们就把我当做普通摆件，我需要死一样的睡眠！
Han Zhang: *yawn* You'd better have a good reason to wake me up. I'm not your lackey. We made a deal, that's all. And I'm freaking tired after that trip!

冷周六：按我们约好的，我需要你为我的材料研究帮点小忙。
Hissabeth: Yeah, and about that deal? I need something from you, now.

冷周六：绝缘，耐高温，具有良好的神秘术耐受。你这间金属屋子的材质可真不错。
Hissabeth: This little pod of yours. It's electrically insulated, heat-resistant, and highly durable against arcane energy. In short: the perfect aerospace material.

冷周六：我刮些粉末做成分分析。很快，就像你看了次牙医……
Hissabeth: All I need is to sand off a bit of material from it. Don't worry. Just think of it as dental work.

含章鼎： 等等！等等！我们应该一手交钱一手交货！
Han Zhang: Wait, wait. You haven't paid for that yet.

含章鼎： 你不会忘了条件吧?
Han Zhang: A deal is a deal.

研究员确实需要一点时间回忆，好在她最后找到了答案。
She needs a moment to think but eventually lands on a solution.

指甲盖大小的工牌被挂在了小蝾螈的尾巴上。
She hooks a tiny badge the size of a fingernail onto the salamander's tail.

冷周六： 你的员工证。先告诉你，这是实习证件，请好好表现。
Hissabeth: Here's your ID card. Just to be clear, this is only for an internship. You'll need to actually work to earn yourself a permanent one.

冷周六： 这可是用我的正式员工身份做担保才要来的。
Hissabeth: And don't do anything stupid. I vouched for you, and now both our necks are on the line.

含章鼎： 我看它很适合我！我早就说我瞅着该在拉普拉斯就职，东方分部的工程类竞争太强了……
Han Zhang: Oh, it does look good on me. I knew I belong with Laplace. *sigh* The engineers at the Foundation's East Branch are way too competitive for my liking.

含章鼎： 你还想知道什么吗？我这里也有一些试图用火药飞天的记载，或者炼丹……这个比较难。
Han Zhang: So, what else you need? I've brought some records about gunpowder-fueled flight, and a few books on Eastern alchemy. Though, I'm not sure you'd be able to read any of them.

在小蝾螈喋喋不休时，研究员已经把它翻来覆去瞧了个遍，最后指向容器底部四四方方的文字。
As the little salamander chatters on, she flips over its vessel and inspects it thoroughly before pointing to the square markings on the vessel's base.

理线学者和基金会职员都围了过来，人们总是难以抗拒自己的好奇心。
The others gather close, unable to resist their curiosity.

冷周六： 我想知道这行字的意思。
Hissabeth: What does this mean?

含章鼎： 这个？我现在住的鼎来自潘家园，说真的，工艺不错。
Han Zhang: Oh, that? You know, I got this pod from the Panjiayuan Antique Market. It's not a genuine antique, but the craftsmanship is quite excellent.

含章鼎： 这行字是“微波炉可用”。那时候微波炉是稀罕物件！
Han Zhang: These characters here mean "microwave safe." Funny enough, microwave ovens were not that popular when I got it.

含章鼎： 说到潘家园，这么大这么有意思的旧货市场很难得，买什么古董啦收藏品啦，就适合往里头钻。
Han Zhang: Speaking of Panjiayuan, you can't find a flea market as big or as fun anywhere else. If you're ever looking for antiques and collectibles, it should be your first stop.

含章鼎： 如果你们真心想看看，我也不是不能找机会带你们去……
Han Zhang: Humph, if you want to go take a look, I might just be nice for once and take you ...

小蝾螈察觉到了理线学者和基金会职员闪闪发亮的视线。
Little salamander notices their eager eyes.

终于有机会发挥商人的好口才，它打算进一步抓住这个时机——
At last, a chance to show off its salesman charm—a moment it's determined to seize.

冷周六：不是什么“禁止触碰，否则爆炸”就行，我吃过那些莫名其妙的神秘学发明的亏。
Hissabeth: No, thanks. Just making sure it doesn't mean "danger, explosive." I already learned that lesson from another escapade with an arcane invention.

她把不知道何时借走的匕首还给基金会职员，又将那个装满金属粉末的小瓶塞进办公桌抽屉。
She returns the dagger she'd borrowed—who knows when—and slips the vial of metal powder into her desk drawer.

冷周六：好了，我弄到需要的粉末了，很快吧？你光顾着说话，应该压根没感觉。
Hissabeth: Alright. I've collected enough. You were so busy talking you didn't feel a thing, did you?

冷周六：然后——这位远道而来的灰白格子，你呢？考虑好了吗？
Hissabeth: Now, back to our visitor in the checkered pattern uniform, have you made a decision?

短暂的沉默之后，命名日问出口的却是另一个问题。
After a brief pause, the question Name Day asks switches the conversation to an entirely different track.

命名日：在计划结束之后，你们打算拿那位小宇航员怎么办？
Name Day: What are you going to do with the little astronaut when the project's over?

冷周六：只要她同意加入计划，我立刻就会给她提交入职拉普拉斯的申请。你愿意为此添份力就更好。
Hissabeth: I'll submit her application to Laplace once she agrees to join us. It'd be great if you could help with her employment procedures.

命名日：我指的是，她什么时候才会知道“暴雨”会造成怎样的后果。
Name Day: I mean, when are you going to tell her the real consequences of the "Storm"?

冷周六：在她拿到正式员工证的时候。
Hissabeth: Same as always, as soon as she gets a permanent position with Laplace.

命名日看向北方哨歌，他以为北方哨歌会加入这场对话，至少做几句解释。但她只是点了点头。
Name Day glances at Windsong, thinking she might chime in—offer an explanation, at least. But she only nods.

事实如此。那位素未谋面的小宇航员也迟早该知道，灰白穹顶和冰冷的金属建筑无法庇护所有人。
That's just how it is. That little astronaut, whom they've never even met, will have to learn it too: That pale dome and those cold steel buildings can't protect everyone.

雨水会将熟悉的事物冲刷殆尽。一次，再一次。
Soon, the rain will wash away all that's familiar to them. Again, and again.

命名日：……
Name Day: ...

命名日：我留下。
Name Day: Alright, then I'll stay.

指针：你想留在马戏团？
Pointer: You mean you really want to stay with the circus?

库珀花环没有直接给出答案。
Kiperina doesn't have a straight answer.

库珀花环：我……我可以来帮忙，但能不能拿到拉普拉斯的员工证，对我来说不重要。
Kiperina: I ... I meant that I'm willing to do whatever you need, but I don't think I want to do this permanently.

库珀花环：如果大家都说我的神秘术能起作用，你们需要我加入，我就答应——我自己也不清楚，我能做到哪些事，在哪些地方派上用场。
Kiperina: Since you say that you need my arcane skill for this project, I'm happy to help, though I don't really know if I can.

指针：我觉得你其实很清楚团长为什么要做这个选择。
Pointer: I think you know why Mr. Kozlov brought you all this way.

指针：你们多久没吃上肉了？
Pointer: When was the last time you had a proper meal?

库珀花环：我们有炖菜吃，团长也会想办法弄到罐头。
Kiperina: Well, we usually have stews, and sometimes Mr. Kozlov will find us some canned food if we're lucky.

她的反驳声音很小，因此越发缺少说服力。
Her rebuttal is soft and utterly unconvincing.

指针：你准备在马戏团待一辈子吗？
Pointer: And you still want to spend the rest of your life in that circus?

库珀花环：……
Kiperina: ...

敲门声撞破了这阵沉默。库珀花环趁这个时候仰起头。
A knock breaks the silence. Kiperina uses the moment to lift her head.

当她再次坐好，刚刚在她眼睛里闪烁的光点已经被抹得很干净了。
By the time she sits back down again, the light that had flickered in her eyes is gone.

科兹洛夫：我们的另一个小姑娘在这里，她不怎么喜欢说话，但性格很好。
Mr. Kozlov: This is her, the girl I talked about. She doesn't speak much, but I feel that she has a good character.

远旅：……
Voyager: ...

女孩儿好奇的目光扫过每个人，在指针那儿顿了顿。
The girl casts a sweeping look across the room, pausing briefly on Pointer.

科兹洛夫：去吧，坐到阿涅娅旁边。
Mr. Kozlov: Don't be shy. You can sit next to Alia.

科兹洛夫：你们刚才聊了些啥？阿涅娅没给您添麻烦吧，女士？
Mr. Kozlov: What were you talking about? I hope our Alia didn't cause any trouble, madam.

他往房间里踏出两步，才发觉库珀花环的注意力在他手中提着的包裹上。
那里边是他和娜塔莉亚收拾好的、认为两个女孩儿会需要的东西。
He steps into the room, noticing immediately that Kiperina is fixated on the parcel in his hands. It's filled with things he and Natalya packed—things they thought the girls might need.

库珀花环：科兹洛夫先生……
Kiperina: Mr. Kozlov ...

库珀花环：……我还会回到乌特恩亚亚吗？
Kiperina: Will I ever have the chance to return to Utrennyaya?

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库珀花环：……我还会回到乌特恩亚亚吗?
Kiperina: Will I ever have the chance to return to Utrennyaya?

冷周六带着其他人推门进入办公室时正遇到这一幕。她饶有兴趣地站在一旁，见证女孩得到她的回答。
Hissabeth pushes the door open just in time to catch this scene. She lingers nearby, curious, watching the girl receive her answer.

科兹洛夫：那会是未来的事。
Mr. Kozlov: We can talk about that in the future.

科兹洛夫：我们还会保持联系，你可以和远旅一起回来看望马戏团的大家。
Mr. Kozlov: Of course, we will keep in touch. You and Voyager can pay us a visit whenever you like.

科兹洛夫：……她吃得不多，也是个聪明的孩子，不吵闹。她能留下，对吧?
Mr. Kozlov: The girl's called Voyager, madam. She's clever, quiet, doesn't eat much. You-You will take her in too, won't you?

指针对此没有意见。她简单地进行了一些分析，认为同龄人的陪伴的确有助于缓解库珀花环的训练压力。
Pointer doesn't object. She runs a brief analysis and concludes that the company of a peer could help ease the pressures of Kiperina's training.

仔细听完指针的说明后，科兹洛夫最后拍了拍花环的肩膀。
After listening carefully, Mr. Kozlov pats Kiperina's shoulder.

科兹洛夫：努力让自己过上不用东奔西跑的日子，好吗，阿涅娅?
Mr. Kozlov: I always hoped you would settle down and live a comfortable life. Promise me, you'll do your best, Alia.

库珀花环：……好的，团长。
Kiperina: Yes, Mr. Kozlov.

冷周六：噢，你们终于商量完了。看起来不太需要我再做解释。
Hissabeth: Oh, you've finally reached an agreement. Cool, looks like I won't have to do any more explaining.

冷周六：如果现在是告别时间，我觉得你得给这位看上去很不开心的小家伙留点什么纪念品。
Hissabeth: If you're saying goodbye soon, maybe you ought to consider bringing her a parting gift. She looks like she could use one.

命名日：没错，到时候她能带着这份纪念品去找您。
Name Day: Yeah, something to remind her of home.

懂得观察气氛的基金会职员飞快地接上这句话。
Name Day picks up the thread without missing a beat.

北方哨歌也在此刻适时地迈出脚步，站到库珀花环身边。于是冷周六没再开口。
Windsong steps forward just in time, joining Kiperina's side, and Hissabeth trails off.

北方哨歌：不需要什么贵重的礼物，但你至少得鼓励她几句，是不是?
Windsong: Or maybe you can offer a few words of encouragement? What do you say?

科兹洛夫看到库珀花环用小指轻轻摩挲着手中的仪器，那是北方哨歌之前借给她的。这个小动作说明库珀花环感到紧张。
Mr. Kozlov spies Kiperina rubbing the device in her hands with her pinky—the one Windsong had lent her earlier. He knows her well enough to understand the meaning: nervous.

他不清楚仪器的具体价值，但马戏团里肯定无法轻易找到这样的东西。
He has no idea about the device's exact value, but he's certain it's not something you'd easily find in a circus.

科兹洛夫：哈哈，礼物嘛……得给我留点时间做准备。
Mr. Kozlov: Right, right, a gift. I-I'll need some time to prepare it.

科兹洛夫：不如这样，我们做个约定——等你未来回马戏团看望大伙儿，再来取这份礼物。
Mr. Kozlov: Let's make a deal, shall we? You'll get your gift next time you pay a visit to the Utrennyaya.

科兹洛夫：这么一来你肯定也会记得回家。我还怕你到时候嫌麻烦，不肯跑太远。
Mr. Kozlov: That way, you'll keep us in mind and come home again one day. I was worried you might not want to travel such a long way for us.

库珀花环：不，即使乌特恩亚亚去了最远最远的北方，我也会来找你们。
Kiperina: I will, Mr. Kozlov. I'll find my way back to Utrennyaya even if you've moved to the other end of the world.

她费力地拎起科兹洛夫带来的包裹，基金会职员赶紧接过它，把它放到了一旁的桌上。
She struggles to lift the parcel Mr. Kozlov gave her. Name Day quickly steps in to assist her in placing it on the table.

时间过得真快。
科兹洛夫的脑海里突然冒出这句感叹，但他说出的内容与此毫不相关。
"Time flies." The thought pops into Mr. Kozlov's head, but what he says out loud has nothing to do with it.

科兹洛夫：好，好。阿涅娅是个好孩子——
Mr. Kozlov: Hahaha, that's my girl.

科兹洛夫：记不记得那句话？“做好你能做的每件事，就能摆脱遗憾。”
Mr. Kozlov: Remember what I said? Do the best that you can and have no regrets.

科兹洛夫：你能让我和娜塔莉亚放心，对吧？
Mr. Kozlov: Natalya and I don't have to worry about you, do we?

库珀花环：嗯，我可以。
Kiperina: No.

库珀花环：我一定会尽全力的，就像在乌特恩亚亚一样。
Kiperina: I'll give my best performance here, like I always did with Utrennyaya.

像是为了说服自己，她连着点了两次头，用最严肃、最认真的语气做出许诺。
Almost like she's trying to convince herself, she nods twice in a row and makes a solemn promise in her most serious tone.

未来是否只是个概念？这个问题被刻意地忽视，就像压在旧衣箱底部的秘密。
A question rises up in her, just below the surface. How can she be sure? She chooses not to ask.

/lo/ - 哑谜化现象正在扩散
/lo/ - The Spread of Enigmafication 小径

/lo/ - 哑谜化现象正在扩散
/lo/ - The Spread of Enigmafication

简中
0001 匿名 No.95025535 ▶
不过是参与了两年的项目被中止，接下来我就能躲在房间里面玩数独了，真是一点都不伤心呀。

0002 匿名 No.95025586 ▶>>95025620
别高兴得太早，很快你就会失去假期，现在到处急着用人。

0003 匿名 No.95025620 ▶>>95025867
>>95025586
卑微的主攻数论的我又能为“暴雨”下的重建工作出什么力呢？谁也不能阻止我度假了！

0004 匿名 No.95025631 ▶>>95025718
哑谜正在有条不紊地增殖，太好了，很快我就能独占全拉普拉斯的茶水间。

0005 匿名 No.95025718 ▶>>95025961
>>95025631
等到人少了，他们就会减少物资供给，你只能霸占全拉普拉斯的一日之餐。

0006 匿名 No.95025867 ▶
>>95025620
悲观些，也许能战胜“暴雨”的正好是一连串莫名其妙的数学公式呢，然后你就会为了破解那个公式而被抓去二十四小时无间隙工作，每天被露西女士询问三遍研究进度。

0007 匿名 No.95025961 ▶
>>95025718
呕，我不干了。

0008 匿名 No.95026012 ▶
我会把你也加进人道主义关怀机里的。

0009 匿名 No.95026078 ▶>>95026278
好样的，还有倒霉蛋在这种情况下都拿不到假期的么？我开始好奇了。

0010 匿名 No.95026278 ▶>>95026293
>>95026078
有很多，比如医疗组的约翰和机械工程组的约翰以及材料学约翰等等，总之所有非理论技术部门都在露西女士的实用主义下疯狂通宵重建拉普拉斯大厦。

0011 匿名 No.95026293 ▶
>>95026278
这该死的“暴雨”原来是实用技术约翰们设计出来抢经费的阴谋。

English

0001 Anonymous No.95025535 ▸
Just had a two-year project canceled. Soon I too will be able to hide out in my room all day playing Sudoku. Not sad about this at all.

0002 Anonymous No.95025586 ▸ >>95025620
I wouldn't start celebrating just yet. It looks like you're about to lose your vacation time since there's a shortage of staff everywhere.

0003 Anonymous No.95025620 ▸ >>95025867
>>95025586
What are they gonna do? It's not like a simple number theory major like me can contribute to rebuilding in the wake of the "Storm." Nothing's going to stop me from going on vacation, nothing!

0004 Anonymous No.95025631 ▸ >>95025718

Would you look at that? The Enigmafication is spreading nicely. Good. At this rate, I'll have the entire Laplace break room all to myself.

0005 Anonymous No.95025718 ▸ >>95025961
>>95025631
As more people start slacking off, supplies will be cut too. You might get to hog all the Daily Meals from all of Laplace, but that's probably the best you'll do.

0006 Anonymous No.95025867 ▸
>>95025620
You know, it'd be hilarious if a bunch of random numbers and formulas turned out to be the key to defeating the "Storm," and you got roped into nonstop 24/7 work trying to crack it, with Madam Lucy interrogating you three times a day about your progress.

0007 Anonymous No.95025961 ▸
>>95025718
That sounds absolutely disgusting. I need a nap just at the thought of that.

0008 Anonymous No.95026012 ▸
Oh, and as part of the "humanitarian" gesture, I'll make sure your voice gets added to the machine too.

0009 Anonymous No.95026078 ▸ >>95026278
Well isn't that something? There are still poor souls who didn't get a vacation even at a time like this, with all these non-essential projects getting cut?

0010 Anonymous No.95026278 ▸ >>95026293
>>95026078
There's plenty. Like John from the medical team, John from the mechanical engineering group, and John from materials science ... Basically, every non-theoretical department is pulling all-nighters to rebuild Laplace under Madam Lucy's brand of ruthless pragmatism.

0011 Anonymous No.95026293 ▸
>>95026278
It really makes you wonder if the "Storm" was part of a conspiracy by the Johns to steal funding from the rest of the teams and justify their overtime pay. Coincidence? I think not!

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1987 6 月 普列谢茨克发射基地
June 1987, Plesetsk Cosmodrome

指针： 感觉如何？许多人在开始训练的头几个月都会有较为明显的不适感。
Pointer: How do you feel? Intense nausea is common for the first few months of zero-g training.

库珀花环： 呼……我想基本上——没问题——
Kiperina: *pant* I think I'm fine.

库珀花环： 感谢您的关心。
Kiperina: You're very kind to ask, ma'am.

第一次训练结束后，库珀花环吐了出来。
Her first training session was rough and more than a little messy, causing her to throw up.

指针将她扶到医务室，等喘匀了气，她磕绊着说出自己的要求，和现在所说的一样。
Pointer helped her to the infirmary. Once she could breathe again, she stammered out a request—just like the one she made today.

库珀花环： 我们应该增加训练日程。
Kiperina: I'm ready for more.

指针： 我否决过很多次了。冷周六刚刚才看过你最新的体检数据和神秘术测试报告，你不能再给自己增加任何训练，而是要学会休息。
Pointer: You're at this again? Hissabeth already checked your vitals and arcane skill test reports. Her conclusion was clear: You need to rest and recover before we begin again.

指针： 如果你把自己逼到了极限，因此病倒，我们的计划也同样无法完成。
Pointer: If you push yourself too hard and become too sick to perform the mission, that won't help us either.

库珀花环： 我还可以更努力！只要反复练习，我就能做得更好——
Kiperina: But I can do more. All I need is a bit more training. I need to perform flawlessly.

指针： 你不需要做得更好，你只要保证“能够做到”。
Pointer: We don't need "flawless," not at the cost of your health. We need "satisfies all requirements." Nothing more.

指针调整着语气，尽力在脑海里寻找着可以称得上鼓励或安慰的句子。
She adjusts her tone, searching her mind for something that might qualify as comfort or encouragement.

指针： 你已经超出了我原本的期待。
Pointer: You're already doing better than we anticipated.

她担心这句话太过干瘪，但库珀花环认真地摇了摇头。
She fears the words come out too flat, but Kiperina shakes her head sincerely.

库珀花环： 谢谢您。但我还没有背熟操作流程，也还无法熟练运用神秘术。
Kiperina: Thank you. But I still haven't memorized the flight procedures, and I'm still struggling with my arcane skill.

库珀花环： 我会向北方哨歌女士申请增加理线学课程。我想，这应该不属于过度训练的范围了吧？
Kiperina: Maybe I can ask Ms. Windsong to give me another ley lines lesson. That's not "pushing myself," is it?

指针： ……
Pointer: ...

指针： 那么你必须保证每天的八小时睡眠。
Pointer: That's acceptable, but you will ensure you get a minimum of eight hours of sleep every day.

指针妥协了。在这样的年纪，她也有过拧着一股劲，想要拼命做好某件事的时候。
Pointer gives in. She too had once been hell-bent on proving herself.

指针： 还需要保证一日三餐的正常饮食。
Pointer: And promise me you'll eat well and never skip meals.

库珀花环： 当然。我记得冷周六女士说今晚有一场聚餐，所以我打算在回来后再做半小时练习……
Kiperina: Yes, ma'am. Ms. Hissabeth said there would be a team-building dinner tonight. I'll attend it and train for another half an hour after we come back.

指针： 不，我不是这个意思。
Pointer: No. That's not what I meant.

照顾过于懂事的孩子也是一件常常令人不知所措的活计。
There are few tasks more difficult than instructing a child who is too mature for her own good.

指针： 别考虑这些了，快去吧，去换身衣服。我和你一块儿出门。
Pointer: *sigh* Anyway, go change. We'll go together.

米尔内的几家餐馆中，这是生意最好的一家。冷周六在其中做了不少贡献。
Of all the restaurants in Mirny, this one does the best business, thanks in no small part to Hissabeth.

她的确把吃饭看做生命中的重要之事，也真诚地希望让朋友们都尝到这份乐趣。
With all those mouths to feed, food has always been a vital part of her lifestyle, one that she is only too eager to share with her team.

而且这儿有一张足够大的餐桌，小组里的每个人都能在桌旁找到自己的位置。
Plus, the tables here are big enough for everyone in their group to have a seat.

冷周六： 你刚认识我那天是不是就坐这儿?
Hissabeth: We sat here when we first met, non?

库珀花环： 好像是。现在这张桌子甚至有点儿挤……
Kiperina: I think so. This table seems a bit too small now.

北方哨歌： 至少帮忙的人够多，成功的几率也会大很多。
Windsong: Well, there's strength in numbers.

冷周六： 但最关键的还是小宇航员。神秘术练习得怎么样了?
Hissabeth: Yet everything now depends on our brave astronaut. How's your arcane skill training?

库珀花环： 大概还不错。北方哨歌女士是一位很好的老师。
Kiperina: Not bad, I guess. Ms. Windsong is a wise teacher.

北方哨歌： 哈哈，看来我的那位教师朋友也教会了我很多。你会有机会认识她的。
Windsong: Haha, I'm glad I've learned something from my experience with Vila. I hope you'll get to know her one day.

冷周六： 等你从宇宙顺利返回，就有大把时间可以用来认识一群有趣的家伙。
Hissabeth: You'll have plenty of time to make friends once you return from your mission.

库珀花环： 好呀。到时候，我可能得先去见一见马戏团的大家，科兹洛夫先生还等着我去取礼物呢。
Kiperina: Looking forward to it. But first I have to go back to the circus. I think Mr. Kozlov will have my gift prepared by then. I'm sure he will.

库珀花环： ……虽然他这周都没有过来看望我和远旅。
Kiperina: Though, he didn't come to see me and Voyager this week.

命名日： 一边忙着演出，另一边忙着训练，也很难找到共同的空闲。
Name Day: He has a whole circus to run, and you're busy with training. It's hard to find a good time when you're both free.

命名日： 也许那位先生怕你看到他，想起马戏团的生活，想着要快些回去，干脆就不往发射基地跑。
Name Day: Perhaps he didn't want to make you homesick, but I'm sure he misses you a lot.

命名日： 但米尔内离得很近，你可以抽空来镇上，回马戏团，花两三个钟头休息会儿也没什么……
Name Day: Mirny isn't far from here. You should go back and visit sometime. No one will blame you if you take a break for a few hours.

指针： 我可以开车送你。
Pointer: I am able to drive you to town, if you need.

指针： 只要你提前两天左右提交你的日程安排，我很可能也能够腾出空来。
Pointer: Just submit your schedule two days in advance. I will set some time aside for a short trip.

库珀花环：谢谢。我想，我还是要在一切都顺利结束之后回去。
Kiperina: Thank you. But I think it'll have to wait until the project's over.

库珀花环：那应该就是科兹洛夫先生说的“未来”。而且我得给他留出准备礼物的时间。
Kiperina: Mr. Kozlov said I would always be able to visit him in the future. Besides, he needs time to prepare the gift.

并非所有人都对未来感兴趣，至少库珀花环的朋友更关心眼前的物件。
Not everyone is interested in the still distant future. Kiperina's friend, at least, is more focused on what's right in front of her.

她轻轻敲击小鼎的边缘，为它清脆的声响露出微笑。
She taps the edge of the small vessel, smiling at the crisp, metallic sound it makes.

含章鼎：拜托，请别这么做，回声会让我的脑袋发晕……
Han Zhang: Err. Don't do that. The echo from that sound makes me dizzy.

远旅：……？
Voyager: ...?

她缩回手，仔细观察了一阵，发现这只生物并没有任何攻击性行为。
She pulls her hand back and watches until confirming the little creature is friendly.

于是她再次伸出手，试图摸索出与它和睦相处的办法。
Then she reaches out again, trying to figure out how to get along with it.

库珀花环：……远旅？
Kiperina: Voyager?

库珀花环：别走神，他们都要把菜吃光了——
Kiperina: Don't get distracted. They've almost finished the food.

基金会职员默默地给桌上的食物换了个位置，推过两个还满着的碟子。
Name Day swaps the food around the table, pushing two still-full plates to the middle.

冰冷的鳞片也在此刻贴上库珀花环的手腕。
Cold scales press against Kiperina's wrist.

小蛇 I：**你不渴吗？瞧这里，热牛奶和果汁，随你选。**
Snake I: **Feel like a drink? Here, we've got some hot milk or warm apple cider. Pick one.**

它拖着杯子艰难地前行到此，在桌面上留下一道长长的痕迹。
Dragging a cup behind it, the snake leaves splotches of spilled drink all across the table.

库珀花环：我要这个，谢谢你。
Kiperina: Milk will be fine. Thank you.

库珀花环为自己和远旅选好了热牛奶，学着其他人那样抬起胳膊。
Kiperina passes another cup to Voyager. She mimics the others by lifting the cup, first in both hands and then just one.

冷周六：干杯，朋友们。庆祝我们成功地拉起了一支小队——先别管成不成吧。
Hissabeth: Let's have a toast, friends. To our new team, though no one knows for sure whether our project will succeed or is doomed to fail catastrophically.

冷周六：为我们共同的目标！
Hissabeth: Together, we're working towards the future, cheers!

一个友好的信号，一种象征团结的誓言。
A friendly signal. A quiet promise of unity.

故事或关系转变的标志。从陌生人，变为并不完全陌生的人，直到——
A turning point in any story or relationship, from a stranger to a colleague, and eventually—

Друг/Товарищ.
“朋友/同志”
Друг/Товарищ.
"Friend/Comrade."

众人： 干杯！
All: Cheers!

冷周六： 我们的成功概率还是很大的。虽然没完全恢复到最佳技术水平，但拉普拉斯仍然拥有足够先进的科技，以及最好的科学家。
Hissabeth: Having said that, the odds are in our favor. Even though Laplace is no longer in its prime, it still has the best technology and the finest scientists.

北方哨歌： 噢？你是说“我们”吗？这个小组里当然是“最好的”那群人——我一直认为做研究最重要的就是坚持。
Windsong: The finest scientists? You mean us? I couldn't agree more. I've always believed that perseverance is the most basic fundamental quality that any researcher should possess.

指针： 返回未来是我唯一觉得该坚持的事。
Pointer: Perseverance ... There's only one thing that I think we should persevere with: our efforts to return to the future.

命名日： 原来拉普拉斯的所有人都这么喜欢“怀旧”。
Name Day: Didn't know you Laplace researchers missed the good old days so much.

指针： 不管你怎么摆弄文字……你得承认，那就是个足够好的时候。
Pointer: Laugh if you want, but you can't deny that our era was better than this one.

库珀花环努力捕捉着这些词汇。室内很暖和，长桌边的谈话也很轻松，她压在心底的疑问也终于有了浮出来喘口气的时机。
Kiperina keens her ears in, trying to catch each word. The room is warm, and the conversation at their table easy and relaxed. The question she's been keeping down finally bubbles out of her mouth.

库珀花环： ……未来是什么样的?
Kiperina: What was the future like?

库珀花环： 我读过给临时员工的说明，知道要取到的数据也许能帮助大家找回一些消失的东西，也知道你们见过的“未来”可能并不是最后被找回来的那个。
Kiperina: I've read through the manual for temporary employees. The data we're going to collect may help people get back the things that they lost, right? From the futures that you've been to.

库珀花环： 但我还是想知道，在你们的那个九九年，列宁格勒变成了什么样子？那时候有没有马戏演出?
Kiperina: What's Leningrad like in 1999? Were there any circus shows in your era?

库珀花环： 所有事都变得更好了吗？糖果和其他物资都不再限量供应了吗?
Kiperina: Does that mean everything was better than it is now? I have trouble imagining it. Were there sweets for everyone and stores that never ran out of food?

北方哨歌： ……
Windsong: ...

北方哨歌： 是的。所有事，除了理线学。它还是这么边缘，因为它甚至无法吸引学习者的关心，让她对这门学科的未来没有一点儿展望……
Windsong: Things were much better then, well, except for the study of ley lines. It was still struggling as a scientific pursuit, especially when it came to attracting new students. Though, even now its only student seems to lack much interest in it.

库珀花环： 不，不是这样！抱歉，我光想着生活里的事……
Kiperina: Th-That's not true! Sorry, I'm just having difficulty focusing on it with all the other demands on my time.

命名日： 我想北方哨歌女士只是抛给了问题太多的学生一个小玩笑。
Name Day: It's okay. Ms. Windsong was only making a joke at the expense of her very overworked student.

命名日： 未来的一切都很好，在路边随便哪家店都能买到糖和你想要的几乎任何东西。
Name Day: It's true things were nicer in the future. I do miss the sweets, and that the shops were never empty.

餐桌上的交谈听起来如此令人愉快，所有见证者都向她许诺这是值得的。
Every witness seems to offer her the same promise: it's worth it.

日子应该往前，而不是反复地驻留于过去。
Life should move forward, not stay stuck in the past.

库珀花环： 太好了，我们一定会成功的，为所有人！
Kiperina: Amazing! I'm sure we'll make it back one day!

这次她主动举起了杯子。
This time, she raises her cup first.

致陌生人
To Former Strangers CO-09

1987 普列谢茨克发射基地
暴雨前 3 个月
1987, Plesetsk Cosmodrome
3 months before the "Storm"

三，二，一。咔。
Three, two, one, cut.

录制结束，一切依旧顺利。
And just so we're clear, everything went well as usual.

简单来说，我手上这张卡带承载的东西惊人的沉重。
The video in this disk, to put it simply, is too much for anyone to handle.

猜猜里边是些什么？没关系，选个你能想到最离谱的答案。
Guess what it's used for. Go on. Give me the most ridiculous answer you can think of.

用上现代化思维……是的，一切都在发展，
有许多内容都能以数据形态保存。
A little tip: think like a modern person. The development of technology allows us to save a lot of things as digital data nowadays.

来份录像作为电子遗书，这可比过去手写的玩意方便多了。
Yes, it's a last record. A video is much more convenient than sitting down with a pen.

她将数据卡放到桌面，伙伴们的目光适时地追了过来。
She places the data card on the table. It immediately draws in all eyes.

冷周六：录像数据没问题。指针，你的那部分需要现在补上吗？还是之后再说？
Hissabeth: Data secured. Pointer, do you want me to add your part to the video now? Or maybe later?

指针：我就不用了。后续的内容都是你那边的活儿，材料相关的东西我帮不上忙。
Pointer: Preferably never. This whole "last record" thing is your passion. Besides, I know nothing about material sciences.

冷周六：但你花了那么多时间帮忙转写术式，当然也得出现在这份记录里！
Hissabeth: But you spent so much time transcoding the incantation. You simply must show up in my video. Please, I insist.

冷周六：我们是一个小组，谁都不该缺席，对吧？
Hissabeth: We're a team. We shouldn't miss anyone's perspective, non?

指针：……嗯。
Pointer: Yes.

长时间工作相当消耗精神，她平静的回应里流露出一些疲倦。
Even for her, long hours can wear things down. There's a trace of fatigue in her otherwise calm reply, a lag in her response.

冷周六：如果大伙儿都没意见，我们就进入复盘时间。虽然我个人更愿意称呼它为公开检讨。
Hissabeth: Superbe, then let's take a look at our work so far and learn from our mistakes, well, my mistakes.

我和指针之前在普列谢茨克发射基地研究关于传送术式的内容。
Pointer and I had been working on the teleport disk at the Plesetsk Cosmodrome.

更具体些来说，阶段性目标是用传送术式向太空站和航天飞船运送物资，最终目的是实现稳定的、安全的、生命体可用的宇宙空间内超长距离远程传送。
More specifically, our interim mission was to determine how to transport supplies to space stations and spacecraft using teleport incantations. The ultimate goal being to achieve stable, safe, and long-distance teleportation to outer space viable for living organisms.

项目稳步推进，直到一个坏消息来临——
The project had been going smoothly until we received some bad news.

由于规划变动，普列谢茨克发射基地的大多数研究项目都要被迫中止。
Due to a policy change at Laplace, most projects in Plesetsk were being suspended.

所幸接下来好消息追上了坏消息。如果接下发射监测器，拿回“暴雨”前宇宙数据的任务——
Fortunately, the bad news was followed by a small amount of good. Madam Lucy said if we could send a monitor to space to collect data when the "Storm" arrived ...

我们的研究就还能继续！甚至有机会为解决“暴雨”的问题出份力！
We'd be allowed to continue with our project! It was a vital opportunity to make our contribution to deciphering the "Storm"!

我们只有几个小麻烦要解决。人手，能源，以及个人决心。
There were only three major issues to solve: manpower, energy supply, and determination.

显然，人手问题和能源问题已经得到了解决。感谢各位的协助。
As you can see, the first two issues have been solved by our new members. Thank you all for your help.

尤其要感谢我们的小宇航员。
Especially our brave little astronaut.

计划很简单。她进入宇宙，到达指定坐标，投放并校准监测器位置，呼叫返航。
The plan is now simple. She'll fly into space, reach the required altitude, launch the monitor, and zero in on the correct coordinates, and then, she'll contact ground control to come home.

她的神秘术将保护她撑过可能会有的窒息或高温。
Her arcane skill will protect her from any possible danger caused by pressure or heat in the vacuum of space.

最后一步，她激活传送软盘，在地面等待的我们也同样激活软盘。
Then finally, she will activate the teleport disk, and we will activate our receiver on the ground.

砰——所有人顺利地回到极圈内的普列谢茨克基地，安全，成功！
Ta-da! Everyone will arrive in Laplace's Arctic Branch safe and sound to acclaim and accolades from all around the scientific world!

当然，以上是理想情况。截止目前，我们还有一箩筐的问题没有解决。
Well, that's a simple framework of the plan. But we still have tons of minor problems to tackle first.

而其中最大的问题，就是传送软盘无法远距离精准定位。
为此我们反复进行了多次测试。
Our top priority is improving the long-distance positioning accuracy of the teleport disk. We've already begun testing our latest prototypes.

……但大家都知道，最后这次测试结果不妙。
Though the last test didn't end well.

目前我还在寻找具体的失败原因。但理论上，这不过是一场在实验中难以避免的小小事故而已……
We're still searching for the cause of that particular catastrophic error. But we won't let it stop us. This was no more than an inevitable roadblock, a small accident on the way to technological progress.

指针：冷周六。既然要吸取失败的教训，就不能逃避问题。
Pointer: Hissabeth, if we are going to have any chance of learning from our mistakes, we can't run away from our problems.

好吧好吧，那是一周前的测试……
Alright, alright. That last test was a week ago.

冷周六：还是老规矩，虽然我们能给软盘做些改良，但免不了需要一个具有足够智慧的生物来执行测试。
Hissabeth: Same as the last time. Though we've made some improvements, we still need an intelligent creature to run the test.

冷周六：这一次也还是我来。
Hissabeth: And I guess it'll be me again.

命名日：你确定吗？我觉得考虑到危险性和对任务的价值，实际上让我……
Name Day: Are you sure? Considering the danger and your value to the project, I think you ought to let me ...

冷周六：我做的东西如果自己都不敢用，怎么还好意思拿给别人尝试?
Hissabeth: How can I ask anyone to try my invention if I wouldn't use it myself?

冷周六：怎么，你在等什么？对了，记得一会儿退到安全区域的时候启动办公室隔离门。
Hissabeth: Now, what are you waiting for? Get to the safe zone. Oh, and remember to secure the blast door.

命名日：昨天库珀花环小姐来喂生态缸里的鱼，询问过这件事。
Name Day: Ms. Kiperina asked about the test yesterday as she was feeding the fish.

命名日：她说已经能基本控制自己的神秘术了，有她帮你做防护，你会更安全。
Name Day: She said she's been able to control her power more now. You'd be much safer with her help.

命名日：同一个队伍里的人应该共同承担风险，不是吗?
Name Day: We're a team, right? We sink or swim together.

时针就在这时候走向了整点，小小的身影也及时地从门口探出头。
As the clock strikes the hour, a small figure peeks in through the door.

库珀花环：我刚结束训练——应该还来得及吧，冷周六女士。
Kiperina: My training just finished. I hope I'm not late, Ms. Hissabeth.

冷周六：虽然最后的确引发了实验事故，但大伙儿没受什么伤，北方哨歌的神秘术教学很有效，库珀花环也是个好学生。
Hissabeth: Well, we did have a pretty bad accident, but thanks to Kiperina's arcane skill, no one was too badly hurt. Windsong is one cool teacher, and that girl's a phenomenal student.

冷周六：定位范围波动太大，这个问题的确有些棘手。在医疗室里躺了几天，我们也吸取了教训……
Hissabeth: The margin of error remained high, a significant problem for sure. But we'd learned our lesson after spending all that time recovering in the ward.

冷周六：万一遇上最糟糕的突发情况，还是应该留下什么东西好让其他人处理……呃……遗留问题。
Hissabeth: That is, that we should prepare for the worst, so that those who survive will know what to do with, umm, our legacy.

冷周六：这就是电子遗书的重要所在。
Hissabeth: Our last record matters, my friend.

小蛇 I：**二号，我觉得指针说的“吸取教训”可能并不是指这件事。**
Snake I: **Two, I don't think that's what Pointer meant when she told us to "learn from our mistakes."**

在冷周六捏住小蛇的嘴巴之前，它就机敏地藏回了头发里。
Before Hissabeth can pinch its mouth shut, the little snake ducks back into her hair.

指针：……
Pointer: ...

指针：我必须再次强调，实验安全比一切都重要。
Pointer: Again, I emphasize that safety must come first in the lab. It is my first and most important protocol.

指针：我和北方哨歌只是回去取资料，你们就被打包送去急救。
Pointer: Windsong and I left for all of ten minutes, and by the time we got back, each and every one of you ended up on death's door!

指针：还有那份延迟撤离的申请书……太荒谬了。
Pointer: And now I find out you've even petitioned for a postponed evacuation. This is getting ridiculous!

冷周六：你清楚我们的时间多紧，“暴雨”应急预案不是已经启动了吗?
Hissabeth: You know how tight the schedule is now that the "Storm" Emergency Plan has been activated, don't you?

冷周六：但往好处想，我们至少能大致知道还有多少时间，能优化方案，改进软盘。剩下三个月……
Hissabeth: The silver lining is that now we know that we have exactly three months. We can still optimize the procedure and improve the disk and ...

指针： 够了，西尔维！
Pointer: Enough, Sylvie!

指针用从未有过的严肃语气打断了冷周六的话。
Pointer cuts her off. Her tone is serious.

命名日： 如果对计划的进展有疑问，我想大家可以坐下来讨论……
Name Day: Oh, c'mon, friends. Can we just calm down and discuss our schedule over dinner?

命名日： 或者您有一些好的建议，正急着要告诉大伙儿……
Name Day: I believe Ms. Pointer was only trying to suggest a better plan.

指针： 我建议现在中止计划。
Pointer: I am. I suggest we stop all work on this project immediately.

这并不在年轻人的意料之内。他一时间找不到合适的措辞来缓和气氛。
The young man is caught off balance, unable to find the words to ease the tension in the room.

冷周六： 为什么？我们远远没到要放弃的时候。
Hissabeth: What? Why? The situation really isn't that dire.

库珀花环： 是的，这……这太突然了，指针女士。那次实验事故真的不算严重……
Kiperina: Ms. Hissabeth is right. We shouldn't be discouraged over one accident, Ms. Pointer. The damage wasn't too severe.

指针： 还有三个月。而我们最新的进展就是一次事故。
Pointer: Only three months left, yet our latest "achievement" was a total catastrophe.

指针： 我明白你们认为还能继续尝试，认为成功的概率很大——但那些都只是“预测”。
Pointer: I know what you're all thinking. That the odds are still good, and it's more or less safe to continue. But all that is a weighted gamble.

指针： 没有任何东西比眼前的生命更重要。
Pointer: Nothing matters more than your lives.

她万分清楚这一点。因为她曾经是最敢于冒险的那部分人。
She knows this all too well. This is not her first time making bold gambles.

研究员 I： 指针，你觉得我们成功的概率有多大?
Researcher I: Pointer, what do you think the odds are really?

指针： 理论上是七成，在我看来几乎是百分之百。
Pointer: Without diving into the calculations, it's around a 70% chance in theory. But my logic is screaming something else in my ear.

研究员 II： 你没必要这么做，指针……
Researcher II: You ... you don't have to take that risk, Pointer.

指针： 我有分寸，我比任何人都清楚该怎么做。本来就不存在绝对成功的尝试。
Pointer: I know what I'm doing. Nothing's guaranteed in the world of science.

指针： 我——
Pointer: I ...

她闭了闭眼睛，阻止更多画面继续涌入脑海。
She closes her eyes, interrupting the playthrough of her memories.

指针： 我绝对不会同意你们冒这么大的风险。
Pointer: The risk is too high. I can't allow it.

冷周六：可是本来就不存在绝对成功的尝试。没有人去试，就永远不会知道结果。
Hissabeth: But it's like we always say: there is nothing guaranteed in the world of science. You never know before you take that fateful step.

说得多么坚定，又多么理所当然的一句话，与当时的指针如出一辙。
Such a firm, matter-of-fact statement. It sounds exactly like something the old Pointer might have said.

指针：但谁来保证计划百分百成功，谁来面对失败的后果？不是进医务室躺几个月、几年，而是——
Pointer: My analysis points to a dangerous level of uncertainty in this project. The price of failure, even optimistically, could be much worse than a few days in recovery. There could be more permanent injuries. You could even ...

“暴雨”。
The "Storm."

指针环视着所有人，他们都尚未领受过失败的教训，也不该承受那些。
Pointer scans the room. None of them have known failure—not yet—and they shouldn't have to.

指针：那些消失的城市和人，我们都见过太多了。
Pointer: You've seen how things, places, people just disappear in the "Storm."

指针：别再继续了。你们还不明白吗？
Pointer: You need to stop this insanity before that happens to us. Don't you understand?

冷周六：我的确不知道……究竟有什么问题？
Hissabeth: I really don't. Why should we stop?

她思考片刻，仿佛突然抓住了灵光，对指针点了点头。
She thinks for a moment, then a spark of inspiration flashes across her face.

冷周六：你说得对，牺牲不应该是常态，活着的人才能保证这些研究的存续。
Hissabeth: No, you're right. We shouldn't pretend as if it's normal to risk our lives for this. At the end of the day, if we die, our research dies with us.

冷周六：在危险的情况下，你会活下来。我希望你来保管这个故事。
Hissabeth: But if something were to happen to the team, you would be the one to survive. That's why I want you to keep our records, to take down everything in case the worst happens.

冷周六：给你。
Hissabeth: Here.

指针低头看着那张数据卡。
Pointer looks down at the data card.

机械只能忠实地记录与复现数据，无法读出更多的含义，更无法理解人类所谓冲动的选择。
Machines are only capable of faithfully recording and replaying data. They can't interpret meaning. They certainly cannot understand the reckless choices of human beings.

后来者能草草浏览每位成员的经历，知道他们如何相遇、做出选择、合作，以及分别。
Those who come after might skim through the logs and learn how the team met, chose, collaborated, and parted ways.

但镜头之外的内容呢？实验室的温度、餐馆招牌菜的滋味，以及她当下的犹豫。
没有任何东西能承载这些细节，除了记忆。
But what about everything outside the frame? The temperature of the lab, the taste of a restaurant's signature dish, the hesitation she feels right now. No device can preserve those details—only memory can.

需要前进的人，也需要留下的人。
Some need to move forward. Others need to stay behind.

她没有伸出手。再抬起头时，她已经做好了决定。
She doesn't look up and never reaches for the disk. She's made up her mind.

指针： 我不会收下数据卡，更不会去提交延迟撤离申请书——我不会帮你们送命。
Pointer: I won't take it, and I won't submit this petition for you. I can't stand by and let you kill yourselves.

指针： 我要退出计划。
Pointer: I'm done. I quit.

冻雨天
A Freezing Rain CO-10

1987 普列谢茨克分部
暴雨前两个月
1987, Plesetsk
2 months before the "Storm"

指针。拉普拉斯科算中心普列谢茨克分部研究员。
The name is Pointer. Researcher in the LSCC Plesetsk Branch.

加入计划的原因，和退出的原因一样。
The reason I joined? The same reason I quit.

没有什么比眼前的生命重要。我一直是为了人们能活得更好而做研究。
Nothing matters more than people's lives. All the research I've done has been for one purpose: to make people's lives better.

拉普拉斯分部·大厅
Hall, Laplace Branch

北方哨歌： 你在这儿，指针！最近怎么样?
Windsong: Pointer, there you are! How's everything going?

理线学学者似乎并不介意她的中途离场。每当在分部大楼碰见指针，她都会聊上几句，顺带提及一些航天小组的近况。
Windsong doesn't mind her quitting. Whenever she runs into Pointer at the branch office, she always stops for a few words, often with updates on the aerospace team.

北方哨歌： 我听说你正忙着帮相关人员撤离。情况如何？我看米尔内大部分的店铺都关门了。
Windsong: I heard you're busy with the evacuation. Seems many stores in Mirny have already closed up.

指针： 老样子。等之前的工作交接完了，我就会到米尔内镇上正式开始协助，应该也就是帮忙打包、协调人员、解释情况之类的。
Pointer: As soon as I finish the handover here, I'm heading back into town to help with packing, coordinating, and explaining the situation to the locals. Same old, same old.

北方哨歌： 我昨天问起冷周六研究情况，她也说是“老样子”。但我看他们进度还不错。
Windsong: "Same old, same old." You know, Hissabeth said that exact thing when I asked about the team's progress yesterday. They seem to be doing alright.

指针： 是吗。
Pointer: Good.

北方哨歌从大衣里取出一个小袋子，把话题轻巧地拨向了其他方向。
Windsong takes a small bag out from her coat, nudging the conversation in a lighter direction.

北方哨歌：噢，我刚想起来——这里还有点多出来的种子。这次多给你些。
Windsong: Oh, by the way, I've got some seeds left. Do you wanna take them off my hands?

指针：……我看起来对园艺感兴趣?
Pointer: Do I look like a gardener to you?

北方哨歌：米尔内的驻军和一些民众说，之前有拉普拉斯的研究员给他们送过向日葵种子。
Windsong: Well, it's just that I heard from a few people here in Mirny that a Laplace researcher was giving out sunflower seeds.

北方哨歌：我只知道这个人不是我自己，但具体是哪位，也没有什么证据。
Windsong: And it wasn't me, so I've been wondering just who it could have been.

北方哨歌：你不需要吗？我看他们很喜欢这份礼物。
Windsong: Don't you want some? Seriously, everyone loves them.

指针：……
Pointer: ...

在离开普列谢茨克发射基地的那天，她将花种分发给了沿途碰到的人。
On the day Pointer left the Plesetsk Cosmodrome, she handed out these seeds to everyone she passed.

当时她是怎么想的？或许是急切地想抛开任何联系，避免自己中途折返。
What was she thinking? Maybe she just wanted to break all ties, to stop herself from turning back.

她收起了这份礼物，打算在合适的时机再次送出。
She keeps this bag, saving it for the right moment.

指针：多谢。
Pointer: Thanks.

指针：说起来，那份延迟撤离申请书，最后是谁提交给路德维希的?
Pointer: So, who ended up signing the application?

北方哨歌：冷周六打算在取监测器的时候顺带提交，正好展示她的研究成果。她说这样路德维希同意的概率会大很多。
Windsong: Hissabeth will, when she goes to collect the monitor and report our research to Ludwig. She says it's more likely to get approval that way.

指针：他们是彻底不打算中止计划了吗?
Pointer: They don't know when to stop, do they?

北方哨歌：我想他们不会放弃的。
Windsong: They don't know the meaning.

冷周六：还是放弃吧。
Hissabeth: Stop.

冷周六：那些鱼稍稍受了点刺激就不吃东西，你怎么喂也没用。
Hissabeth: If the fish get startled, then they won't eat anything.

库珀花环：我明白了，冷周六女士。
Kiperina: I see, Ms. Hissabeth.

但她依然在将鱼食仔细地撒上水面，希望这些脆弱的小生物能多少保留些求生意志。
She sprinkles the fish food carefully over the water's surface, hoping these fragile little creatures might cling to some instinct to survive.

命名日：我刚清点完了剩余的材料，卢恩矿石的损耗比预想中好一些。
剩下的文件要放到哪里？反面还能当计算稿纸用。
Name Day: I finished a full inventory check. There's more runium left than we thought. Now, where should I put these useless old files? I was thinking we could use them for draft paper.

冷周六：如果你能帮我把这些文件变成一把刀，我会很感激你。
Hissabeth: Maybe you can turn them into a knife or something.

冷周六：虽然派不上大用场，至少它们还能拿来切切水果。
Hissabeth: A knife would be more useful at this point. You know, to cut fruit or whatever.

命名日：这个不行。你桌上废弃的名片可以。
Name Day: Actually, that card there on the table would work better for that.

冷周六：有什么特别的?
Hissabeth: Why is that?

命名日：材质。金属名片不算常见，它们做武器会比用于自我介绍更好。
Name Day: It's all about the material. Metal makes a better edge than paper. Never quite understood why you made them like that.

冷周六：那是我之前研制的新型材料。北方哨歌和指针的名片也都是我做的，受热就会变锋利，在手里捏一会儿能当拆信刀用……
Hissabeth: Oh. I was testing out the new alloy. I used it to make Windsong's and Pointer's cards. It gets harder and sharper when heated. Give it a rub with your hands, and you can use it as a letter opener.

话音在这里停住了。他们尽量不提及指针的离开，试图让一切按照寻常的模样继续。
Their words trail off. They've been trying not to bring up Pointer's departure, to pretend like everything is still just as it was.

冷周六：这个术式不够稳定……要想预设目的地，必须锚定一片区域，或是一个明确的定位点。
Hissabeth: The ritual still isn't stable enough. We need a specific location or area to set as a destination in advance.

冷周六：得先确定它能识别的范围。
Hissabeth: But first, we need a way to pinpoint a recognizable area.

冷周六：公式是……
Hissabeth: The formula should be ...

命名日：北方哨歌女士发了条消息提醒我们记得取监测器。
Name Day: Ms. Windsong sent me a message. She said: "Don't forget to collect the monitor."

冷周六：噢，她给大伙儿都发了？替我谢谢她。
Hissabeth: Oh, she sent it to you too? Tell her I said thanks.

冷周六：不对……不是这个数。
Hissabeth: No, that number doesn't look right.

含章鼎：我尽可能打听过了，你说的神秘学矿物有好几种都相当稀缺，现在没法弄到手。
Han Zhang: I tried my best, but those arcane minerals you were asking for are scarce as all hell! I haven't been able to find a single supplier.

冷周六：也行，能弄到更好，没有就算了。
Hissabeth: Then, we'll carry on without them.

冷周六：是这个。
Hissabeth: That's it.

冷周六： 不，完全不对劲。
Hissabeth: Nope. Wrong again.

冷周六： 计算数据本来是指针拿手的活儿，如果她来算会快很多……
Hissabeth: Pointer was the master of numbers. With that brain of her, she'd have had this over and done by now.

房间角落的声音引着她回过头，远旅正用几块矿石碎屑搭起摇摇晃晃的尖塔。
A sound from the corner of the room draws her attention. Voyager is stacking pieces of mineral shards into a wobbly tower.

在灯光照耀下，塔尖闪闪发亮，格外引人注目。
In the lamplight, the peak sparkles, strangely mesmerizing.

冷周六： 当心别划伤自己了，那些东西看起来没用，但实际威力大得很。
Hissabeth: Careful, don't hurt yourself. They're more powerful than they seem.

看见远旅半知半解地点点头，冷周六回过头来，打算重新想办法对付手里的数据。
Voyager nods with a vague but accepting gesture, and Hissabeth turns back, ready to refocus on the data.

但微妙的平静一旦被打破，就很难再恢复原状。
But the fragile silence is broken, and other words spill out.

库珀花环： 冷周六女士。
Kiperina: Ms. Hissabeth.

照顾完那些鱼，小宇航员走到了冷周六的旁边。她难得主动靠得这么近。
The little would-be astronaut walks over and stands beside Hissabeth. It's rare for her to approach so closely.

库珀花环： 我想询问您一个问题……时机也许不太合适。但是它对我非常重要。
Kiperina: I have a question for you. Sorry if it's not a good time, but it's important to me.

库珀花环： 我希望您能给我确定的、真实的答复。
Kiperina: And it's something I hope you'll answer honestly.

金鱼缸成为了这个突兀话题的无辜受害者。基金会职员慌张地捞起地板上的鱼，为它在旁边找了个新的住处。
Startled by the coming topic, Name Day broke the fish tank accidentally. He scrambles to scoop up the spilling fish from the floor.

命名日： 抱歉——冷周六女士，您可以当我不在这儿。我并不知道你们有过什么谈话。
Name Day: Sorry, ladies. Please ignore me. I'm not here, and I didn't hear a thing.

命名日： 库珀花环小姐很聪明，她猜出任何事都不奇怪，对吗?
Name Day: Ms. Kiperina is a smart young lady. It's hardly surprising that she'd be quick to figure things out, don't you agree?

冷周六： ……
Hissabeth: ...

冷周六俯视着她，这张仰起的脸很稚嫩，但神情也很坚决。
Hissabeth looks down at her. The upturned face is young, but so very determined.

冷周六： 你的问题是?
Hissabeth: So, what's your question?

库珀花环： 指针女士离开的时候提到过，“那些消失的城市和人，我们都见过太多了”。
Kiperina: Ms. Pointer said something before she left about places and people disappearing into the "Storm."

库珀花环：我想，指针女士不是会轻易放弃的人。除非她知道，我们失败的后果远超能够承受的范围。
Kiperina: It's hard to believe that she would ever give up on our mission, unless she knew the price of failing was truly horrible.

库珀花环：“暴雨”不只是一场自然灾害，是不是？
Kiperina: Then the "Storm" can't just be some normal kind of natural disaster.

库珀花环：“暴雨”是不是会让我们现在生活的地方也消失……？
Kiperina: This "Storm" will destroy everything, won't it?

她抛出了自己压在心底许久的疑惑，冷周六看见她的眼睛像漂亮的玻璃弹珠那样蓄满了光。
She doesn't even know how long that question has sat in the pit of her chest. In her glass-marble eyes, Hissabeth sees a brightness welling up.

她不知该如何回答，但沉默本身也是一种答案。于是女孩明白了。
She doesn't know how to respond. But silence can be an answer, too, and the girl understands.

库珀花环：我们认识的人也会吗？小熊、鸟儿、这些鱼也都会，对吗？
Kiperina: All the people we know? All the bears, birds, these fish, everything?

库珀花环：在我们找回那个失去的“未来”之前，也要面对很多次……很多次的……消失。
Kiperina: The lost future that you talk about, was it the first to disappear? Or are there more that have been lost? Will the same thing happen to our time?

库珀花环：它……没有你们描述得那么好。
Kiperina: Things are much worse than you let on.

库珀花环：有多少东西改变了？
Kiperina: What else has changed in the future?

女孩眼中的那些光始终没有真正地淌下来。库珀花环很早就明白眼泪的作用相当有限。
The light in her eyes never fades—not completely. Kiperina has long understood that tears won't change anything.

冷周六：太多东西都不如人们想象的长久。
Hissabeth: Many, many things changed. Some things won't last nearly as long as people think they will.

冷周六：对你们来说或许是天翻地覆的改变，但生活还在继续。有好事，也有坏事。
Hissabeth: For you, the world might seem to have turned upside down, but life will go on.

麻烦总是接踵而至，指针离开，北方哨歌还有自己的地质勘察任务，而这里正在说话的人都在向她寻求回答。
Pointer is gone. Windsong has her own geological surveys. Now everyone that's left seems to be looking to Hissabeth for answers.

冷周六尝试斟酌措辞，但她本就没有太多被关照的经验，并不理解要如何安慰他人。
She tries to choose her words deliberately, but she has hardly ever been comforted, so she doesn't know how to comfort others.

冷周六：所以——你决定好要正式加入拉普拉斯了吗？
Hissabeth: So, now that you know what's at stake, are you ready to officially join Laplace?

冷周六：只有正式员工才有知情权。在此之前我无法向你透露太多东西。
Hissabeth: I'm afraid there is still a great deal I cannot tell you until then. Many of the answers you're seeking are classified, for employees only.

命名日：抱歉，冷周六女士。
Name Day: Pardon me, Ms. Hissabeth.

命名日：考虑到库珀花环小姐要执行的任务，她有权知道“暴雨”意味着什么。
Name Day: But given the danger of the mission we are expecting Kiperina to perform, I think she has the right to know what the "Storm" really is.

库珀花环：我明白，您不想违反拉普拉斯的规定。
Kiperina: I understand that you don't want to go against Laplace's rules.

库珀花环：但我想您可以点头或摇头。
Kiperina: But I'll bet there aren't any rules against me figuring it out and you simply nodding, am I right?

冷周六点头了。于是库珀花环继续说下去。
Hissabeth nods. So Kiperina goes on.

库珀花环：我不会在未来见到科兹洛夫先生，也不会得到那份礼物。
Kiperina: I won't get to see Mr. Kozlov or get that gift in the future.

库珀花环：加入拉普拉斯，意味着……我要和乌特恩亚亚的大家彻底告别。
Kiperina: So, if I join Laplace, I won't see anyone from Utrennyaya ever again.

冷周六：……
Hissabeth: ...

沉默片刻后，她再次点头。
She hesitates but at last nods again.

冷周六：你可以做选择，像指针那样，我不会强迫你留下。
Hissabeth: The choice is yours. I won't force you to do anything.

冷周六：在餐馆碰到你那天，我说可以给你写推荐信，和今天一样都是认真说的。
Hissabeth: Remember the day we first met in the restaurant? I said I would write you a recommendation. I was serious. I still am.

冷周六：推荐信我其实已经写好了，以防万一，你后面那位灰白格子也会给你担保证明，北方哨歌也在推荐信上签了名。
Hissabeth: In fact, it's already done. Windsong has signed on to it too, and our Foundation friend behind you is prepared to offer another guarantee just in case.

冷周六：你的朋友远旅也会得到推荐。但我们终究没法为所有人解决问题，也没法替任何人做决定。
Hissabeth: We will make a recommendation for your friend Voyager as well, but that's all we can do. I'm afraid we can't protect everyone, nor can we make this decision for you.

库珀花环：……
Kiperina: ...

冷周六：你要继续吗?
Hissabeth: Do you want to keep going?

她也在问自己同样的问题。
The question isn't just for Kiperina.

还要继续吗？如果拿回数据，如果数据有用，是不是总有一天所有人都不用再受“暴雨”的困扰?
If they recover the data—if that data is any good—maybe someday no one will have to worry about the "Storm" ever again.

如果努力拿回的数据只是一堆无用的字符呢?
But what if they put their lives in jeopardy and gain nothing from it?

冷周六：不做尝试就只能被迫接受，试一试至少还有机会改变。
Hissabeth: If you don't, you'll be allowed to return and accept what's to come, but if you join us, there is a chance to change things.

这是她的答案。也只是她自己的答案。
That is her answer—the only answer she needs to keep going.

库珀花环： 我……
Kiperina: I ...

偶然的诗
Poems Come By Chance CO-11

沉默是有重量的。当它逐渐累积，终究会像细沙一样没过每个人的咽喉。
Silence has weight. Like sand piling, layer on layer, on one's chest, eventually it can suffocate.

房间里响起的啜泣声极其微弱，只有两三声，很快就被压灭了。
The sobs barely register—two or three, snuffed out before they can burst.

库珀花环： 我会完成这个任务。
Kiperina: I will complete my mission.

她咬字清晰，仿佛立下誓言般郑重。
She speaks with clarity, as if making a solemn vow.

库珀花环： 如果我拿到数据，顺利回来，我会考虑加入拉普拉斯。
Kiperina: And if I successfully come back with the data, I'll consider joining Laplace.

库珀花环： 现在我无法仔细思考该如何选择。所以，请原谅我无法立刻给您答复。
Kiperina: But I can't make a decision now. I need more time to think.

库珀花环： 但我会继续的，您可以放心。
Kiperina: I will stay until my job is done. You don't have to worry about that.

库珀花环： 因为这是科兹洛夫先生和大家都希望我做的事……现在也是我唯一能做的事。
Kiperina: That is what Mr. and Mrs. Koslov and my friends in the circus would all want. It is the right thing to do.

库珀花环： ……
Kiperina: ...

库珀花环： 我要去训练了，晚些见。
Kiperina: If you'll excuse me, I should return to my training. I'll see you later.

早在尾音落地前，她就迈开了步子，将一整片难捱的沉默抛在身后。
She's already on the move before the last word is spoken, leaving behind another layer of suffocating silence.

没等上多久，另一个人也尝试着从中脱身。
It doesn't take long before someone else tries to wriggle out from it, too.

命名日： 我们也先走了，仓库里还有些材料等着清点，说不定里头有能用的东西。
Name Day: Us too. Need to double-check the warehouse inventory. Might find something useful.

含章鼎： 昨天不是都收拾好了吗？那些——
Han Zhang: Wait, haven't we done that already? Those—

命名日： 好了。如果找到什么，我们会列张单子送来的。
Name Day: Alright! We'll let you know if we find anything.

小宇航员和基金会职员先后离开了房间。角落里的少女疑惑地偏过头，努力地比划出几个手势。
They leave the room one after another. In the corner, Voyager seems entirely unsure of what to do.

冷周六：跟他们去忙吧，我还有数据没处理完。
Hissabeth: Join them if you want. I have some unfinished business.

远旅：……
Voyager: ...

片刻过后，轻快的身影迈出了房门。
Moments later, the last light-footed silhouette exits the room.

远旅：……
Voyager: ...

熟悉的金色就停留在走廊远处，低下头靠着墙壁。
The familiar gold glint rests at the far end of the hallway, her head lowered against the wall.

远旅试图跟上同伴的脚步，但很快又犹豫地刹住了步子。
Voyager tries to approach but hesitates, stopping mid-step.

左右张望，确认过走廊上再没有其他身影，她将小提琴架上肩头。
She looks around to make sure the hallway is empty, then lifts her violin onto her shoulder.

远旅：……
Voyager: ...

远旅：……阿涅娅！
Voyager: Alia!

琴音和呼唤绞成一股颤颤的丝弦，让小宇航员回过头来。
The music strings and her voice twist together like a trembling thread, calling her friend to turn around.

库珀花环：是你在叫我吗?
Kiperina: Was that you? Did you just say my name?

库珀花环：你学会了——
Kiperina: You learned how to—

在看清那些闪烁的光点后，她骤然间收住了声音。
As she sees those flickering sparks, her voice falters.

只是短暂的、眨眼间的工夫，眼前的少女又恢复了普通的模样。
Then, in a heartbeat, Voyager resumes her usual appearance.

远旅：星星……很好。
Voyager: Stars ... good.

远旅：阿涅娅、开心。
Voyager: Alia, happy.

冷周六久违地独享了整间办公室，却并未如预料中那样顺利地推进工作。
Hissabeth has the office to herself for once, but the progress she had hoped would come to her is still elusive.

在又一次计算失败后，她撂下了手里的笔，开始重新确定今日目标。
After yet another failed calculation, she sets her pen down and reconsiders her goals.

冷周六：至少今天把所有数据算完。
Hissabeth: These calculations need to be finished today.

冷周六：“转念即至”要求施术者默念目标地点，这可以大致理解成是为了校准定位。
Hissabeth: The "Teleport" ritual requires the caster to recite the location. It could be understood as calibrating in a way.

冷周六：按照之前的思路想下去，如果从这个阶段入手……
Hissabeth: Let's continue with that thought.

冷周六：预设好软盘的目的地，使用口令触发……之前无法稳定传送，或许是因为在过远的距离下，锚定目的地的术式达不到足够的精确度……
Hissabeth: The destination must be preset, and the ritual cast through incantation ... But the further the distance, the harder it is to stay on target.

冷周六：如果能有一个独特的、绝对不会被识别错的神秘术反应源用于定位的话……
Hissabeth: If only there were an arcane reaction strong enough and unique enough to calibrate to ...

周遭突兀地静默了一瞬。那台监测神秘术能量反应的仪器发出的警报可称惊天动地。
It's only then that she notices the strangeness of the moment, which is abruptly broken by the arcane energy monitor as it lets out an ear-splitting alarm.

灼眼的亮光迅速覆盖了整块屏幕，紧接着——更快地熄灭。
A blinding light flashes across the entire screen, then cuts out.

仪器的监测范围被她有意设置得很窄，最多覆盖到走廊。这个反应源只和她隔着一堵墙。
The instrument's detection radius is small, barely beyond the nearby hallway.

冷周六：——！
Hissabeth: !

因为步子太急，她险些在门口造成一次碰撞事故。
She narrowly avoids a full-on collision in the doorway.

好在她很快就借着女孩儿的肩膀找回了平衡。
Luckily, she catches herself using the girl's shoulder.

库珀花环：发生什么了？您还好吗，冷周六女士？
Kiperina: What happened? Are you alright, Ms. Hissabeth?

冷周六：刚才是你在用神秘术？
Hissabeth: Was that you? Did you cast that arcane skill just now?

冷周六：不，这超过了正常情况下绝大多数神秘学家的极限。还有谁和你在一起？
Hissabeth: No, those energy levels were too high for you—beyond most arcanists. Who was with you just now?

库珀花环：……还有远旅小姐。
Kiperina: Voyager.

库珀花环：她只是为了安慰我——如果她不小心干扰了什么实验，我帮她向您道歉。
Kiperina: She was just trying to make me feel better. Did it interfere with your experiments? I apologize, Ms. Hissabeth. I promise it won't happen again.

库珀花环：如果您要找她，我也可以陪您一块儿去。她刚离开不久……
Kiperina: She just left. If you want to find her, I'll go with you.

冷周六：你能确定她刚才在你面前用过神秘术，是吗？
Hissabeth: Are you saying she was the one that cast that arcane skill?

库珀花环：是的，那是个很漂亮的神秘术。看起来就像……
Kiperina: Yes. It was so pretty. It was like ...

冷周六：中子星。
Hissabeth: A neutron star.

这个词显然不在库珀花环的知识范畴里，她疑惑地偏了偏脑袋。
It's obvious that the concept is beyond Kiperina. She tilts her head expectantly.

冷周六：它们中的一些有强磁场，能起导航作用，就是所谓的宇宙灯塔。
Hissabeth: It's a type of highly magnetized star that emits powerful beams that can be traced to show us its precise location. We call them the beacons of space.

冷周六：换成神秘术的能量反应也一样！一个足够明亮的反应源，能轻易地被定位！
Hissabeth: Such a strong arcane reaction would be so bright that it'd be trivial to locate even from an extreme distance!

库珀花环：我不知道什么是中子星……但我大概明白了您的意思。就像太阳在许多星星里是最显眼的。
Kiperina: I don't know much about space, but it sounds like the difference between finding a star in the sky and looking for the sun.

库珀花环：但是宇宙应该很大，或许和其他一些我们还没见过的星星比起来，太阳没有那么明亮……
Kiperina: But then the universe is also very big. I imagine if you were looking from far enough away, even the sun would seem small.

冷周六：没错，没错……与整个宇宙比起来，就算是剧烈的神秘术反应也显得微乎其微。
Hissabeth: Damn! I'm afraid you're right. When comparing all the stars in the observable universe, our sun is far from the largest or brightest. Only the closest. We can't assume proximity in our case.

冷周六：但是……反过来呢?
Hissabeth: But then, there's still got to be a way, non?

抓住刹那间的灵光，冷周六沿着全新的思路推导。
Capturing the fleeting aura, she propels a new train of thought forward.

冷周六：“暴雨”来临前，神秘术会得到增幅，波动更加剧烈——而不受“暴雨”影响的地方呢?
Hissabeth: Before the "Storm" arrives, the levels of arcane energy in all affected areas will be greatly amplified. But, what about places that won't be affected?

冷周六：这个地点也会在监测仪上格外突出，因为它几乎毫无增幅反应。
Hissabeth: Perhaps then, the trick will not be to look for the light in darkness, but for the darkness in the light, like finding a dim bulb in a string of Christmas lights.

冷周六扶住库珀花环的肩膀，郑重地许下承诺。
Hissabeth places her hands on Kiperina's shoulders and makes a promise.

冷周六：我可以试着调整卢恩矿石的使用比例，严格限制软盘的定位范围在普列谢茨克分部附近！
Hissabeth: If that's the case, I can adjust the portion of runium in order to focus the disk precisely on Plesetsk!

冷周六：如果这次实验成功——
Hissabeth: If this works out—

冷周六：我可以保证，你一定能安全返航。
Hissabeth: Then I guarantee you will arrive home safe and sound.

1987 普列谢茨克分部
暴雨前两个月
1987, Plesetsk
2 months before the "Storm"

指针：好，我明白了。注意安全，回见。
Pointer: Understood. Take care.

她按掉通讯，向朝自己走来的身影挥了挥手。
She ends the call and waves at the silhouette walking her way.

北方哨歌：在忙什么?
Windsong: What are you up to?

指针：和米尔内的驻军联系，他们巡逻时发现了异常的魔精活动。
Pointer: I've been communicating with the garrison in Mirny. They've picked up some abnormal critter activity during their patrols.

指针：我稍后会赶过去帮忙，最后一批镇民也要开始撤离了。
Pointer: Another batch of residents is set to evacuate too. I'll head over to help them shortly.

指针：你呢，你的地质勘察还顺利吗？打算留在分部躲雨，还是抓紧时间到总部报到？
Pointer: What about you—your geological survey? Are you staying at the branch, or will you head back to HQ?

北方哨歌：没找到值得开发的矿藏，我决定再做点努力，应该会踩着最后时间回到这里。
Windsong: Haven't found anything that's worth digging up yet, but I've decided to give it another try. Should be back here in time for the evacuation.

北方哨歌：那位小学徒说，等她顺利返回，就会决定是否加入拉普拉斯。我当然要等着好消息。
Windsong: Though I'm hoping to stick around for my little apprentice. She said she'll only give us her decision on joining Laplace once she's back from her mission. I can't wait to hear the good news.

北方哨歌：你是彻底打算不再关注这件事了？
Windsong: You still pretending not to care?

指针：无论我是否关注都不会影响结果，不过我希望他们能懂得及时放弃。
Pointer: My concern, whether it exists or not, will have no tangible effect on their results. I just hope they don't kill themselves for nothing.

北方哨歌：冷周六打算后天进行最后一次传送实验，我会在分部的会议室等她。
Windsong: Hissabeth is planning a final teleportation test the day after tomorrow. I'll be observing from the meeting room.

北方哨歌：就是楼上那间最常用的会议室，大概是下午。
Windsong: You know the one we always use upstairs? Early in the afternoon.

指针：那时候我应该在米尔内。
Pointer: I'll likely be in Mirny by then.

二人陷入了短暂的沉默。趁这个间隙，北方哨歌敏锐地抓住了下一个话题——
人群中显眼的玻璃缸。
A brief silence follows. In the pause, Windsong deftly shifts the topic to the conspicuous glass tank in the crowd.

北方哨歌：嘿，乌尔里希，又见面了。
Windsong: Hey, Ulrich! We meet again.

北方哨歌：只是这么一小段时间没碰面，你竟然又憔悴了些！
Windsong: You look even worse than when we last met.

乌尔里希：北方哨歌？还有……指针？
Ulrich: Ah, Ms. Windsong? And Pointer?

乌尔里希：两位大忙人居然会同时出现在普列谢茨克分部的大厅里。
Ulrich: What have we here, two of our busiest bees working together in the Plesetsk Branch?

指针实在无法理解磁流体“憔悴”的状态从何而来，她读不到对方的表情。于是她只能朝对方点头示意。
Pointer has no idea why Ulrich looks "even worse." His expression, as ever, is nigh unreadable, so she simply nods to him.

北方哨歌：你的人道主义假期何时结束？还来得及去看点有趣的东西吗？
Windsong: So, when is this "humanitarian vacation" of yours over? Any interest in sparing a little time to watch something fun?

乌尔里希：如果“有趣的东西”指德米特里他们的聚会，那就免了。
Ulrich: If by "something fun" you mean Dmitry's party, then thanks, but no, thanks.

北方哨歌：不不。我应该向你提过的，是冷周六的传送软盘实验。
Windsong: No, not that. I told you about it before—Hissabeth's teleport disk experiment.

乌尔里希：哦，这件事——我想起来了。你们要做的事在分部和总部都传开了。
Ulrich: Ah, yes, that one. You know word of it is already spreading through HQ and all the other branches?

北方哨歌：怎么说？狠狠夸了一通？
Windsong: And? What's the impression?

乌尔里希：我不确定，倒是给他们增添了不少饭后谈资。
Ulrich: I wouldn't categorize it as "good," but it has certainly become a contentious topic.

北方哨歌：总还是有支持者，比如露西女士。听说她最近新邀请了一位来自东方的、研究弦理论的科学家去总部。
Windsong: At least one of the bigwigs is supportive—Madam Lucy. It seems she intends to keep our experiment going either way. She even invited a prominent String-Theory Researcher to HQ.

北方哨歌：就像我之前说过的那样，有些事的价值不全在于立刻做出成果。
Windsong: As I said, even if we don't get the results we hoped for, the work itself can be illuminating.

始终未发一言的研究员选择在此刻挥了挥手。
The silent researcher at last offers a wave to attract the attention of the room.

指针：抱歉，我还有事，我得先离开了。
Pointer: Excuse me. I have obligations to attend to.

指针：下次有机会再聊。
Pointer: Let's talk again later.

她走得很快，磁流体和理线学者目送着迅速变成一枚小黑点的背影。
She walks off, leaving Ulrich and Windsong to watch her as her figure passes into the hall and away.

几分钟后，理线学者突然发出一声惊呼。
Several minutes pass, then Windsong gasps.

北方哨歌：该死！我没带工牌，现在指针走了——我要怎么搭电梯回实验室？
Windsong: S**t! I forgot my badge, and Pointer's gone. How am I supposed to get back to the lab?

北方哨歌：乌尔里希，我得麻烦你多跑一趟。
Windsong: Sorry, Ulrich, do you mind walking me back?

北方哨歌：正好你还没回答我，要不要去见证冷周六的实验……
Windsong: By the way, you didn't answer whether you'll be at Hissabeth's experiment.

西蒙娜收

To Camille 小径

西蒙娜收
To Camille

简中

亲爱的西蒙娜：
我们有多久没联络了？与寒冷的拉锯战消耗了我太多精力，直到今天我终于提振起体温，并给尾巴沾上了墨水。
西尔维她很好，马克西姆与亚历山德罗总是在帮助她并行思考，墨尼克照旧会在关键时刻控制局面。塞普内特斯最近越来越有思想了，我想他迟早会忍不住开口说话。海伦娜比以往还困，所以她二十四小时都待在有暖气的地方。还有尚塔尔与皮埃罗，大家都是老样子。
而我在这里的收获也不光是冬眠，当地的文学刚好填补我被西尔维扔掉的收藏空缺。
他们对痛苦与死亡的摹写令梅露西娜印象深刻，而他们在新道路上的尝试又总是充满梦想与浪漫。
我随信寄了一些给你，里面都是西尔维或许感兴趣的部分——当我念到这些部分时，她的记忆总是特别清晰，其中让她印象最深的是帕斯捷尔纳克的《二月》：“越是偶然，就越真实，并在痛苦中编成诗章。”
虽然这无从验证——西尔维绝不会亲自承认，但我想她是我们一家中第一喜欢浪漫的。或者第二，仅次于我。我多么希望你也是迪布瓦家的一员，那样你就能理解西尔维看到流星时的记忆。
衷心期盼有一天能和你讨论我近来的收获，或许等到西尔维这个小小的挑战圆满结束后，你可以来普列谢茨克一趟，我保证我和西尔维都会维持着高体温欢迎你。

你的挚友，艾斯黛乐
English
Dear Camille,

How long has it been since we last spoke? The long tug-of-war with the cold drained all my energy. Only today did I manage to warm up enough to dip my tail in ink and write to you.

Sylvie is doing well. Maxime and Alexandre always help her think in parallel, and Monique, as usual, keeps things under control at critical moments. Serpentes has been showing more and more signs of thought lately. I think it's only a matter of time before he speaks. Hélène is sleepier than ever, staying in heated rooms around the clock.

As for Chantal and Pierre, they're the same as always.

And me? I didn't just hibernate. The local literature has filled the gaps in my collection that Sylvie once ruthlessly discarded.

The Melusines were deeply moved by these authors' vivid portrayals of suffering and death, yet even within the darkest themes, the authors' exploration of new paths brimmed with vitality, dreams, and a defiant sense of romanticism.

Whenever I read the literature to her, her memories become unusually vivid, and she recalls one line in particular with striking clarity from Pasternak's February: "The truest verses arise by chance, tempered in the fire of pain."

Of course, there's no way to verify this and Sylvie would never admit it, but I believe she's the most romantic in our family. Or maybe the second-most. After me. I wish you were part of the Dubois family too. That way, you'll truly understand what Sylvie's memories feel like when she sees a shooting star.

I truly hope we can talk about all of this someday. Maybe after Sylvie's little challenge is complete, you could visit Plesetsk. I promise Sylvie and I will both be warmly waiting to welcome you.

Your dear friend,

Estelle

《协奏曲》
Concerto CO-12

1987 普列谢茨克发射基地
暴雨前两个月
1987, Plesetsk Cosmodrome
2 months before the "Storm"

与平日相比，实验室里并没有太多不同。尽管伙伴们已经尽力将散落的小物件摆放齐整，但显然这种有序性难以得到维持。
There's not much difference in the lab today. Even though the others had tried to tidy up the clutter, any attempts at organization are doomed to fail here.

冷周六将最后一叠文件推到桌面角落，退后几步打量着自己收拾出的成果。
Hissabeth pushes the last stack of files to the corner of the table, then steps back to survey her work.

冷周六：我准备好了。你们也记得尽量保持安全距离。
Hissabeth: I'm ready. Remember to stay within the safe zone.

冷周六：医疗队会在近期撤离，所以我们得尽量小心。
Hissabeth: The medical team is helping with the evacuation, so we need to be extra careful this time.

库珀花环：您真的不需要我来做测试人员吗？我的神秘术已经足够熟练了，完全能保护自己。
Kiperina: Miss, are you sure I shouldn't be the one doing this? I've mastered my arcane skill. I'll be able to protect myself.

冷周六：当然不能是你，宇航员身上不能有伤疤，它们会因为升空时的高压开裂。
Hissabeth: No, no, no. Look at all the files here. They might give you a paper cut. It's an unacceptable risk for our astronaut. Even the slightest abrasion could explode under the pressure of lift-off.

冷周六：放心，这次成功率很高。多次数据核验和模拟都没什么毛病。
Hissabeth: No need for concern. We've done the simulations and cross-checked the data thoroughly.

冷周六：以防万一，我今天早上起来还对着软盘读了好几篇露西女士的演讲稿，还有拉普拉斯神秘术科技化应用领域的前沿论文，试图让它做好足够的心理准备。
Hissabeth: To aid in the disk's mental preparation, I even read it Madam Lucy's speech and some Laplace essays on the scientification of arcane skills.

库珀花环：可是——
Kiperina: But—

冷周六：库珀花环。
Hissabeth: Kiperina.

冷周六很少郑重其事地称呼谁。小宇航员不禁站直了身子。
Hissabeth's tone is formal, far more serious than she is known for in any other situation. Kiperina's back straightens.

冷周六：带其他人撤退到隔离门外面。
Hissabeth: Take the others behind the blast door.

冷周六：考虑到场地问题，我会用自己的神秘术给周围做隔热墙，尽力来点预防措施。
Hissabeth: I'll use my arcane skill to protect the field as much as I can.

冷周六：毕竟需要实时沟通情况，隔得太远的话通讯信号会被电磁影响，所以你们还是得待在门外。我已经尽可能把风险降到最低啦。
Hissabeth: In order to maintain communication, you'll need to stay behind that door, or else the signal will be disrupted. But with my arcane skill, the risk should be minimal.

库珀花环： 如果出了什么事，你要怎么办?
Kiperina: What if something goes wrong? What will you do?

冷周六： 我会管好自己。你得开始熟悉一些流程，总会用得上的。
Hissabeth: I will take care of myself. The only thing I ask is that you pay close attention to what I do.

冷周六： 除非有谁主动退出，否则出了事就轮流顶上，直到没人能接手。说不定最后全得靠你一个呢?
Hissabeth: Because in the worst-case scenario, if you find yourself out there alone, you'll need to be able to perform this intuitively.

库珀花环： 我没有那么多经验……
Kiperina: I don't know if I'm ready.

冷周六： 现在下结论还早，别随便就说做不到啊。
Hissabeth: Maybe, but it's still too early to give up, little astronaut.

她轻轻推了一把小宇航员的肩膀，让她往后退。
She gives her a gentle push on the shoulder, nudging her back.

自动门开始合拢。
The automatic door begins to close.

库珀花环： 但……
Kiperina: But ...

她没有来得及说完话，门扉便彻底关闭。
She doesn't finish her sentence before the doors shut completely.

冷周六： 哪来那么多严肃的告别，浪费时间。
Hissabeth: Enough talking. We don't have time for any dramatic farewells.

冷周六： 桌子上是……谁的工牌？指针走的时候肯定把她的东西全收拾好了。八成是北方哨歌的。
Hissabeth: Wait, whose ID is this? Couldn't be Pointer's. She packs meticulously. Let me guess. Windsong?

她仔细确认了上面的文字。
She reads the words on the ID, smiling smugly at her confirmation.

冷周六： 还真是。也不知道她怎么进的分部大楼。
Hissabeth: I knew it. How is she gonna get back into the lab?

启动软盘之前，她把这项意外收获挂在了脖子上。
Before activating the disk, she hangs the unexpected find around her neck.

冷周六： 给她来个惊喜。
Hissabeth: I'll just have to surprise her with it later.

拉普拉斯分部·会议室
Conference Room, Laplace Branch

空荡的会议室里，磁流体和理线学者分别占据了大门左右两侧的少部分空间。
In the empty meeting room, Ulrich and Windsong take up space on opposite sides of the door.

会议桌边的位置并不舒适，谁都不想在闲暇时坐过去。
No one feels like sitting at the uncomfortable conference table without a good reason.

乌尔里希： 你对他们有多大把握?
Ulrich: Where would you place their odds?

乌尔里希： 或者说，按你的评估看，拿回的数据是否真能帮助我们找到“暴雨”的真相?
Ulrich: Perhaps more importantly, is there any guarantee the data they collect will elucidate meaningful truths behind the "Storm"?

北方哨歌： 这可谁也没法保证。虽然我们是“拉普拉斯科算中心”。
Windsong: You know as well as I do. Laplace hasn't mastered the art of prediction. We don't offer guarantees.

北方哨歌： 全知全能的拉普拉斯妖究竟把故事读到哪儿了？谁知道呢。
Windsong: Besides, maybe our demon already knows how this all ends, but I'd rather not.

北方哨歌： 我个人是不喜欢被剧透结局的那一派。
Windsong: Personally, I hate spoilers.

乌尔里希： 我也是。
Ulrich: As do I.

磁流体耸了耸肩，正打算从最近关注的高新技术中挑选一个有趣的例子延续话题，熟悉的声音却不适时地响起。
Ulrich shrugs, about to continue the conversation by mentioning a neat bit of tech he's recently looked into, when a strange but familiar voice cuts in.

监测器： 有人在度假？真悠闲。真悠闲！
Monitor: Slackers? Slackers!

???: 找到他们了。感谢您的努力。
???: Yes, I've found the room. Thank you.

磁流体的发声装置卡壳了片刻才成功喊出声音的归属者。
Ulrich's voice modulator stutters for a moment before finally spitting out the name.

乌尔里希： ……阿德勒研究员？
Ulrich: Is that Adler?

北方哨歌： 路德维希先生？
Windsong: Mr. Ludwig?

理线学者的脸上一片愕然。磁流体的疑惑更明显，它明白地展示了大大的“!”。
Windsong looks stunned. Ulrich, clearly confused, flashes a giant "!" mark.

停在机器头顶的渡鸦也歪了歪脑袋。
The raven perched on the monitor's head tilts its own in curiosity.

“路德维希”： 很高兴听到两位有这样的研究热情。同样感谢你们的努力。
"Ludwig": I'm glad to see you're so devoted to our research, and I thank you for your hard work.

“路德维希”： 我来此等候冷周六研究员，并替露西女士转交“暴雨”监测器。
"Ludwig": I'm here to deliver the "Storm" Monitor on behalf of Madam Lucy.

“路德维希”： 考虑到实际的物资使用情况，以及时间紧迫，由一个小组对原有的机器进行了必要改造。
"Ludwig": Given our lack of resources and time, we were forced to modify an existing device to perform as our monitor.

“路德维希”： 它原本在科算中心承担日程汇报及工作提醒服务。
"Ludwig": It was originally a robotic assistant, something to set daily schedules and work reminders.

“路德维希”： 阿德勒研究员的事我有所耳闻。
"Ludwig": You already noticed Adler's voice. It's synthetic, of course.

“路德维希”： 出于同事间的人道主义关怀，他们收集了阿德勒曾经的发言数据，合成了语音包，把这台机器送到他的房间门口，试图让他和外界保证一定的社会化接触。
"Ludwig": His colleagues originally developed this machine for him as a "humanitarian gesture." It was trained to mimic his voice—an attempt to keep him social.

“路德维希”： 结果是它被“退货”了。因此转往其他方向出力。
"Ludwig": It ultimately proved ineffective in that role, so now it will serve as our monitor.

乌尔里希：我明白。合理利用资源是正确的决定。但我觉得“人道主义关怀”可以有更明确的执行标准。
Ulrich: I understand. Given the circumstances, recycling resources is wise. Though, I struggle to see how a robotic assistant could be a "humanitarian gesture."

“路德维希”：感谢理解。露西女士为你提交的休假理由也是“人道主义关怀”，看来你在普列谢茨克分部休养的期间，对这一词汇有了更多了解。
"Ludwig": Your appreciation is noted. And I supposed you might. In fact, this vacation Madam Lucy sent you on to Plesetsk is a kind of "humanitarian gesture" on her part. Perhaps she hopes you'll gain a deeper understanding of the term.

乌尔里希：……
Ulrich: ...

渡鸦显然对这份沉默十分满意，它不再发表任何意见。
The raven, pleased with the silence, offers no further input.

北方哨歌在监测器的屏幕上点了几下，为自己的新发现露出微笑。
Windsong taps a few times on the monitor and smiles at her new discovery.

北方哨歌：让我瞧瞧这个监测器——可选的语音包还挺多。“钢铁的炼成方案”，我猜这采样自露西女士的会议发言。
Windsong: Mind if I take a closer look? Wow, there are a lot of voice packs programmed into this thing. "How to Temper Steel"—Madam Lucy's voice, I'd bet.

北方哨歌：还有那位大明星玛丽莲小姐的。啊，这是斯普特尼克一号的播报语音。
Windsong: And then, what else is here? Sweetheart, the superstar? Oh, and Sputnik-1 too.

北方哨歌：“毛绒且温暖的陪伴”？这又是……？
Windsong: "Warm and Fluffy Company," who could that be?

监测器：’&#*（&!
Monitor: '%#@&*$#!

乌尔里希：他们不该把时间都浪费在这种地方。送上太空的监测器怎么会需要魔精语音包。
Ulrich: What a waste of time! Why would a monitor need a critter's voice in space?

北方哨歌：放轻松点，大家总得有办法缓解工作压力嘛。我觉得还挺有意思的。
Windsong: Maybe they just put it in for fun. It could be useful to relieve a little stress.

北方哨歌：噢，看来时间刚好。冷周六也准备好了。
Windsong: Oh, perfect timing. Hissabeth has entered the testing grounds.

冷周六：现场汇报。我启动了软盘，但它没有反应，猜测是某个部分读数有误。
Hissabeth: Field report. I activated the disk, but it's not working. There must be an error in its incantation.

冷周六：噢，提示灯在闪烁，是红灯。这说明它的确有蓄积神秘学能量，并且很可能在按照我限定的范围进行定位校准。
Hissabeth: Oh, the indicator is red, so then it must still be accumulating arcane energy. It may be calibrating its position within the range I set.

冷周六：但多出的能量似乎被用在了其他地方，这个术式的耗能是守恒的——所以它很可能会连带我附近的东西一起传送走。
Hissabeth: But what about all this excess energy? I worry it might not just transport me but half the office.

含章鼎：……你还有什么想交代的吗？我愿意收养你办公室里能幸存下来的鱼。
Han Zhang: Any last words? If you explode, I call dibs on your fish.

冷周六：耐心点，我觉得它在努力了。
Hissabeth: Have some patience. It's doing something.

她甩了甩这枚软盘，但当她停下动作时，软盘依然在轻微地摇晃。
She shakes the disk once or twice, but when she stops, it continues to tremble—

——剧烈地摇晃。
—violently.

整间办公室似乎都跟着发起抖来，生态缸里的鱼不安地来回游动。
The entire office begins to rattle along with it. The fish in the eco-tank dart anxiously.

冷周六：哈，很遗憾，我觉得可能不会有幸存的鱼。
Hissabeth: Bad news: I don't think any of those fish are gonna survive.

冷周六：祝我一路顺风——！
Hissabeth: Wish me a safe journey!

在会议室的地面开始起伏之前，监测器灵活地退到了走廊上的安全地带。
Before the floor starts to ripple, the monitor scoots itself out into the hallway for safety.

北方哨歌也猛地贴紧了墙壁，试图稳住身体。
抬头时，她发现磁流体的玻璃外壳在震动，内容物摇晃着散开成许多小颗粒。
Windsong slams her back against the wall to steady herself. Looking up, she sees Ulrich's glass tank vibrating, its contents scattering into tiny particles.

北方哨歌：乌尔里希，我简直能听到你头脑风暴的声音——
Windsong: I can hear you brainstorming, Ulrich. It's oddly literal.

乌尔里希：……！……，……！
Ulrich: ...! ..., ...!

玻璃破碎声使北方哨歌多瞧了几眼旁边的同事，确认磁流体仍然好端端地待在外壳里。
The sound of shattering glass immediately has Windsong turn to her colleague, confirming that Ulrich is still secure inside his case.

造成动静的是从半空中坠落的鱼缸，以及——
The noise appears to have come instead from a fish tank falling and—

冷周六：嘿，各位小心！
Hissabeth: Hey, watch out!

北方哨歌：我得说实话，冷周六，打个招呼用不上这么大的排场。
Windsong: You know, Hissabeth, there's gentler ways to make an entrance.

冷周六：我——听——不——清——！
Hissabeth: I—can't—hear—you!

无论是耳机里还是眼前的话语声都相当模糊，似乎随着空间的移动被撕扯得变形。
The voices around her, whether in her headset or her ears, are garbled, twisted by the movement of space.

研究员在半空中调整好了姿态，稳当地落在会议桌上。
Midair, Hissabeth adjusts her posture and lands squarely on the meeting table.

不提那条从石头鱼缸里飞出来的倒霉小鱼，这个见面招呼还算不错。
Aside from the poor fish that were flung from their stone tank, it isn't the worst entrance.

躺在地板上的鱼有气无力地拍打着尾巴，远不如落在乌尔里希头顶时精神。
The fish flopping on the floor begin to slow, except the one that has landed fortuitously in Ulrich's tank.

冷周六：可怜的鱼，它肯定没救了。就算我在中途把鱼缸变成石棉石，防止玻璃摔破，也没能防住它被甩出来。
Hissabeth: Poor fish. I attempted to turn my aquarium into a fireproof ceramic to keep it safe, but it looks like it just made it easier to shatter.

冷周六：嗯……？
Hissabeth: Wait ...

提到自己的神秘术，她慌忙低头查看手里向北方哨歌递出的东西。
Mention of her arcane skill triggers a panic. She glances down at the object she'd been handing to Windsong.

它的重量显著增加。这应该是拉普拉斯首块拥有石棉石挂带的工牌。
It's heavier than it should be. This must be Laplace's first ID badge with a ceramic strap.

冷周六：糟糕，没反应过来。
Hissabeth: Uh-oh, I forgot about this.

冷周六：还好不是重要部分！
Hissabeth: Luckily, it didn't affect the card itself.

她眨了眨眼，让神秘术的辉光完全褪去。
She blinks, letting the shimmer of her arcane skill fade.

北方哨歌：这还挺罕见。我会带着它多走走，让大家瞧个稀奇。
Windsong: That's a unique design. Thanks. It might make for a nice conversation piece.

忙着抢救头顶那只可怜生物的磁流体将小鱼放回鱼缸，直起身子。
Ulrich is busy saving the poor fish swimming atop his head, dropping it back into the tank.

乌尔里希：——恭喜你，冷周六女士。
Ulrich: Congratulations, Ms. Hissabeth.

乌尔里希：你的研究成果相当惊人，我必须向你致以真诚的掌声。
Ulrich: Your results appear more than adequate. Indeed, you have exceeded my expectations.

冷周六：这么——这么严肃吗？我的确很高兴，不过——总之还是谢谢您。
Hissabeth: Is that stuffy-office talk for a good job? Merci, all the same.

北方哨歌：我也得说声恭喜。以及，这是不是说明你能保证让我的小学徒平安回到地球了？
Windsong: Congrats! So, does your success here mean my lovely apprentice has a chance to land back on Mother Earth safely?

冷周六：完全可以，虽然这基本上是为了计划临时改进的软盘，还不能推广应用……
Hissabeth: More than a chance now. Though, I'm afraid the adjustments we've made to the process will be impossible to replicate at scale.

“路德维希”：但已经足够说服我了。
"Ludwig": Nonetheless, you've convinced me.

渡鸦乘着它的机械座椅靠近。
The raven rolls toward them on its mechanical perch.

“路德维希”：我同意批准你的延迟撤离申请书。
"Ludwig": Your application for delayed evacuation is approved.

耳机里的欢呼先一步响起，冷周六还在回想刚刚听到的句子。
The cheers in Hissabeth's headset reach her before she's finished processing the words.

冷周六：但我还……没有把它交给您？
Hissabeth: But I haven't even submitted it yet?

“路德维希”： 我的意思是，你现在就可以提交它。
"Ludwig": Well, you may submit it now.

含章鼎： 所以这就是你带着一张支离破碎的申请书返回的原因?
Han Zhang: So, that's why you're back here with that torn-up application form?

含章鼎： 我佩服你们竟然能把它重新拼起来!
Han Zhang: I gotta tell you, it's impressive you managed to piece it back together.

众多目光短暂地聚焦在这张薄薄的、由胶带粘合的、几乎难以辨认清原本字迹的纸张上。
All eyes fall on the thin sheet of paper, held together with tape and barely legible.

冷周六： 好吧，传送过程中还是不适合携带无防护的纸制品。
Hissabeth: At least I learned something from it: Don't teleport paper products without a protective sheath.

库珀花环： 没关系，我们离成功很近了。
Kiperina: We seem so close to success.

库珀花环： 接下来我只需要坚持训练，保持最佳状态，直到发射当天。我明白的。
Kiperina: I will keep training. I need to stay at my best for our launch day.

站在库珀花环身侧的少女轻轻拍了拍库珀花环的肩膀，努力表达自己的意见。
Voyager taps Kiperina on the shoulder, doing her best to express her opinion.

库珀花环： 我明白你的意思。我会注意自己的身体状况的。谢谢你，远旅。
Kiperina: I know. I won't push myself too hard. Thanks, Voyager.

命名日： 也没剩多少时间，你可以适当地多歇一歇。
Name Day: We don't have much time left. Remember to rest too, while you still can.

命名日： 我建议你为了庆祝这次成功，给自己放个短暂的假期，一天也行。
Name Day: You should take a day off. Consider it a celebration of our successful experiment.

库珀花环： 我相信冷周六女士会有接下来的安排……还有很多事得忙。
Kiperina: Actually, I believe Ms. Hissabeth already has plans for me. We still have a lot of work to do.

库珀花环向沉思着的研究员投去询问的眼神。
Kiperina holds her stare on the pondering researcher, expectantly seeking her input.

冷周六： 安排……我是安排了一些重要事项。
Hissabeth: Plans? Yes, that we do.

冷周六： 教会你监测器的使用流程，进行发射前的安全检查，确认传送软盘的最终锁定坐标……
Hissabeth: I need to train you to use the monitor. You will have to confirm the final coordinates on the disk and be able to perform the final safety checks before launching.

冷周六： 噢，对。我这次去取监测器还学到了一个新鲜词，我们也的确有执行它的必要。
Hissabeth: Oh, I think it may be necessary to implement a particular procedure that Ludwig mentioned.

冷周六： “人道主义休假”。
Hissabeth: A "humanitarian vacation."

永恒春天的地方
Where Ever Spring Stays CO-13

1987 米尔内镇上
暴雨前 29 小时
1987, Mirny
29 hours before the "Storm"

普列谢茨克镇，米尔内镇，无论叫什么名字，发射基地周围的镇子面貌都十分相近。
Plesetsk, Mirny—whatever the name, the towns surrounding the Cosmodrome look more or less the same.

小镇街道
Town Street

它们是为附近的研究基地而建的，也会因研究的中止陷入沉寂。
一粒雪在茫茫雪地里并不起眼，它的融化不会有太大的声息。
They were built to support the nearby research facilities and fall silent along with them. A single snowflake goes unnoticed in the vast white, melting into hot breath.

指针： 我来吧，这应该是最后几箱物资了。
Pointer: Allow me. These should be the last boxes.

士兵： 不用，女士。您就告诉我们要搬走哪些就好，大家本来就各有分工嘛。
Soldier: Leave them, miss. Just tell us which ones should be moved, and we'll take care of them. We all got our own jobs to do.

小伙子抢在指针前头弯下腰，动作飞快地把板条箱挨个儿摞进车厢。
The young soldier bends down ahead of Pointer, loading the boxes into the truck one by one with practiced speed.

指针核对着手里的清单，示意他数量无误。倒数第二批物资的装车宣告结束。
Pointer checks the list in her hands and gives a nod—correct quantity. The second-to-last batch of supplies is now loaded.

指针： 你们这些驻军是跟着明天的最后一批人一起走，还是要多留几天?
Pointer: Will you leave with the others tomorrow, or are you staying on until the final evacuation?

士兵： 上头安排我们明天撤离，回到芝诺在附近的基地。
Soldier: Our orders are to evacuate to Zeno's nearest base tomorrow.

士兵： 您呢？我前些时候负责的就是普列谢茨克发射场的人员运输工作，那里应该已经全部撤空了。
Soldier: How about you? We were responsible for escorting the last staff members from the Plesetsk Cosmodrome. That place should be empty now, shouldn't it?

士兵： 您应该比我更清楚，这种大规模的、突发性的撤离行动不常见。
Soldier: An evacuation like this has to be for something big. I'm sure you know better than I do.

士兵： 早点去安全的地方吧，女士。
Soldier: If you can, miss, find somewhere safe, ASAP.

指针： 我打算今晚离开米尔内。所有人安全撤离了，我就走。
Pointer: I'm leaving Mirny tonight, just as soon as I help finish with the evacuation.

指针： 我记得还有几支驻扎在这里的队伍，但没见到那几个熟面孔，他们还好吗?
Pointer: There are fewer troops around now. Have there been any further orders?

士兵： 有些去清除路上的魔精了，您知道附近最近很有些不安分的魔精。
Soldier: Some were sent to clear the roads. There's been more critters blocking the way lately.

士兵：另一些似乎被调去参与更紧急的支援任务，只有我这种新兵留在这儿……
Soldier: I guess the others were assigned to an urgent support mission. So it's just the rookies like me left.

指针：撤离行动太危险，的确不该让新人留下。
Pointer: Evacuations can be dangerous. A job like this shouldn't be left to new recruits.

士兵：瞧您说的，我倒是嫌这里太安稳——但我得服从命令。
Soldier: You think so? Honestly, I was hoping for a little challenge. But we're soldiers, we follow orders.

他打开车门，伴随着发动机的轰鸣，轮胎下扬起一蓬细密的雪粉。
The engine roars to life, sending up a small flurry of snow from its undercarriage.

士兵：用不用我捎上您?
Soldier: Do you need a lift?

指针：不了，我去看看撤离人员情况如何。
Pointer: Thanks, but I'm going back to check on the evacuation. Be safe.

车辆沿着路面碾出的泥泞道路驶远，指针选择了与它相反的方向。她往镇子更深处走去。
The truck disappears down the slush-covered road carved through the snow. Pointer heads in the opposite direction, further into the town.

含章鼎：这就是你选的“人道主义休假”地点？一个矿坑?
Han Zhang: So, this is our "humanitarian vacation" here? An open mining pit?

冷周六：当然。
Hissabeth: You've got it.

米尔内矿坑
Mining Pit, Mirny

冷周六：足够近，方便出行，没有不选这里的理由。就是来得好像有点早。
Hissabeth: It's nearby and easy to reach. I can't see a reason why we shouldn't come check it out. The only problem is I got the timing a little off.

冷周六：等一会儿吧。现在不是极光最明显的时候。
Hissabeth: But just you wait, it won't be long now before the aurora shows up.

她朝矿坑远远地掷去一颗小石子。它飞快地滚进夜色，半点踪影都没留下。
She tosses a pebble toward the pit. It vanishes into the dark.

冷周六：给拉普拉斯和基金会都招揽了新成员，捣鼓出了有点用处的传送软盘，再顺利拿到数据……
Hissabeth: We've recruited a great team from Laplace and the Foundation and worked out the kinks of our teleport disk. If we can just manage to collect some useful data ...

冷周六：仔细想想，大伙儿还真是前途光明。
Hissabeth: Our future could be brighter than any aurora.

命名日：友情提醒，赌博有风险。
Name Day: I hate to be negative at a time like this, but this is still a big gamble.

冷周六：也算赌对了，你不是为了好前途留下的吗？这些总能够你拿个调任通知了。
Hissabeth: But we won big today. Didn't you join us to bring about a better future? Just think, our achievements on this project could pave the way to a promotion or at least a transfer.

命名日：别套我的话——这个节骨眼上大家进入坦白环节可不吉利，就像作品里常见的坏结局预警。
Name Day: Don't try to butter me up with promotion talk. Anyway, it's bad luck to talk like that right before a mission. Worse than bad luck—it's cliche.

命名日： 一群原本不相关的人莫名其妙聚在一起，干一件不被支持的大事，在中途忽然分享自己的过去。
Name Day: Strangers coming together to do great deeds, risking mortal peril for the good of humanity. Now, just before the climax, we'll start talking about our motivations and backstories.

命名日： 紧接着他们的故事就会急转直下，编剧随机抽取一位倒霉鬼干掉。剩下的人只能回忆永不复返的“最好的日子”。
Name Day: All to give the story a twist: when someone bites it in the last act, and then the whole gang is haunted by their last moments of peace together.

含章鼎： 这个我懂！有种理论能解释事物的潜在联系，叫什么——对，量子纠缠。
Han Zhang: Oh, there's a theory about that! What is it called again? Right, quantum entanglement.

含章鼎： 在我老家那边的《易经》里头也有记载，我觉得道理差不多，就是说我们在这里做的事情，总会和远处的另一些事物相关……
Han Zhang: Where I'm from, there's a book called Yijing that has a similar idea, that the things we do are mirrored in faraway places.

转过数个相似的路口，指针终于到达了目的地。
After turning several near-identical corners, Pointer reaches her destination.

一小撮人聚集在街边，当望见她的瞬间，那些冻得发红的脸庞纷纷露出笑容。
A small group of people has gathered by the roadside. The moment they spot her, their wind-chapped faces break into smiles.

指针： 情况怎么样？我过来核对撤离名单。
Pointer: How are things proceeding? I'm here to perform a final check on the evacuation.

镇民： 辛苦您！我们好着呢，随时可以上车。
Resident: It's going well. We're all ready to leave.

镇民： 就是可惜了这些花，本来大伙儿想找找办法，看能不能移到别的地方，但周围——您也知道，都是雪地，都冻得结实……
Resident: It's just these flowers. We thought about planting them somewhere, just so we don't need to carry them, but with the soil frozen over ...

指针： ……花？
Pointer: Flowers?

镇民： 是啊，您之前给我们的那些种子，原本只是这孩子种着玩，没想到却开出了花。
Resident: Yes, you know, from the seeds you gave us. My daughter planted them just for fun, but they really thrived!

穿着厚衣裳的小姑娘把纸箱费力地抱起来，向指针炫耀她心爱的宝贝。几株向日葵在里面骄傲地昂着头。
A little girl bundled in thick winter clothes hoists up her box of treasures to Pointer—several tall potted sunflowers.

孩子： 妈咪说这非常——非常不容易。
Child: Mommy said it's really really difficult.

孩子： 这是一个奇迹！是我，还有大姐姐你一起做到的！
Child: It's a miracle! Miss, but you and I did it together!

指针： 是的……你说得对。但是你要带上它们一起走吗？会很重，一路上也会很累……
Pointer: Yes, I suppose it indeed appears miraculous. But how are you going to take them with you? I think it will be a bit too heavy to carry on the road.

镇民：其余的我们分了出去，留下这几朵，开得最好，就心想还是多费点工夫带上算了。
Resident: We've given away the rest to some of our neighbors. But these are the ones that bloomed the best. It hurts to think we'd just leave them here to die.

镇民：这么冷的天，要讨口饭吃本来就难得很，说要撤离，也不知道能到哪儿去，以后又会怎样。
Resident: It's so cold now, and it's getting hard to find food. We know we have to evacuate soon, but no one has told us where we're going, or what's next.

镇民：但您看，您给我们的这些种子，孩子们照料着，竟然真开花了——还开得这么好。
Resident: Despite all the hardship, these seeds you gave us somehow managed to bloom under my daughter's care. Look, they're absolutely radiant!

镇民：花草都能努力过活，人又怎么能随便泄气呢?
Resident: If even these little flowers are ready to fight to survive, how can we give up?

周围的镇民附和着，小姑娘越发得意地捧好了自己手里的箱子。
The townspeople around her chime in, and the girl beams even brighter, holding the box tight in her arms.

指针：其实……
Pointer: That's true.

她想劝大家把空间与精力分给其他更重要的行李。
She wants to tell them to save their space and energy for more important supplies.

这是北方哨歌给她的种子，应当经过神秘术改良，它也许早就习惯了长在冻土上。
The seeds were a gift from Windsong, likely altered through an arcane skill, perhaps already adapted to grow in permafrost.

但此时此刻，她觉得自己并无权力评判这些花朵之于人们是否有意义。
But at this moment, it doesn't seem right to judge these flowers that hold meaning for others.

指针：谢谢。我没有在这里见过别的花……但它们的确很漂亮。
Pointer: Thank you. I'm not aware of the local species of flowers here, but I'm certain all the same that these are the most beautiful flowers in Mirny.

指针：希望它们能和你们一起去其他地方看看。
Pointer: I hope you can find a way to take them with you.

目送着向日葵的那抹金黄逐渐远去，指针重新踏上街道。
Watching the golden hue of the sunflowers fade into the distance, Pointer steps back onto the street.

她打算检查自己之前停放的车辆，接着简单地巡逻——最后离开，不再回头。
She will check on the vehicle she parked earlier, take one final patrol, and then leave, without looking back.

而米尔内的确是一个足够小的镇子，意料外的相遇在此时有发生。
Yet Mirny is, in fact, just large enough for chance encounters to still occur.

拉普拉斯职员 I：嘿——指针？我没看错吧?
Laplace Staff Member I: Hey, am I seeing things? Pointer?

拉普拉斯制服的冷光在雪地里格外不起眼，指针眯了眯眼睛，这才认出前面招手的人影。
The glint of a Laplace uniform blends into the snow, and she squints until she recognizes the waving figure.

指针：你不是还在假期吗？应该不需要参加协助撤离小组才对，怎么也跑这么远?
Pointer: Oh, hey! Weren't you on vacation? Why are you back here with the evacuation team?

拉普拉斯职员 I： 我看你们人手也不够，反正闲着也是闲着。
Laplace Staff Member I: Well, I had nothing else to do anyway, and we need all the help we can get.

拉普拉斯职员 I： 对了，跟你说个事儿。我前两天才听说路德维希批准了一个小组的延迟撤离申请。
Laplace Staff Member I: Did you hear? There's still a team at Plesetsk. Ludwig even approved a delayed evacuation for them.

拉普拉斯职员 I： 真佩服他们，这个节骨眼上竟然有人不想走！
Laplace Staff Member I: I guess they're planning to stay to the very last moment. Can you believe that?

指针： 路德维希同意了？他们……他们还在发射基地？
Pointer: Ludwig actually approved it? They are going to stay in the Cosmodrome?

这个消息与她预计中的发展截然不同，她惊讶地提高了音量。
The news is nothing like she expected. Her voice rises in shock.

拉普拉斯职员 I： 很不可思议，对吧？不得不说，有勇气的家伙比我想象中要多太多了。
Laplace Staff Member I: Unbelievable, right? That takes a lot of guts. Who would have guessed we had people like that here at Laplace?

拉普拉斯职员 I： 你有空可以去发射基地那边问一声，看那群人会不会在这两天改变主意。
Laplace Staff Member I: If you've got time, maybe you should go check on them, see if you can talk some sense into them.

他想拍拍指针的肩膀，考虑到那些机械零件，半途上又缩回了手。
He aims to pat her shoulder. But considering her mechanical components, he lowers his hand halfway.

拉普拉斯职员 I： 行，我还得去挨个儿清点这条街的屋子，先走了！
Laplace Staff Member I: Anyway, I have a street of houses to check one by one for stragglers, so I've got to get back to it.

拉普拉斯职员 I： 天这么冷，记得注意检查零件，小心它们冻上——回头平安到了分部，我们再聊！
Laplace Staff Member I: Oh. It's freezing cold out there. Don't forget to check the components. I'll catch up with you when we get back to the branch.

指针： ……
Pointer: ...

她原以为路德维希会否决这个荒谬的提案，这个牺牲概率远大于成功意义的任务。
She once hoped that Ludwig would shut down this absurd plan—a mission with far greater odds of failure than achieving any meaningful goal.

但她也早该承认，这群执拗的人为了最终的目标，无论遇到怎样的挫折都不可能放弃。
But she should've known better. Laplace is filled with the most stubborn people imaginable. They would never give up, no matter how many obstacles stand in their way.

“暴雨”将至，她还能做什么？
The "Storm" is coming. What else is left for her to do?

指针看向发射基地的方向，只有一片刺目得令人皱眉的雪白。
Pointer looks in the direction of the Cosmodrome, the buildings obscured by a swirling sheet of white.

含章鼎： 万物都由原子构成，太行如砺，黄河如带，等是尘埃。
Han Zhang: Everything is made of atoms. From afar, Mount Taihang is like a grindstone, the Yellow River is like a belt, and all these things are but dust.

含章鼎： 顺着这个概念说，今天我们能聚在这里，完全是偶然……
Han Zhang: In other words, maybe the reason why we're here is only a complete coincidence.

冷周六：停，停，把话题拉回来。我对太浪漫的说法过敏。
Hissabeth: Hold it, hold it, let's just get back to the topic at hand. I think I'm allergic to poetry.

库珀花环：但他都开头了，可不可以让他继续讲完？我想了解这种说法。
Kiperina: Aww, I want to hear the rest. Would you please let him finish?

冷周六：饶了我吧，我真的受不了。我宁愿进入坦白环节，当然，还是先献祭我的队友。请。
Hissabeth: No way. I think I'd rather take a chance on that lethal backstory cliche. How about you start us off?

小蛇们配合地歪过头，众多视线都落到基金会职员身上。
The little snakes tilt their heads in unison. Every eye lands inquisitively on Name Day.

他敢打赌这是自己最希望挨一记石化神秘术的时刻。
He almost wishes for a petrification spell to hit himself.

命名日：呃，好吧，要问什么？
Name Day: Um, sure. What do you want to know?

命名日：怎么误打误撞加入了这支松散又野心勃勃的队伍？
Name Day: Are you curious about why I chose our loose yet ambitious team?

冷周六：“松散又野心勃勃”，这几个词挑得挺不错。
Hissabeth: "Loose yet ambitious," that's a good description.

冷周六：你自己选的问题，说明你就等着解释这个呢。快点，我懒得听太复杂的说法。
Hissabeth: You brought it up. Now spit it out, and make it simple.

命名日：其实也没什么特别的。而且你们提的计划看起来比较有实践价值。
Name Day: Maybe I shouldn't have oversold it. I just think you have a good plan.

命名日：万一跟着这群人真能做成大事，一不小心拯救了世界呢——大伙儿都很难抗拒这种念头，对吧？
Name Day: What if this works? What if we do this and it changes the world? And I could be a part of that? It's a tempting thought. Don't you think?

命名日：如果可以，我可不想反反复复地看“暴雨”再把哪片熟悉的土地抹掉。
Name Day: I just don't want to see another place I hold dear lost to the "Storm."

冷周六：噢。为了家乡？
Hissabeth: So, you mean it was for your hometown?

命名日：要这么说也行。
Name Day: Yeah, I guess you could say that.

库珀花环：这个时代也有你的家乡吗？
Kiperina: Isn't your homeland still here in this era?

更多时候，库珀花环会选择倾听和等待。她鲜有主动插入对话的时刻。
More often than not, Kiperina chooses to listen and wait. She seldom inserts herself into conversations.

库珀花环：你能接受它们就这么……消失？
Kiperina: Have you just accepted the fact that it will disappear ... again?

基金会职员摇摇头。
He shakes his head.

命名日：这个时代有它自己的图景，和我没太大关系。即使名字相同，消失的东西就是永远消失了。
Name Day: My home isn't in this era. Maybe the names are the same, same old familiar buildings, but nothing that matters to me. What's gone is gone.

命名日：不过没事，我有个便携型“故乡”，仅此一份。
Name Day: Don't feel bad for me though. Now, I have my own "portable hometown."

他竖起手指，敲了敲耳边那枚摇摇晃晃的小装饰。
He raises a finger and taps the little ornament dangling on his ear.

冷周六：原来这不是储备金之类的？我一直以为和海盗的金币耳坠差不多，走投无路可以摘下来换路费。
Hissabeth: Hey, I always figured you kept that around in case you needed some quick cash, you know, like those pirates that had coin earrings.

命名日：哦，我哥把它打上去的时候说弄丢了就会杀掉我。
Name Day: Oh, no. My brother said he would kill me if I gave this away.

命名日：鉴于它的象征意义是“家里最后一个活着的孩子”，假如真丢了，我的家人可能会气得从坟墓里爬出来，如果他们有坟墓。不过必要的时候我肯定会选路费。
Name Day: It's meant to be for "the last living child," a family heirloom of sorts. If I lost it, I think my family would crawl out of their graves and haunt me, if they had graves. Still, if I was in dire need ...

“家人”。这个词唤起了短暂的沉默。
"Family." The word stirs emotions in all those listening.

小宇航员低下头，试图遮掩自己的表情。
Kiperina lowers her head, trying to hide her expression.

远旅：阿涅娅、家？
Voyager: A-Alia, family?

女孩指了指脚下的地面，她尽可能地用学到的词汇回应，尽管含义可能略有偏差。
She points to the ground, doing her best to respond with the words she's learned, even if the meaning is slightly off.

库珀花环：我的家和家人不在这里，他们在乌特恩亚亚，远旅。
Kiperina: No, Voyager, this is not my family. They're in Utrennyaya.

库珀花环：这里的是“朋友”。
Kiperina: These are my friends.

远旅：……朋友。
Voyager: Friends.

她知道这个词，但此前一直认为这是专用于形容库珀花环的音节。
She knows this word, but until now she only used it to describe Kiperina.

对库珀花环而言，这个词则是消解隔阂、卸下防备的标志。
For Kiperina, it's a word that breaks down barriers and opens doors.

库珀花环：就算大家说没关系，说只要有活着的人记住这些就好，对我讲很多道理，我还是没办法想清楚。
Kiperina: You told me that as long as there are living people to remember what has been, that what we're doing will be worthwhile. I've tried to accept that, but I still can't.

库珀花环：会消失的不是一片叶子、一杯水、一点微不足道的存在，是我长大的地方和我认识的人……
Kiperina: What has been ... It's not just an old building or some candy in a store. It's the place I grew up and the people I love that will be taken away.

库珀花环：——这就是生命里的全部内容。这就是我的生活。
Kiperina: It's everything in my life. It is my life.

库珀花环：我知道我应该接受现状，我只是想知道怎么才能——怎么说服自己？
Kiperina: I know I must accept it, that I can do nothing but accept it, but how can I ever accept it?

更长久的沉默。
Another long silence.

会站在这里的每个人都有一个坚持下去的理由，这理由足以支持他们追逐任何看似荒谬的目标。
Everyone standing here has a reason to keep going—reasons strong enough to chase the absurd.

换句话说，这里并没有谁知道问题的答案。
In other words, no one here knows the real answer.

追星星的人
We Who Chase the Stars CO-14

绝大多数情况下，说服自己比说服他人更困难。
The hardest person to convince is often yourself.

察觉到库珀花环的失落，年轻人还是谨慎地开口了。
Sensing Kiperina's disappointment, Name Day finally speaks up.

命名日： 关于这个……
Name Day: About that ...

冷周六： 我不知道。
Hissabeth: I don't know.

如此直截了当的回答让还在思考措辞的职员险些咬到舌头。
The blunt reply causes him to bite his tongue and listen.

冷周六： 我刚听到父母的死讯，就坐上了去拉普拉斯分部的大巴，什么都没来得及想。
Hissabeth: When I heard about my parents' deaths, I was just stepping onto the bus to Laplace. I felt like I had no time to even think about it.

冷周六： 我以为自己完全接受了事实，对没法改变的事情你能做什么呢?
Hissabeth: I guess I mistook that for acceptance. After all, there's nothing I could do to change it.

冷周六： 过了两三个月，我写研究日志的时候不小心摔坏了笔。
Hissabeth: Then about three months later, I broke my pen while writing a research log.

冷周六： 不夸张地说，我哭了整整四十个小时。天哪，感谢当时的舍友没把我拖出门锁在外头。
Hissabeth: I cried for 40 hours. FORTY HOURS. And I'm not exaggerating. I'm grateful my roommate didn't have me committed.

库珀花环： 那是他们留给你的……?
Kiperina: Was it your parents' pen?

“冷周六会哭”这件事也让她颇感震惊，但她会及时掐断自己不够礼貌的念头。
The very idea of Hissabeth crying seems almost impossible to imagine. She cuts off the thought before it turns impolite.

冷周六： 拉普拉斯配发的。如果你需要，每个月都能免费换新，没人会管。
Hissabeth: Nah. Just an ordinary Laplace office pen. They give them out by the box load.

冷周六： 但以前我在家摔坏了什么东西，会被批评不够小心——接着他们再和我一块儿选新的。
Hissabeth: But back home when I broke something, my parents would tease me for being careless, and then we would find a new one together.

冷周六： 你根本没法真的说服自己，你只能不去想它，或者找很多理由。
Hissabeth: You can't really accept a thing like this. The only thing you can do is put your pain aside and find something to do with yourself.

冷周六： 像缠胶带球那样一点点裹起来，当你忙着考虑胶带要怎么卷，其实也就分心了。慢慢地就会看上去好点。
Hissabeth: Even if it's just making a ball of tape. Just wrap a ball, round and round, over and over, until you've forgotten what it even looked like inside.

库珀花环： 我会试试这个方法。
Kiperina: Maybe that is something I can try.

小宇航员郑重地点头。
The little astronaut nods solemnly.

冷周六： 这是过来人的经验之谈。小孩子总爱想这个，弄掉了作业本就会觉得人生到此为止。
Hissabeth: Cool, you should. I'm speaking from my experience. You know, when you're young, everything bad seems like the end of the world. Forgetting your homework might as well be the apocalypse.

的确如此。职员把用于缓和气氛的话都咽了回去。
She's right. Name Day swallows the words he had meant to use to lighten the mood.

在出发前他听过类似的问题。他也问过自己类似的问题。
He's heard enough of them before. He's even asked himself the same.

阿夫西维： 你要回家看看吗?
Avgust: Are you going home, Mr. Raccoon?

命名日： 不，只是去出任务。
Name Day: No, I'm heading out for a mission.

阿夫西维： 维拉说，外边是一个你们都很熟悉的时候。但你们都不打算回去。
Avgust: Vila said it's a time that you're familiar with, but that you didn't ever plan on going back.

阿夫西维： 我知道维拉住到来亚什基之前也有一个家。你来基金会之前肯定也有。
Avgust: I know Vila had another home before she moved to Rayashki. You must have one too!

阿夫西维： 那是什么样的地方？也下雪吗?
Avgust: What was it like? Does it snow there?

命名日： 会下雪。雪把白桦枝干压低，也会把野兔和其他动物的足迹盖住。
Name Day: Yes. It snowed there, so much that it made the trees sag and covered up your footprints as soon as you walked past.

命名日： 沃尔霍夫河结冰的时候，我和妹妹就砸开冰面钓鱼。
Name Day: When the Volkhov froze over, my sister and I would go and fish from holes we cut in the ice.

阿夫西维： 帕索诺从冰上掉下去过，他有好几个星期没来上学。
Avgust: Comrade Pasono once fell in the ice doing that. We didn't see him at school for weeks.

命名日： 确实很危险。
Name Day: Playing on the ice can be dangerous, little Avgust.

传说里溺水的少女会变成鲁萨尔卡。他向维拉验证过，这只是个传说。
Legend has it that girls who drown become Rusalki. He asked Vila once, and she confirmed it was only a myth.

大部分故事都是如此。在流传的过程里被过度加工。
Most stories are like that, heavily embellished in the retelling.

为了和仍在思考的小男孩对话，或者为了控制浮起的回忆，他蹲下身，脑袋差不多和那朵向日葵平齐。
To hold the boy's drifting thoughts or rein in his own memories, he squats down until his head is level with the sunflower.

命名日：不过它已经不存在了。虽然还能在地图上找到，但那不一样。
Name Day: But it's all gone now. No matter the era, even if I went back to that little dot on the map, it would never be the same.

阿夫西维：我知道。就像来亚什基。
Avgust: Like Rayashki.

命名日：……就像来亚什基。
Name Day: Just like Rayashki.

它也只是被“暴雨”剥离了故事的一小块土地。记得的人寥寥无几。
Another patch of land whose story was lost to the "Storm." Remembered only by the few lucky enough to have lived there.

他试图把话题往回拽，以免对话滑往全然无法应付的方向。
He tries to pull the topic back before it veers somewhere neither of them can handle.

命名日：好好活着，很多事情就会突然在某天得到解决。
Name Day: That is why we must stay alive, then things will work out some day.

???：列尼亚，活着比什么都重要。
???: Lyonya, stay alive. That's the most important thing.

???：穿过雪地往我告诉你的方向走，别回头。
???: Keep going. Follow the route I told you. Never look back.

基金会登记员：能独立出外勤任务，差不多就能正式入职了，恭喜你。
Foundation Registrar: Being certified as capable for an independent field mission means you're an official Foundation member. Congrats in advance.

基金会登记员：大部分人都会在申请书上填个代称，也有少数人用真名，这个随你喜欢。但要改起来比较麻烦，你得好好想。
Foundation Registrar: Most people here use an alias, though it's all up to you. Just make sure you pick a good one. It's not easy to change once it's confirmed.

列昂尼德：好的，谢谢您的提醒。
Leonid: I see. Thank you for telling me.

离开家乡的日期与另一个即将被庆祝的日子很接近。
The day he left home came close to another date soon to be celebrated.

就这个。
That's it.

他递出了填好的申请书。
He hands over his application form.

基金会登记员：我看看……好，没问题。
Foundation Registrar: Let me check. Alright, no problem.

基金会登记员：“暴雨”可给大伙儿添了不少麻烦……眼下正缺人手，之后得加油干活儿啊。
Foundation Registrar: The "Storm" has made everyone's life harder here. The Foundation is always in need of more manpower, and in need of honest men like you even more so.

基金会登记员：圣洛夫基金会远东分部欢迎您的加入，命名日先生。
Foundation Registrar: Welcome to the St. Pavlov Foundation Far East Branch, Mr. Name Day.

名字意味着存在。
A name means existence.

地图上找不到的城市，与地图上同名却截然不同的城市，哪种更不可接受?
What is hard to accept? Knowing that your city can't be found on any map, or that city still shares its name but has changed entirely.

他尝试过，自己的神秘术并不能对生命体生效，记忆中稍纵即逝的辉光大概只是错觉。
He's tried before, but his arcane skill doesn't work on living beings. That fleeting glow he remembers is probably just an illusion.

阿夫西维：你在想什么？你想家了吗?
Avgust: You're thinking about something. Missing your home again, yes?

阿夫西维：没关系。维拉说只要认真上课，学好了知识，在哪里都可以重建我们的家。
Avgust: It's okay. Vila said as long as we pay attention in class and keep learning, we will be able to rebuild Rayashki in the future.

阿夫西维：只要每位同志都不忘记！当然，我记得很牢！
Avgust: We will rebuild it as long as each and every comrade keeps that goal in their mind, and I will never forget.

向日葵歪过脑袋。孩子学着自己看过的那样，拍了拍朋友的肩膀，送出一点鼓励。
The sunflower tilts its head. The boy mimics it, then he pats his friend's shoulder, offering a little encouragement.

阿夫西维：加油，浣熊同志。
Avgust: You can do it, Comrade Raccoon.

命名日：非常感谢，阿夫西维同志。
Name Day: Thank you very, very much, Comrade Avgust.

在基金会职员被思考绊住的时候，极光已经铺满了天幕。
Name Day is still lost in thought as the aurora begins to spill across the sky.

它遵循既定的规律，恒常且绚烂，不必依靠某个词语而存在。
It follows its own patterns, constant and resplendent, existing without the need for names.

自然中并没有围绕人类打造的事物。
Nothing in nature is made for humanity.

冷周六：把最好的位置让给你，来，阿涅娅。
Hissabeth: Come here, Alia. You can have the best seat.

库珀花环：其实我已经习惯被叫做库珀花环了。
Kiperina: Oh, I think for now, I'd prefer to be called Kiperina.

她小声咕哝了一句，但还是走到了预留出的位置。
She mutters something more under her breath but still finds herself sitting in the offered spot.

冷周六：抓紧机会，这可是难得的极光爆发。
Hissabeth: Hurry up. You don't get an aurora like this every night.

冷周六：——你的神秘术得依靠里面的高能带电粒子。
Hissabeth: You need those charged particles up there for your arcane skill.

库珀花环：原来我们不只是出来散心……
Kiperina: I thought we were here for a vacation.

冷周六：散心，顺便给你多添一份保障。
Hissabeth: It can be more than one thing. You do need this though.

她找了块合适的石头坐下，顺手帮库珀花环和远旅拍了拍旁边石块上的灰尘。
She finds a suitable rock to sit on and brushes the dust off the stones beside her for Kiperina and Voyager.

冷周六：别太紧张了，在宇宙里散步可比走在钢丝上简单。
Hissabeth: Stay calm. Walking in space is definitely going to be easier than walking a tightrope.

冷周六：宇宙中没有绝对的方向之分，下落同时也能是上升。这取决于你使用的参照体系。
Hissabeth: There's no absolute direction up there. Up or down depends on the reference you choose.

冷周六：简而言之，只要你愿意这么想，往哪走都一样。
Hissabeth: In short, there's no "falling down."

小宇航员认真地点了点头。
Kiperina nods seriously.

库珀花环：明天，后天……后天我就要去亲眼看一看头顶这些星星了。
Kiperina: Tomorrow, no, the day after tomorrow, I'll be up there drifting above the Earth with the stars.

库珀花环：不知道它们摸上去有没有温度。
Kiperina: I wonder if they'll feel warm to the touch.

出于紧张，又或者是因为夜风太冷，她稍微有些发颤。
Whether from nerves or the night wind, she shivers.

冷周六伸出手，连带着远旅一块儿揽过来，三个人挤成一团。
Hissabeth opens her arms wide to pull both girls into a huddle.

库珀花环：以前天气很冷的时候，我会抱着米莎，就是那只我照料的小熊，跟她一起休息。她身上特别暖和。
Kiperina: The night is so cold. Back with the Utrennyaya, on nights like this, I would sneak into the pens and sleep beside Masha—the bear cub I took care of. She was so warm to cuddle.

库珀花环：和现在的感觉很像。抱歉，我并不是想说你们像小动物……
Kiperina: And now I'm here, huddled with all of you. Oh, sorry, I'm not suggesting you remind me of bears.

库珀花环：只是这样很安心。
Kiperina: It just feels safe.

命名日：我明白，那些格外难捱的冬天，得靠兄弟姐妹们捉几条附近的流浪狗，挤在一块儿取暖。
Name Day: There were times, during the coldest winter nights, that my siblings and I would cuddle up with the stray dogs to keep ourselves warm.

含章鼎：我没多少过冬的经验，你们不能直接选择冬眠吗?
Han Zhang: Hold on. You people don't just hibernate through the winter? You're missing out.

从这支小队凑齐以来，他们第一次这样轻松地聊天，谈论与任务无关的内容，提起遥远的过去和生活至今的经历。
This is the first time their little team has sat together without the mission on their minds, chatting instead about past lives and faraway memories.

不知不觉，一点儿困倦悄然涌上库珀花环的脑袋。
Before she realizes it, sleepiness sneaks up on Kiperina.

她站起身，试图摆脱这阵突然袭来的疲惫。冷周六也跟着她站了起来。
She stands to shake off her sudden drowsiness, and Hissabeth rises with her.

冷周六：准备回去吧，别让我们的小宇航员累坏了。
Hissabeth: Alright, we should head back. We don't want our little astronaut to be too tired.

含章鼎：但你还没说过你为什么要坚持到现在呢，别回避话题!
Han Zhang: Hey, you think I don't see what you're doing? You haven't told us your story yet.

含章鼎：我一直都很好奇这个问题，你看起来不像会喜欢数星星的那种人。
Han Zhang: It's been on my mind since I first got here: why would you do all this? You don't strike me as the hopeless dreamer type.

冷周六：是吗？好吧，新的刻板印象又多了一种。
Hissabeth: I don't? Well, I should make more of an effort to match the stereotype.

研究员偏了偏头，恰好把打着瞌睡的小蛇托回肩膀上。
She tilts her head just enough to catch the dozing little snake and nudge it back onto her shoulder.

冷周六：为了了解我们自己从何而来，将如何结束。
Hissabeth: It's not so dreamy though. I just wanna know the answers. Where do we come from and how things will end?

冷周六：这个理由还不够充分吗？对我而言已经足够。
Hissabeth: What? Not convincing enough?

冷周六：或者你想听个更加正式的说法?
Hissabeth: Perhaps you want something more in-depth?

冷周六：之前我和指针快被手上的活儿逼疯，就会抽空过来散个心，她通常这么说——
Hissabeth: Way back when, before all this, Pointer and I were being driven mad by work, we would walk out here and there was something she would say to me.

她稍稍眯起眼，饶有兴致地观察着那片绵延的光幕。
She narrows her eyes, watching the shifting curtains of light with interest.

来自太阳的高能带电粒子，在地球磁场的作用下呈现出肉眼可见的炫目色彩。
High-energy solar particles, shaped by Earth's magnetic field, dance across the sky in colors visible to the naked eye.

几乎可以听见它们微弱而含混的爆裂声。
If you listen closely, you might even hear their faint crackling.

冷周六：有了语言之后，人就能够描绘宇宙何以至此，又何以终结。
Hissabeth: Language is a tool that permits us to describe how the universe was created and how it will end.

冷周六：知晓死亡与短暂，人就开始追求存在的永恒，并思考自身。
Hissabeth: Through it, we reflect on our existence. In order to understand eternity, we must first understand death and impermanence.

轻轻晃了晃脑袋后，她重新找回了平时略微散漫的语气。
After a small shake of her head, she regains her usual casual tone.

冷周六：这可是我学指针说话学得最像的句子——每个见过的同事都这么夸我。
Hissabeth: What do you think? Good impression of her, non? Everyone says it's my best.

天幕上高悬的极光回望着地面的人群。
绚丽的光线落下，模糊了雪地与天空的交界，也令每个人的表情都变得朦胧不清。
The aurora hanging high above the sky shines down at the people below. Brilliant beams fall, blurring the edge between snow and sky and softening every expression into something unreadable.

冷周六的声音像是从远处传来。
Hissabeth's voice feels like it's coming from far away.

冷周六：明天很可能是“暴雨”前的最后一天空闲时间了。对了。你们有没有想过这个问题——
Hissabeth: Tomorrow might be our last free day before the "Storm." I guess it's fitting then to ask the age-old question:

冷周六：如果明天是生命中最后一天，该去做点什么？
Hissabeth: If tomorrow was the last day of your life, what would you do?

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Cabinet of Wishes 小径

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Defeat death. Marry Anastasia. Witness history.

告别时刻
Time to Say Goodbye CO-15

1987 普列谢茨克发射基地
暴雨前 17 小时
1987, Plesetsk Cosmodrome
17 hours before the "Storm"

小宇航员站在厚重的防护门前，在识别器上按下指纹。
The little soon-to-be astronaut stands before the heavy blast door and presses her finger against the scanner.

和之前几个月一样，她准时穿过逐渐空荡的走廊，在自己脚步声的陪伴下前往各个训练室。
Just like several months before, she walks the quiet corridor on the way to her training.

库珀花环：只要做好能做的每件事……
Kiperina: Do everything we can, and do my best.

库珀花环：就不会为遗憾所困扰。
Kiperina: Leave no regrets.

库珀花环：希望今天我也能顺利完成训练任务。
Kiperina: That's why I have to finish my training.

在长久地为一个目标努力之后，越是接近结局，就越是紧张。这是无可避免的正常的情绪反应。
The closer she gets to the end, the more the nerves take hold.

因此，她尝试着从平稳而熟悉的日常生活中寻找一些慰藉。
So, she looks for comfort in steady, familiar routines.

一，二，三。
One, two, three.

她在心里完成了计数，防护门也准时向两侧滑开。
She finishes her count silently. Right on cue, the blast doors slide open.

失重感令她安心。与模拟操作、神秘术培训和离心力训练相比，这是她最喜欢的项目。
The weightlessness calms her. Compared to the other simulated operations, arcane skill practice, and centrifuge spins, this is her favorite routine.

走在钢丝上的感觉与此类似，但她眼下不必担心坠落。
It's like walking a tightrope, but without the fear of falling.

没有了重力限制，似乎可触摸的高度也变得无限，世界像一张柔软的绒毯向周围铺展。
With gravity out of the picture, the sky itself feels reachable, the world stretching out like a velvet blanket around her.

如果这是我生命中的最后一天。
If this is the last day of my life,

怎样证明我曾在世界上拥有过生命呢？依靠名字，经历，记忆？
how can I prove that I was here in this world? With my name, my memories?

我记得，他们这样称呼我。
I remember what they called me:

阿丽娜·梅德韦杰娃。小熊一样的女孩儿。
Alina Medvedeva. The girl like a bear.

我们得给你起个在马戏团表演用的名字。
You must have a proper stage name for your performance.

科兹洛夫：“库珀花环”。
Mr. Kozlov: "Kiperina."

科兹洛夫：这个名字怎么样？是娜塔莉亚和我一起想的，她最近很迷宇宙探索讲座。
Mr. Kozlov: What do you think? Natalya and I decided on it together. She's a clever one, always reading the latest astrological lectures.

科兹洛夫：据说和天上某个由冰构成的小行星带有关，它长得就像甜甜圈或者蛋糕托，应该也像花环……
Mr. Kozlov: It's from a place in the stars. Kuiper, she calls it, some asteroid belt made of ice.

科兹洛夫：花环，来自宇宙的礼物！
Mr. Kozlov: This is because, to us, you are a gift from the stars!

她被稳当地抱着，高高举起。对孩子而言这就像飞行。
He lifts her high, steady and secure. To a child, it feels like flying.

贴近灯泡与帆布构筑的天空。
So close to a starry sky built from light bulbs and canvas.

科兹洛夫先生……娜塔莉亚女士……
Mr. Kozlov ... Mrs. Kozlov ...

娜塔莉亚：真的连夜就走？我们的时间哪有这么值钱……我们去求一求那位拉普拉斯的女士，就晚一两天撤离，找机会和阿涅娅见一面，也不要紧吧？
Natalya Kozlov: We're leaving tonight? Why all the rush? Let's wait one day later, or maybe two. Why don't we ask that Laplace lady to see Alia again?

科兹洛夫：也不好给别人添麻烦。而且这么多人都要走，把整座镇子都撤空了，肯定是因为什么大事。
Mr. Kozlov: I am sure she is too busy. But look, everyone's leaving town! Something must be happening.

他随手指了指远处，街道尽头是安稳而寂静的夜色。
He gestures to a place out in the distance, the dimly lit Cosmodrome barely visible against the night sky.

科兹洛夫：还好我们把阿涅娅提前送到了安全的地方。没听镇上的人说吗？就算世界末日到了，拉普拉斯的大楼也倒不了——
Mr. Kozlov: She'll be safe there. Didn't you hear them say that? Laplace's building will be the last to fall, even if the whole world comes to an end.

科兹洛夫：我们努力活久点，你以后多留意来看演出的观众，说不定哪天就看到阿涅娅坐在台下，端端正正的，给你拼命鼓掌。
Mr. Kozlov: What we must do then is keep ourselves safe. That way, some day in the future, we will have the chance to see her again, sitting in the audience, clapping for us, until her hands are red.

娜塔莉亚：你说得好听，真就一点也不挂念她？
Natalya Kozlov: My big bear wants to pretend he doesn't have a heart. I know you miss her as much as I do.

科兹洛夫：我不是在做规划吗！我们回去把木头牌子修一修，为她多加一个圆圈儿在角落里，就像宇航员的头盔，怎么样？
Mr. Kozlov: Of course, but I must stay in control of myself. Maybe we can put something on the signboard—a circle, like her space helmet.

科兹洛夫：乌特恩亚亚的招牌可是从我爷爷那辈就没改过！还是头回破例！
Mr. Kozlov: You know that signboard hasn't been changed since my grandfather was the ringmaster. What a change it will be!

娜塔莉亚正皱着眉对付行李上的绳结，听到这句话，忍不住重新直起身子。
Natalya frowns as she struggles with the knots on their luggage, but straightens up when she hears the comment.

娜塔莉亚：光一个圈儿有什么好看的，就不能照着画册描几颗星星、几艘飞船上去？回了莫斯科，我头一件事就干这个。你记得留个地址，往后好给她寄东西。
Natalya Kozlov: Yes, yes, and we will add some stars and spaceships. I'll paint them on once we're set up in Moscow. Oh, and don't forget to take down their address so we can send things to her.

科兹洛夫：留了，留了！阿涅娅走了，你倒是开始琢磨这些零碎事情。以前也不见你们关心小事儿……
Mr. Kozlov: You think I didn't do that the minute we came here? Natalya, you're showing so much concern. What happened to my carefree circus wife?

娜塔莉亚：能怎么办呢？事总得有人做。
Natalya Kozlov: It's just that there is nothing else I can do.

她拍了拍手边的包裹，那里面有几只仔细收好的玩偶，和一套清洗干净的演出服。
She pats the package beside her—a few neatly wrapped dolls and a set of freshly cleaned costumes.

娜塔莉亚：大伙儿都不在身边，谁还看顾她，关照她……
Natalya Kozlov: We've always been there for her. Now she's alone and far from us, who will care for her now?

科兹洛夫：但我们可没法永远陪着她。
Mr. Kozlov: *sigh* It is how it must be. We cannot be there for her forever.

科兹洛夫：这份活计可干不长久。
Mr. Kozlov: You can't do this your whole life.

科兹洛夫：来看空中飞人表演的观众，想看到飞行的轻快，也期待看见失手坠落。
Mr. Kozlov: Audiences come to watch an acrobat fly, but they also come to see if they will fall.

科兹洛夫：重要的是，走在一根钢丝上，这样的情景在日常生活中基本不存在。
Mr. Kozlov: Most people would never dare to walk on a tightrope.

科兹洛夫：马戏团就是贩卖梦想和刺激的营生。
Mr. Kozlov: They pay to see people do the thrilling things that they would never do themselves.

科兹洛夫：一辈子吃这口饭可不行。遇到好机会，我还是希望你们能用更安全的法子过活。
Mr. Kozlov: But it is a dangerous business. I often wish that you will one day find a safer way to live than this.

走在地面就是安全的生活吗?
Is walking on the ground really any safer?

一辈子的时间又是多长呢?
How long will my life be?

八岁，十岁，十五岁，要往后数到多少才算数?
Eight years, ten years, 15 years? What's next? When will it end?

冷周六：“时间”是不会被数尽的，它只是个概念，有许多种解释方法。
Hissabeth: Time never ends. It's a concept, and there are many explanations for it.

冷周六：如果整个宇宙都由粒子构成，那么我们的思维就能够被推算，任何事情的发展也都是如此。
Hissabeth: One suggests that since the whole world is made of particles, including our brains, then our minds too can be calculated, so that everything that's happening or about to happen can be predicted.

冷周六：宇宙爆炸的瞬间，一切就被摆放在其中，过去、现在、未来，像一锅奶油饺子汤。
Hissabeth: Past, present, future. All that ever was, and is, and ever will be, was destined from the moment the universe began. Each moment like a knot on a string that's already been tied.

冷周六：我们只能沿着线性的时间往前走，就像走在钢丝绳上。
Hissabeth: Our lives just moving along a fixed track from birth to death.

冷周六：但如果从“经历即存在”的角度而言，没有发生在当下的事情就都缺少真实感受，近乎不存在。
Hissabeth: Then there is another, the theory that none of this is really happening at all, that all perception is illusion. Only the present exists, and only for as long as we're experiencing it.

冷周六：这是两种观点，我更支持前者。
Hissabeth: If you asked me to choose, I prefer the first one.

库珀花环：我不太喜欢奶油饺子汤。我还是喜欢正在发生的事。
Kiperina: It's not like a tightrope then. When I walk on the rope, I don't see past and future. I only feel what is happening right now.

库珀花环：比如这些光让我的手掌发烫，但很暖和。而石头摸起来是冰冷的。
Kiperina: For example, these lights make my palms feel hot and warm. But the stones beneath me are cold.

冷周六：噢，听上去你是支持真实体验的那派。
Hissabeth: Cool, sounds like you favor the second theory.

冷周六：不过无论支持哪种观点，都不得不面对一个事实。
Hissabeth: But it doesn't matter which side you're on. There's one thing both have in common.

冷周六：——我们的存在其实相当短暂。
Hissabeth: Our existence—whatever you make of it—is just a fleeting moment in time.

库珀花环：如果每个人都融入更大的存在，或许就能在时间的绳索上多拥有一些长度。
Kiperina: But those countless moments string together into eternity.

库珀花环：我很渺小。乌特恩亚亚会更大一点儿。然后是城市，国家，星球，星系……
Kiperina: I'm small to the universe, just a person, but I'm a part of Utrennyaya, which is bigger than myself. We belong to a people, a country, a planet, and a galaxy.

库珀花环：或许，变成一粒能被定位坐标的灰尘，在宇宙中有一个位置，就能和宇宙分享它的永恒。
Kiperina: Maybe that's how we share in eternity, by existing as part of it. Each one of us, no matter how small, takes part in creating the universe.

研究员略感惊讶地睁大眼睛，但很快就恢复到往常愉快的笑容。
The researcher widens her eyes in brief surprise but just as soon returns to her usual confident and breezy smile.

冷周六：对，就是这样。
Hissabeth: You got it.

冷周六：宇宙的规律足以说明许多东西。明白它的运转，不需要谎言和奇迹也能活下去。
Hissabeth: When we learn all the rules that govern our universe, we'll be able to predict all that is to come. We'll be able to survive without superstition and fear of the unknown.

活下去。既简单又困难的目标。
Survive. That's easier said than done.

如果我明天没有成功……
If we fail tomorrow ...

“暴雨”会把一切都冲刷掉，这些存在都会消失，宇宙里不再有我的坐标。
The "Storm" will wash away all that we've done here, everything I've ever known.

所有记录都只留在那段录像里，他们可能会把它收藏进某个无人问津的铁皮柜子。
The only trace of it will be that recording, stuffed away in some dusty cabinet in the Foundation.

——即使这样，我也希望他们提起我的时候，会指一指头顶的天空，然后这样说……
Even so, I hope one day, when they mention me, they will look up at the sky and say:

“有一位勇敢的小宇航员到过那里。”
"A brave young astronaut walked among the stars."

无关于科兹洛夫先生对“阿涅娅”的要求，
也无关于朋友们对“库珀花环”的期待。
It's not about Mr. Kozlov's wishes for Alia, nor about her friends' expectations for Kiperina.

这是阿丽娜·梅德韦杰娃自己的选择。
And she, Alina Medvedeva, made the choice to go herself.

娜塔莉亚回到帐篷里取最后的几箱衣物，科兹洛夫则忙着用麻绳固定行李。
Natalya returns to the tent to retrieve the last few boxes of clothes, while Mr. Kozlov is busy tightening the ropes on the luggage.

东西实在很多，他努力拽紧绳索，把库珀花环留下的玩偶安全地系在包裹里，随口嘀咕着刚才没讲完的话。
There's a lot to pack. He tugs hard at the rope, tying the dolls Kiperina left behind safely onto a bundle, muttering the rest of what he didn't get to say earlier.

科兹洛夫：孩子们总会长大的，我们也总会死的。给阿涅娅找个更好的去处，也该放心了。
Mr. Kozlov: Children grow up, adults grow old, and then we die, so what's the use in worrying? All that matters is our Alia will be safe.

指针： 您还在这儿？我以为您会更早些走，越晚越容易遇见麻烦。
Pointer: Mr. Kozlov? You should have already left. The longer you wait to leave, the more dangerous it will be.

科兹洛夫吃了一惊。他并不擅长和研究员们打交道，更没想到会在深夜的街道突然碰面。
The man is startled. He's not good at dealing with researchers, and he never expected to run into one on the empty streets so late at night.

科兹洛夫： 难道情况有变动……？这，我们已经收拾好了，立刻就能离开……您看……
Mr. Kozlov: Is-Is there something wrong then? We are ready to go, as-as you can see. We're all packed up.

他局促地指了指身后垒起的箱子，语气近乎恳求。
He motions to the stacked boxes behind him, his tone on the brink of pleading.

指针： 没事的，一切照常，您向外面的士兵出示通行证就好。雪一时半会儿不会停，路上得多小心。
Pointer: No. Nothing to be concerned with for now. But we need you to follow the evacuation notice for your safety. Keep your passes with you. You may need to show the soldiers on the road ahead. And please take care. The snowfall is getting heavier.

科兹洛夫： 那就行，那就行。不过，我能不能再多问一句——
Mr. Kozlov: Sure, sure. But if you don't mind my asking ...

科兹洛夫： 阿涅娅还好吗？她的身体情况如何，训练表现怎么样？我倒不担心她不够认真，就是怕她努力得过了头……
Mr. Kozlov: Is Alia alright? How is she? How's her training? Sorry, it's just ... I know that she's a good girl, but I'm afraid she'll push herself too much. She's always been so diligent.

指针： 她一切都好。库珀花环是个很坚韧的孩子，我很佩服她能有这样的意志。
Pointer: You have nothing to worry about. Kiperina is a very disciplined and intelligent young woman. We've been most impressed with her work.

指针： 我个人认为她在拉普拉斯会有很不错的前途。
Pointer: I believe that she could have a very promising future with Laplace.

中年人脸上的疲惫消退了许多，他找回了一点儿身为团长的得意神采。
The fatigue on his face eases a bit, and some pride returns to him—the pride of a ringmaster.

科兹洛夫： 我就知道这孩子能行！
Mr. Kozlov: Promising! I knew it. My Alia is a promising candidate for Laplace!

科兹洛夫： 刚在摩尔曼斯克捡到她那会儿，她还是个裹在被子里的娃娃。谁知道现在都这么有出息喽……
Mr. Kozlov: *sigh* When we first found her in Murmansk, she was just an orphaned babe. And now, see how wonderful she has become.

指针： 嗯，时间总是眨眼就过去了。
Pointer: I believe I understand. Time really does fly, doesn't it?

科兹洛夫： 多亏您肯跟我说说她的情况。我都不好意思去看她，怕打扰她，又怕见个面会舍不得。要是我没忍住哭出来，可就丢人丢大了。
Mr. Kozlov: Thank you for telling me about her. I've wanted to pay her a visit, but I don't want to bother her, and I also don't think she wants to see an old man cry.

科兹洛夫： 算了，都没事儿了，知道她过得好就行……您忙吧，我不打扰您了。
不过这时候您怎么还往镇子里边去呢？
Mr. Kozlov: But if you say she is doing well, this is enough for me. But I must ask, miss. Why are you still in town? Aren't you going to be busy with the launch soon?

指针顺着他的目光望向街道尽头，沉沉的夜色里，雪花打着旋儿落下。
Pointer follows his eyes as he casts a look down the street. Bright fluorescent lights illuminate snow that swirls as it falls.

科兹洛夫肩上的雪无声地融化，指针肩头覆着一层薄薄的白色，像是凝结的时间。
The snow falls on both of their shoulders. It melts on Mr. Kozlov, but it settles in layers on Pointer's metallic frame.

指针： 我回来看看有没有落下的东西。
Pointer: I'm here to see if we missed anything.

奶油饺子汤
What's About Time CO-16

1987 米尔内镇上
暴雨前 14 小时
1987, Mirny
14 hours before the "Storm"

灯光冲淡了少许寒意，也为空置的桌椅增添了一点儿生活气息。
The lighting softens some of the chill, adding a touch of life to the empty tables and chairs.

中年人从柜台后伸出手，推过冒着热气的杯子和盛得满满当当的小瓷碟。
The owner reaches out from behind the counter, pushing over a steaming cup and a small porcelain plate packed to the brim with gingerbread.

餐馆老板： 您看这个时间，正好我快收拾好东西，明天就跟车队走了。
Restaurant Owner: Sorry, miss, but we've already packed everything away. I'm leaving on the last truck tomorrow morning.

餐馆老板： 要是昨天或者今天再早点，我还能请您吃一顿！现在真是找不出啥。
Restaurant Owner: There was still some fresh food around yesterday, but today I've got nothing.

餐馆老板： 喏，烧壶热水是没什么问题，还有点姜饼，看着填肚子吧。
Restaurant Owner: All I can offer you is a mug of boiled water and some gingerbread.

指针： 足够了。有吃的就好。
Pointer: That will be enough. Thanks.

小镇的大多数人都已经离开。她这趟过来耽搁得有些晚，只剩这家餐馆还亮了盏灯。
She got here a little late. This is the last place in town with a light on.

老板翻找半天，凑出一桶泡面和一些自制点心。
The owner rummages around for a while and manages to find a bucket of instant noodles and some other homemade treats.

她咬了口姜饼，为它的好滋味发出赞叹。
She bites into a gingerbread cookie, the soothing spice and sweetness lingering on her sensors.

指针： 很不错。
Pointer: Wow. This gingerbread tastes amazing.

餐馆老板： 那当然，我家在新莫斯科夫斯克。我和您朋友说过，您不经常来，估计没听到。
Restaurant Owner: You bet. I'm originally from Novomoskovsk. We're famous for it. I think I told your friend the story last time she was here.

餐馆老板： 好几个朋友都比我走得还远些，去和冻土打交道。我呢，打以前就不擅长对付煤矿。幸好从家里的餐馆学点手艺，也能活下去！
Restaurant Owner: I'm no good with hammers or rocks, but I know food, and the miners always work up a healthy appetite.

餐馆老板： 但我做姜饼没拉伊莎好。她家是真有过间烘焙工坊。餐馆能开下去，主要也靠我的嘴皮子。
Restaurant Owner: My friend, Raisa, makes much better gingerbread than I do. Sometimes I think the only reason people eat here is for the conversation, heh heh ...

餐馆老板： 这边比较荒，天也冷，大伙呢也没啥好做的。我就陪大家多聊几句解个闷……
Restaurant Owner: The winter chill keeps everyone huddled inside. So, what else can you do but talk the long nights away?

指针： 有个人说说话确实很好。不过您怎么留到最后一批才走?
Pointer: It is good to have someone to talk to. Still, I'm curious why you decided to stick around until the last minute.

餐馆老板： 我也没要紧事。不知道撤离是为啥，但肯定让忙的人和年轻人先走，他们也安全些。
Restaurant Owner: I'm in no rush. No one's bothered to explain why it is we have to evacuate, so I'll let all the young folks with something to live for get out first.

餐馆老板： 对了，我想和您打听件事……
Restaurant Owner: Could I ask you a question as well?

指针： 您说吧。不过我也很久没关注外头的情况，不一定清楚。
Pointer: Sure, but I can't guarantee I'll have an answer.

餐馆老板： 要是您也不知道，我大概是再找不到人问了。拉伊莎在的那个小镇，我忘了名字，但我记得也是个有矿的地方。也有你们这样的大人物过去。
Restaurant Owner: It's only that my friend lived in a town a lot like this, a mining town. They had their own big shots running things there too.

餐馆老板： 她有两三年没来过信，我想问问看，是出事了，还是像米尔内一样撤空，换了地方?
Restaurant Owner: In her last letter, she told me that those big shots were talking about evacuating them. Then, nothing. It's been years, and I haven't heard from her since.

多么熟悉的描述。
The description seems eerily familiar.

赶在她说出某个地名之前，老板摇了摇头。
Before she can say the name of the town, the owner shakes his head.

餐馆老板： 算了，您要是知道，也不会费劲琢磨这么久。
Restaurant Owner: Forget it, miss. It's a small town. I doubt you or anyone knows what really happened there.

餐馆老板： 唉，其实我就想知道她是不是还活着……活着就总会碰到的。
Restaurant Owner: *sigh* I often wonder where she is now, or if she's even alive, but I hope that I will see her again some day.

指针： ……
Pointer: ...

这样的问题注定得不到答案。她想起的那座镇子也已永远消失。
It's the kind of question that can't be answered. The town she's thinking of no longer exists.

但她相信人需要信念的支撑。为此可以有善意的谎言。
But she believes people need something to believe in.

指针： 我确实不清楚。但没见过和这样的小镇有关的伤亡报道。
Pointer: Sorry, I really don't know.

指针： 很可能也是和米尔内类似的大规模撤离。她说不定也正担心你，安顿下来后或许还能联系上。
Pointer: Perhaps they did evacuate, but relocation can be complicated. It can take years. Maybe you'll hear from her again when she settles down.

餐馆老板： 好，好，至少我放心些。今晚能睡个好觉。
Restaurant Owner: Yes, that's true. These things take time. Well, at least I can sleep at night.

老板转身继续去收拾他的行李，桌边只剩下她一个人。
The owner turns back to his packing, leaving her alone.

她打量着这间餐馆。橱柜顶上的花瓶里插着一支稍稍垂头的花儿，色彩金黄。
She takes a moment to examine the restaurant. In the vase atop the cabinet, a flower droops slightly, its color a bright golden yellow.

指针： 这儿也有向日葵。
Pointer: Sunflowers.

随意送出的、本以为无用的种子，现在竟在各个角落开出了花朵。
The seeds given away so casually, like they meant nothing, are now blooming in corners everywhere.

橱柜里还有尚未收起的食材，密封袋和罐头各自占据了一小部分地盘。
There are still some ingredients on the shelves that haven't been packed, sealed bags and cans each occupying a small space.

指针： 真空冷冻……苹果。还有……
Pointer: Freeze-dried apples, and ...

指针试图辨认那些包装袋上的字样，但并没取得什么成效。
She attempts to scan their descriptions, but in the poor lighting, it's a lost cause.

餐馆老板： 哦，那都还没来得及打包。米尔内这么远，路上又冷，很多食物还没送过来都冻坏了——尤其蔬菜水果之类的东西。所幸有这些配给，不至于路上饿坏。
Restaurant Owner: Oh, I forgot to pack those. It's amazing, isn't it, when you think about it? Even here in the far north, we can get fresh fruit and vegetables.

餐馆老板： 送货的人说，这些技术都还没普及开，是上过天的技术，只能在米尔内吃到。哈哈，我们也算是享受到高科技了。
Restaurant Owner: I guess this technology was invented to make food for cosmonauts, but now people in Mirny get to enjoy it too! The benefits of science, heh heh.

餐馆老板： 您如果需要，也可以拿一些走，我带不走太多的。
Restaurant Owner: You can take some if you'd like. I have no room for them.

指针看着橱柜中的食物，一时有些失神。
Pointer stares at the freeze-dried food on the shelf, momentarily dazed.

此前曾为之努力过的、被认为缺少价值的研究，竟然也在不知不觉中走入了人们的生活。
The research she once worked hard on, once thought meaningless, had found its way into daily life.

指针： 没事，我就不用了。您已经帮了我很多忙了。
Pointer: Thank you. I'll be fine with just this. You've actually already helped me out a lot.

她撕开泡面的包装袋。
She tears open the instant noodle packet.

指针： 没有蔬菜包，哈……
Pointer: No veggie packets, hah.

指针： 人倒霉起来还真是走两步路都会摔一跤。几率这么小的事全让我碰见了。
Pointer: Can my day get any worse?

冷周六： ……所谓的“基础的”“有应用价值”的技术又不会凭空出现。
Hissabeth: They act as if all of their essential and valuable consumer technology just popped up out of nowhere!

冷周六： 航天工程没有用？随便说个简单的——他们吃泡面会没有蔬菜包！
Hissabeth: To think that aerospace engineering has less to contribute than their other projects?! S**t! They wouldn't even have vegetable packets in their instant noodles without us!

近在身边的事物，坚实可靠、质地清晰。毫无疑问地彰显着存在。
Things close by, solid and clear in texture. Undeniable proof of existence.

她一向看重真实可感的一切。
She has always valued what can be felt and touched.

指针： 搞什么，我从来不信什么占卜、预兆和命运。
Pointer: Come on, pull yourself together, Pointer. We don't buy into karma.

指针： 该死的巧合。
Pointer: This is only another damn coincidence.

你愿意面对多大的风险？
What price are you willing to pay for that answer?

指针： ……
Pointer: ...

这可能是她做过最不理智的决定。
This might be the most irrational decision she's ever made.

下定决心后，研究员开始和眼前这桶泡面搏斗。
Having made up her mind, she begins her battle with the bucket of noodles in front of her.

指针： 一丁点儿菜都没有，真难吃。
Pointer: Tastes awful, hmph.

1987 普列谢茨克发射基地
暴雨前 13 小时
1987, Plesetsk Cosmodrome
13 hours before the "Storm"

冷周六： 最后确认。
Hissabeth: Final check.

冷周六： 飞船的情况？
Hissabeth: Spaceship?

含章鼎： 完全没问题，每个零件都合乎标准。燃料装载充足，隔热层用你的新材料完全处理过。
Han Zhang: We've run a full diagnostic check. All components are operational. We're fully fueled, and we even installed that new insulation you invented.

冷周六： 数据监测和通信措施？
Hissabeth: Data monitoring and communication systems?

命名日： 全部正常。备用方案也检查过了，可以做到三秒内响应。
Name Day: Check. All systems are functional, including the backups.

冷周六： 人员情况？
Hissabeth: Astronaut status?

库珀花环：我检查了神秘术量值、各项数据指标、情绪状况，还有宇航服的状态，全部都很好。
Kiperina: I'm all checked out too. My arcane skill energy level, physical and mental status, and the integrity of my spacesuit are all within your parameters.

冷周六：让我想想还有没有漏掉的内容……
Hissabeth: Is there anything else we've missed? Anything at all?

她扫视过每个人，最终让目光停落在满脸好奇的女孩儿身上。
She scans each person one by one until settling on the girl with curiosity burning in her eyes.

冷周六：特聘支援人员兼人道主义关怀员。我刚编的头衔。
Hissabeth: Ah, what about our special humanitarian support staff? Maybe we should give her a check too.

远旅：*一段欢快的旋律*
Voyager: *a cheerful tune*

冷周六：好，进入自由时间。三小时后准时在发射室门口集合。
Hissabeth: Alright, dismissed. I'll see you at the launch bay doors in three hours.

冷周六：有事就用通讯器联络，干活去吧。最后关头才是最得仔细注意的时候。
Hissabeth: Now everyone, cool off a bit. We need to decompress before the action starts. Stay in touch via your communicators. I need everyone frosty. We're in the last mile now.

冷周六：我手头也还有些需要检查的内容。
没办法，人手不够，许多小事儿就得格外上心……
Hissabeth: There are still some things left to be checked through. If only we had more help.

伙伴们陆续离开，冷周六的最后一次检查也宣告结束。
As the others trickle out, Hissabeth's final inspection comes to an end.

她打开办公桌的抽屉，将那张躺在角落的卡片塞进口袋，关好了房门。
She opens the drawer of her desk, stuffs the card lying in the corner into her pocket, and locks the door behind her.

积雪被反复踩成泥水，又再次被抹平为白色。指针挑着路走，尽量踩过还未消失的脚印和车辙。
The snow is trampled into muddy slush again and again, then flattened back into white. Pointer steps carefully, trying to follow footprints and tire tracks that haven't yet been covered.

镇子里已经不再有其他人的声音。失去了最重要的装点，米尔内就只剩冰冷的砖瓦、带有刀痕的木头和沾有污渍的招牌。
There are no more voices in the town. Stripped of its adornments, Mirny is now cold bricks, scarred wood, and stained signs.

军靴和车轮曾将它的白天与夜晚碾磨踏实，成为一块厚重的绒布。
Boots and wheels once ground its days and nights into something solid.

马戏团的彩灯、餐馆菜肴的香气、研究员制服的银色和偶尔闪过的灰白格子都曾点缀过它，使它值得被记述。
The circus lights, the scent of food from the restaurant, the silver of the researchers' uniforms, and the occasional flash of gray plaid—all once decorated it and made it worth remembering.

现在它只是一个镇子，地球上千千万万空荡城镇中的一个。
Now it is a nameless ghost town, one of countless others.

指针：白天的米尔内也这么冷。
Pointer: Mirny is so cold even in the daylight.

指针：看这样子，撤离工作还是挺顺利的……
Pointer: At least the evacuation has gone smoothly.

话音刚落，她就注意到不远处店门口的身影。
No sooner has she said this than she notices a figure near the entrance of a shop.

有哪只慌张闯进镇子的魔精遭了殃。处理它的士兵大概时间不够，就让它的身躯留在了雪地里。
Some flustered critter had wandered into the town and met its end. The soldiers likely didn't have time to deal with it properly and left its body in the snow.

野狗们嗅着微弱血腥味跋涉而来，尽力享受这顿美餐。
The wild dogs, drawn by the faint scent of blood, arrive to enjoy a feast.

指针：这也算安全隐患啊。
Pointer: Well, that's a security risk.

她估计好了合适的突袭角度，迈开步子。
She calculates the best angle for a clean attack and starts to move.

指针：跑远点，别回来了。我可没精力陪你们玩捕猎游戏。
Pointer: Scamper off and don't come back. I don't have time for another round.

鞋底的血凝成冰渣，她踩过的路面留下一串不算清晰的暗红色脚印。
The blood on her soles has been mixed with the snow, forming into icy red shards. Behind her, a trail of murky prints leads off across the snow.

就像系在树上指引道路的红布条，这抹红色蜿蜒向昨晚停车的角落。
Like red ribbons tied to trees marking a trail, this crimson path winds toward where the vehicle had been parked last night.

指针：搞不清楚究竟还剩多少时间。
Pointer: I don't really know how much time I have left at all.

指针：那个“暴雨”预测也只是靠神秘学能量波动来预估，说不定是其他原因导致的，最后压根没事。
Pointer: These "Storm" predictions are based on fluctuations in arcane energy levels. There's even a chance that this won't be the "Storm" at all, just some kind of arcane phenomenon.

指针：先开车过去。路上可别碰见其他意外情况，我不需要什么跌宕起伏的英雄旅程。
Pointer: No matter what the case may be, I can't afford an odyssey at a time like this.

指针：——我得尽快赶回发射基地。
Pointer: I have to get to the Cosmodrome, ASAP.

发射基地·发射室
Launch Room, Cosmodrome

研究员调试着房间里的仪器，小蛇们歪过脑袋，被屏幕上闪烁的提示吸引了绝大部分注意力。
Hissabeth runs through delicate calibrations of all the equipment in the room. The snakes tilt their heads, thoroughly distracted by the many blinking prompts on the screen.

为了让自己集中精神，冷周六试着将脑内的喧哗变成切实的话语。
To focus, she tries turning the noise in her head into spoken words.

冷周六：靠神秘术波动预估“暴雨”，这方法变量太多，根本不稳定。
Hissabeth: Arcane energy fluctuations aren't a perfect method of predicting the "Storm."

冷周六：我真有点担心最后跟踪到的波动都来自那个小姑娘。
Hissabeth: What if all these fluctuations are something else, something like that girl?

冷周六：远旅……还是交给基金会发愁吧，她拒绝更多研究，我也不好勉强。
Hissabeth: Voyager, a mysterious girl with unbelievable power. I should let the Foundation handle this. I can't force her to join in an experiment against her will.

冷周六：发射室的操作系统也该优化，现在有太多冗余步骤，根本不合道理。
Hissabeth: There are too many redundant steps in the launching system. We need to streamline them if we're going to make our deadline.

她用力按住指纹检测面板，勉强保证了自己的措辞听上去礼貌。
She presses down firmly on the fingerprint scanner, keeping her tone civil through gritted teeth.

小蛇 V：**我想这应该是出于安全考虑吧！**
Snake V: **Aren't those steps important for safety?**

冷周六：唉。除了指针，谁还背得下那么厚的操作指南？
Hissabeth: Yeah, yeah, probably, but the process is too complicated. I think Pointer was the only one that ever managed to remember each step in order.

小蛇 V：**没人帮你调试系统，你就想起她来啦——**
Snake V: **Oh, so now you're thinking of her again?**

冷周六：我只是想要个帮手罢了。她现在肯定在普列谢茨克分部忙自己的事。
Hissabeth: Yeah, whatever. I could use another hand, is all. She's probably still in the branch building, busy with her own stuff.

冷周六：再说——
Hissabeth: Besides—

小蛇 V：**你听到了吗？**
Snake V: **Hey, you hear that?**

急促的脚步朝着发射室靠近。
Hurried footsteps approach the launch bay.

小蛇 V：**警戒！二号！你可不能让谁来搞破坏！**
Snake V: **It's an intruder! Hurry, we've got to stop them!**

小蛇的嘴巴被捏住，房间安静下来。她分辨着越发迫近的声音。
The little snake's mouth is pinched shut, and the room falls silent. She listens closely to the increasingly urgent steps.

冷周六：没有额外负重，个子偏高，有轻微前倾身体的习惯……
Hissabeth: Effortless steps from a tall figure, with a tendency to lean forward.

冷周六：没弄错的话应该是熟人。北方哨歌又落了东西在这儿？
Hissabeth: Sounds familiar. Could it be Windsong? Did she leave something behind again?

冲进房间的身影的确很熟悉。意料之外，情理之中。
The figure that bursts into the room is unmistakably familiar. Unexpected, yet somehow inevitable.

冷周六：——？
Hissabeth: ...?

蛇靠星星证明
The Measure of a Melusine CO-17

研究员还没来得及喘匀气，车辆没法直接开进发射场内圈，最后一小段路她是跑完的。
Pointer is visibly winded. Her vehicle couldn't drive into the inner perimeter of the launch bay, so she had to run the last stretch.

但她必须抓紧时间，她回到这里就是为了说出自己的想法。
But she has to make the most of her time. She came back to say what needed to be said.

冷周六比她更快地开口了。
Hissabeth speaks first.

冷周六： 你没事吧？怎么看起来像连着熬了好几个通宵似的？
Hissabeth: Are you alright? You look like you haven't slept in days.

冷周六： 说过多少次，疯狂科学家那一套没什么好处，科研也是体力活——
Hissabeth: How many times have I told you that research requires a healthy body and mind? You need sleep.

指针： 我……回来……
Pointer: I'm ... here for ...

冷周六： 最近我应该没做别的，就忙着手上这个要上天的大工程。
Hissabeth: Just so you know, I've got no time to help with whatever you're working on, and we're finishing this project, no matter what you say.

冷周六： 噢，车我用过，去矿坑附近跑了圈，没人查超载，没吃罚单，顶多油没加满。
Hissabeth: Oh, let me guess. You're here for the car? Yes, I've used it a few times, took the team out to the mine, didn't break anything or get any tickets, but the tank's dry.

每个猜想都绕过了靶心，巧合得像知道正确答案后考出的零分。
Her every theory misses the mark.

指针： 和那些都没关系……！
Pointer: It's not about any of that!

冷周六： 早几天会更安全，你不该选今天。
Hissabeth: Then you should have come earlier—days earlier, not today.

冷周六： “暴雨”很可能还有几个小时就会发生，你会来不及开车回分部大楼。
Hissabeth: The "Storm" is due to come in a couple hours. You won't make it to the Northern Branch.

她干脆先沉默，直到调整好呼吸。
Pointer falls silent for a moment instead, adjusting her breath.

指针： 我来等着帮你们处理后事，顺便看看你们玩命拿到的数据究竟值不值得。
Pointer: I'm here to settle your affairs. We need to secure your records in case you don't make it, and to see if the work you've done is actually worth your lives.

指针： 如果你们出事，正好。我把传送软盘改良好，用自己的名义发表论文，给研究成果起名，把你们的名字写在最不起眼的角落。
Pointer: Just so you know, if you don't survive, I'm going to finish our teleport disk and claim all the credit. Maybe I'll write a dissertation on it. I'll call it "Pointer's Teleport Disk," and you'll all just be a footnote, an "et al." in the citations.

指针： 一定说到做到。
Pointer: You know I'm not bluffing.

冷周六：能帮上忙就好。相信他们也不在意——别忘记用通灵板把论文结果告诉我。
Hissabeth: Cool, whatever, Pointer. Just don't forget to tell me the results. Maybe send them to me via Ouija board.

指针：……你是在开玩笑吗？
Pointer: Are you being serious?

冷周六：你不是认真的，指针？你学会了幽默？原谅我真的一点都没看出来。
Hissabeth: Aren't you? Or are you trying to be funny now? I really can't tell.

她努力维持着的平静语气还是被摧毁了。
The casual air she fought to maintain finally breaks.

指针：我发现没有蔬菜包的泡面太难吃，简直无法容忍！
Pointer: I'm just sick of eating instant noodles without the veggie packets!

指针：你也让人无法容忍！
Pointer: But more than that, I'm sick of you and your attitude!

指针：别在任何时候都轻描淡写地说所有事！
Pointer: All you do is joke around!

指针：吃饭很重要，生死不也很重要吗！
Pointer: If veggies matter that much to a stupid bowl of noodles, how could you think your lives matter any less to me?!

指针：说得轻松就能回避结果？少自以为是了！
Pointer: You want to treat your lives like a cosmic joke? Like your deaths won't matter. Well, they will to the ones you leave behind.

在彻底放弃控制音量，也放弃思考后，她的确从冷周六脸上见到了不一样的表情。
After giving up on controlling her volume and her thoughts, she catches a different expression on Hissabeth's face.

愧疚，悲伤，震惊？都不是。
Guilt, sadness, shock? None of the above.

研究员只是收起了微笑。
She has simply put away her smile.

冷周六：我明白了。
Hissabeth: I see your point.

冷周六：还好我一直在往数据卡里备份研究资料！
Hissabeth: Luckily, I've already made a copy of everything on this data card.

一个更快乐的、发自真心的笑容。
A brighter, more genuine smile appears.

冷周六：我考虑了很久应该把它托付给谁，就算冒着风险把它单独用传送术式送回去，也很可能会有意外和折损。
Hissabeth: I've been wondering who I should trust with it. It's not 100% safe to send back through the teleportation ritual.

冷周六：还好你现在回来了。
Hissabeth: It's good to have you back.

薄薄的卡片再次递到她面前。
The thin card is handed to her again.

冷周六：可能缺了一些内容，含章鼎，我记住他叫什么了——还没来得及做完短片剪辑。
Hissabeth: The editing isn't done. Han Zhang—yeah, I can remember his name now—I didn't have time to finish his part.

冷周六：不过遗书这种东西也不需要多么漂亮的结尾，对吧?
Hissabeth: But who has time to edit a suicide note?

冷周六：要点是，必须托付给一个会认真对待它的人。
Hissabeth: The only thing that matters is that it's in the hands of someone who will take it seriously.

冷周六：现在开车回去还来得及。
Hissabeth: Take it and go. You can still make it back.

数据卡有轻微的热度，它大概始终被装在口袋里。
The data card feels faintly warm. It must have been in her pocket the entire time.

指针：开车也来不及，油箱快空了。
Pointer: *sigh* Forget it. You already told me the car's out of gas.

指针：让我见识下你们的成果。
Pointer: So, I'll be your witness.

冷周六：你决定和我一起死了?
Hissabeth: You sure you wanna die with us, after all?

指针并没有接话，而是靠近了一步。
Pointer doesn't respond. She just takes a step forward.

指针：我只是希望这份电子遗书不会派上用场，至少不是作为遗书派上用场。
Pointer: Call it a fool's wish, but I'm hoping no one is ever going to need to see this.

指针：说吧，你把我们的研究完善到了什么程度?
Pointer: Catch me up to speed, what's the status of the project?

冷周六：目前只能实现定点传送，而且会造成不可避免的压力，带来眩晕、呕吐，和严重晕车类似——
Hissabeth: We've managed to refine the teleportation to pinpoint a fixed position, but there are still some serious side effects: dizziness, nausea, like the world's worst case of carsickness.

指针：无所谓。等我读完研究资料，就会着手解决这些副作用。
Pointer: It'll have to suffice for now. I think I can work that out after I finish reading your progress.

冷周六：期待你的好消息!
Hissabeth: Cool, I'll look forward to that.

她指了指门口。
She points to the door.

冷周六：你的实验室谁都没再进去过，也没动过里面的东西。我的实验室倒是变得乱七八糟。
Hissabeth: Your office should be the same as you left it, besides a layer of dust. Be grateful though. You should see the state of mine.

冷周六：在这里用传送软盘不太安全，万一你把发射台一起带走，或者哪台机器出了故障，我们就完蛋啦。
Hissabeth: Oh, and don't activate the teleportation anywhere around here. If it takes out the single critical component, we'll be screwed completely.

指针：我当然知道。
Pointer: Like I don't know.

指针：不需要更多帮手了？我可以留下帮忙。
Pointer: You need a hand here? I can help.

冷周六：我以为那天我们已经决定好了分工方式，你留在绝对安全的地方保护资料。
Hissabeth: I thought we already figured out our roles? You need to stay at a safe distance to protect the data.

她难以分辨其中是否有嘲讽的成分。
She can't quite tell if there's mockery in her words.

但她也不需要对此追根究底。语言就是这样模糊而缥缈，被说出的话都会折损意义。
But she doesn't need to get to the bottom of it. Language is vague and fleeting. Words lose meaning the moment they're spoken.

指针：那就这样。
Pointer: That's it.

临转身前，她顿了顿，顺手将头发别到耳后。
Before turning around, she pauses and tucks her hair behind her ear.

数据接口与机械装置折射着实验室的冷光。
Her data ports and mechanical components reflect in the sterile light of the lab.

指针：我本以为机器无法忤逆自己的程序。它教导我以保护周围的生命为先。
Pointer: Ha. I always thought I wasn't able to act against my safety programming.

指针：但我们还是在这里见面了。
Pointer: Yet here we are.

又是一个少见的表情。指针的数据库得出了分析结果，对方感到惊讶。但这种情绪也并未在冷周六脸上停留太久。
Another rare expression on Hissabeth's face. Pointer's database logs it as a surprise, but the emotion doesn't linger long.

冷周六：你能尝出普通食物的味道?
Hissabeth: Do you have a sense of taste?

指针以为自己的表情数据已经不会再被奇妙的问题干扰。但她的微笑指数依然上升了 0.35 度。
Pointer once thought her facial expression metrics could no longer be thrown off by strange inputs. Yet her smile is off its index by 0.35 degrees.

指针：我的设计目的之一就是尽可能地仿真。
Pointer: Yeah. I was designed to simulate all aspects of life.

冷周六：仿真？谁规定人类和神秘学家是“真实”的标准?
Hissabeth: Really? But whose life? Who decided whether it should be a human's or arcanist's life?

冷周六：按他们那套分类，你大概算是“意识唤醒者”，就像乌尔里希研究员和露西女士。
Hissabeth: I suppose you are probably another Awakened arcanist, like Ulrich and Madam Lucy.

指针：可能不太一样。不过，还是等事情顺利结束后再说这些吧。
Pointer: Not exactly. But the details can wait.

指针：看来多精密的计算也无法准确预估所有事。就像我本以为在这样的时刻，你会鼓励你的朋友。
Pointer: I thought you would be more encouraging at such a vital moment. Guess my prediction matrix is not quite as perfect as I've let on.

冷周六：我的确在鼓励你。我在试着证明你的存在性……
Hissabeth: I am encouraging you. I'm trying to prove your existence matters.

面对稍微偏过头、神情疑惑的研究员，指针的微笑指数再次上升。
Faced with Hissabeth tilting her head in confusion, Pointer's smile registers even higher.

自她离开发射基地以来，这是她最为轻松的一刻。
Since leaving the Cosmodrome, this is the lightest she's felt.

指针：我该走了。多保重。
Pointer: Well, I should go. Take care.

冷周六：……好吧，我也得继续做准备，多确认几次情况，保证别出岔子。
Hissabeth: Time for another double-check. Everything needs to be flawless.

这条走廊早就刻在了指针的脑子里，闭着眼都能摸清楚方向。
This hallway is etched into Pointer's memory. She could navigate it without any sensors.

快到转角时，她听见了呼喊声。
As she turns, Hissabeth calls out to her.

冷周六：——指针！
Hissabeth: Pointer!

冷周六：我刚来普列谢茨克的时候，跟你简单解释过我的种族，但那真的很简略！
Hissabeth: You know, I should have mentioned something before, something I wanted you to see.

冷周六：吕西尼昂的大街小巷都有关于蛇发女妖的雕像！
Hissabeth: There are Melusine statues everywhere in Lusignan!

冷周六：我很早就离开了那里，但我相信它们还在，即使被“暴雨”冲刷也会在那儿，因为它的历史还算长！
Hissabeth: I left a long time ago, but they should still be there. Even the "Storm" can't wash them away. They've been there for ages!

冷周六：你可以去看看！
Hissabeth: Go take a look if you ever get the time!

指针：去那里根本找不到理由报销差旅费。
Pointer: I don't think Laplace would cover that as a scientific excursion.

她没有停下脚步，也没有回头，只是比了个手势。
She doesn't stop or turn back, but gives Hissabeth a gesture.

指针。拉普拉斯科算中心普列谢茨克分部研究员，前航天小组成员。
The name is Pointer. Researcher in LSCC Plesetsk Branch. Former team member on the Space Monitor Project.

退出计划的原因，得有人为坏结局做好准备，帮忙收场。
The reason I quit? Because someone must be prepared for the worst-case scenario.

另外，那碗面真的很难吃。
And because I was tired of freeze-dried noodles.

这儿也有两位朋友在进行简单的告别。
Two other friends have come to say a quiet goodbye.

尽管无法依靠语言交换祝愿，她们还是尽量做着尝试。
Though they can't quite exchange wishes through speech, they still try.

远旅还不太能控制好这支记号笔。但她写得非常缓慢，非常耐心。
Voyager struggles to control the marker, but she writes, and Kiperina waits patiently.

手掌上的笔迹组成一个复杂难辨的图形，它的几何构成非常精巧，它的含义也仍旧不可识读。
The markings on her palm form a complex, indecipherable pattern—precise in geometry, yet unreadable in meaning.

远旅：阿涅娅。回家。
Voyager: Alia. Come home.

小宇航员的注意力暂时从图案上离开。她接连来了几次深呼吸，确认自己没有听错。
The little astronaut pulls her focus away from the pattern. She takes a few deep breaths, just to be sure she heard it right.

库珀花环： 你居然说了这么长的话！
Kiperina: That was three whole words!

库珀花环： 如果你能学会更长的句子，就能告诉我你的家乡在哪里了。
Kiperina: Maybe once you learn a few more, you can tell me where you're really from.

远旅： ……
Voyager: ...

鞋面上增加了微不可察的丁点重量。
There's a shift of weight on her shoe.

库珀花环低下头，一条小蛇也正抬头瞧她。
Kiperina lowers her head. A familiar little snake looks back up at her.

小蛇 Ⅷ： **姐姐让我来提醒你，该登上飞船了。**
Snake VIII: **My sister sent me to tell you it's time.**

小蛇 Ⅷ： **别害怕。我们九个都觉得你很厉害。**
Snake VIII: **And that you shouldn't be afraid. You'll make one cool astronaut, ask any of us.**

库珀花环： 我完全没有害怕。
Kiperina: I'm not afraid.

库珀花环： 等我回来就给你们做特色果酱。是马戏团里的秘方。
Kiperina: When I return, remind me to show you Natalya's famous jam recipe.

也许是那个图形真有什么奇妙的效果，又或者是对未来平添的几分期待。
Maybe the pattern really does hold some kind of magic, or maybe it's just the feeling of looking forward to the future.

她的脚步确实轻快了起来。
But either way, her steps feel lighter.

库珀花环： 登船检测完毕，没有问题。
Kiperina: Final diagnostics completed.

飞船舱室
Cabin, Spacecraft

库珀花环： 预计一分钟后正式进入发射准备。
Kiperina: We're clear for launch in T-minus one minute.

库珀花环： 有让人始终保持冷静的好办法吗?
Kiperina: Is there anything else I have to remember?

冷周六： 有。坚持呼吸。
Hissabeth: Yes: keep breathing.

库珀花环： 这是一句提醒，还是一个玩笑?
Kiperina: Really, a joke now? Or are you serious?

冷周六： 算是祝福。
Hissabeth: It can be both things.

冷周六： 抓紧时间就位。一路顺风。
Hissabeth: Now get ready, and have a safe flight.

通讯结束。冷周六环视过发射室里的每张面孔，同伴们的神色令她稍感放松。
The transmission ends. Hissabeth scans each face in the launch bay, the confidence in her teammates putting her at ease.

这里没有想要退缩的人。她将手掌覆上那枚按钮。
She knows that everyone here is committed to the end. She places her hand on the button.

冷周六：三。
Hissabeth: Three.

冷周六：二。
Hissabeth: Two.

冷周六：一。
Hissabeth: One.

冷周六：发射。
Hissabeth: Ignition.

克浦斯的故事
The Story of Cepheus 小径

克浦斯的故事
The Story of Cepheus

简中
克浦斯知道一种无比美妙的生活方式。
那就是时刻看着未来，一直向前迈步，它相信这是正确的。
克浦斯走得很快，因此摔得很惨，于是它换上了金属的外壳。
金属外壳下的鬼魂见证了无数美好瞬间——
近乎不灭的火炉被点亮，人造的星星被送上天空，地球的歌声传达至太阳系外。
可这些全部都消失在雨中，它的梦想迎来终结时刻。
于是克浦斯感到前所未有的遗憾，它发现自己对活着的方法一无所知。

克浦斯相信自己是千年后的指针，能指明万年之内的方向，却发现自己连百年内的道路都不了解，甚至照不亮南半球的道路。

克浦斯后来怎么样了？后来它回到了暂时重现的航天基地，为了活在当下的人们继续做起了研究。

是的，我就是克浦斯。
English
Cepheus learned a wonderful way to live.

Always keep your eyes on the future. Keep walking forward. It believed that was the right thing to do.

Cepheus moved quickly. And so, it fell hard. After that, it donned a metal shell.

Inside that metal shell, the ghost of Cepheus witnessed countless beautiful moments—

A near-eternal hearth being lit. Man-made stars launched into the sky. Earth's songs reaching beyond the Solar System.

But it all vanished in the rain. Its dreams ended.

And Cepheus felt regret for the first time. It realized, perhaps, that it didn't really know how to live after all.

Cepheus believed itself to be a guiding pointer for millennia to come, leading the way for ten thousand years. But in truth, it realized it didn't even understand the road to the next hundred years. It couldn't even light the paths of the Southern Hemisphere.

What happened to Cepheus afterward? It returned to the space base and continued its research for the sake of those still living.

Yes. I am Cepheus.

墓志铭
Epitaph CO-18

库珀花环：高度在上升，一切正常。
Kiperina: Altitude rising. All systems normal.

冷周六：好，保持通信。
Hissabeth: Cool. Stay on comms.

她望向舷窗之外，清晰地感受到地面在远离，而天空在迫近。
She looks out the porthole, watching as the ground falls away and the sky closes in.

恰恰与她从钢丝上摔落时相反。
It feels like falling in reverse.

宇航员站起身来，按照重复过无数次的训练流程打开储物箱。
The little astronaut stands up and opens the storage box, following the procedure she has rehearsed countless times.

监测器的摄像头亮起，它愉快地朝前方打了个招呼。
The monitor's camera lights up.

监测器：欢迎来到拉普拉斯。更正，欢迎来到……
Monitor: Welcome to Laplace! Error, new coordinates detected. Correction: Welcome to ...

监测器：数据库未收录该坐标。混蛋，数据错误！混蛋！
Monitor: Location coordinates not found! Reconfirming ... S**t! Location not found! S**t!

库珀花环：跳过二次确认流程，载入预设程序。
Kiperina: Cancel the location process. Load preset program.

库珀花环：启用“暴雨”监测系统。
Kiperina: Activate the "Storm" surveillance system.

监测器：声纹识别通过。信息识别通过。虹膜识别通过。身份已验证，操作权限开放。
Monitor: Voice authorization approved. Iris recognition recognized. Operator identified. Operation access granted.

监测器：祝你拥有好运。特别提示，禁止向器械泼洒酒精，否则后果自负。
Monitor: Good luck. Special Warning: Mind all liquids in the vicinity of machinery, especially alcohol!

这点幽默并没有得到回应，它被搁在舱室的地板上，识时务地进入了自检模式。
The humorous warning gathers no reply. Left on the floor of the cabin, the monitor sensibly begins a diagnostic check on itself.

在宇航员为它扣上安全绳时，它倒没有忘记道谢。
And when the little astronaut fastens its safety tether, it remembers to say thanks to her.

库珀花环： 已顺利到达目标位置。
Kiperina: We've reached our target altitude.

库珀花环： 我将按计划开启舱门，校正星体坐标，投放监测器。
Kiperina: Now, I will open the hatch, adjust the celestial coordinates, and deploy the monitor as planned.

冷周六： 收到。
Hissabeth: Copy that.

氧气含量充足。倒计时十五分钟。
Oxygen level sufficient. Countdown at 15 minutes.

监测器： 记住，轻拿轻放！
Monitor: Excuse me! Please handle me with care!

她尽量扶稳身旁的监测器，拉下把手，在舱门打开前深呼吸。
She steadies the monitor beside her, pulls the lever, and takes a deep breath before the hatch opens.

一片黑暗。
Darkness.

没有前后、上下、远近，没有声音和光线。只有隔着航天服传来的坚实触感。
No forward or backward, no up or down, no sound or light. Only the solid touch that seeps through her spacesuit.

再一次眨眼后，宇宙在她眼前展开，如同……玩具盒子。
When she blinks again, the universe unfolds before her, like a toy box.

宇宙
Space

库珀花环： ——！
Kiperina: ...!

库珀花环： ……报告，确认观测到“暴雨”影响。
Kiperina: Report, the effects of the "Storm" are now being observed.

没有回应。她不知道自己是否准确传达了这一结果。
No response. She has no way of knowing if her signal got through.

她感到头晕目眩，也感到自己的心脏就要冲出胸腔。
She's disoriented, and her heart pounds through her chest.

这些星球以令人恐惧的美丽回报了她的勇气。
These planets repay her courage with a terrifying kind of beauty.

为她献上掌声。
Applause, for her.

监测器： 警告！神秘术波动超过阈值！超过阈值！
Monitor: Warning! Warning! Arcane energy fluctuations approaching safety thresholds!

监测器： 强光！关上窗户！焊接作业时请戴上护目镜！混蛋！混蛋！
Monitor: Extreme light warning! Close the blinds! Remember to wear your safety goggles when arc welding! S**t! S**t!

意识逐渐远去，躯体变得沉重，紧接着又轻盈地浮起。
Her consciousness drifts. Her body feels heavy, then lifts again.

轻如一道呼吸。
Light as a breath.

库珀花环很快从晕眩中找回了平衡。
Kiperina regains her balance, steadying herself against the dizziness.

宇宙的侧面
Illusory Space

周围的景色彻底变了样，变得更加熟悉……也更加难以捉摸。
The view around her has changed entirely. It feels more familiar and yet even harder to grasp.

库珀花环：我……在这里？我还没有启动传送术式……
Kiperina: Why am I here? I haven't activated the teleportation ritual yet.

库珀花环：难道任务已经结束了……？
Kiperina: Is the mission over?

她转过头，自己的手中牵着一个可笑的小东西。
She turns her head. In her hand, she's holding something strange and almost silly.

玩偶：‘@#%￥！&#%!
Doll:‘@#%￥！&#%!

库珀花环：我听不懂您想说什么！请重复一遍——
Kiperina: I don't understand! Please repeat!

库珀花环：请重复一遍，您说的几乎是一串乱码——
Kiperina: Please repeat! I can't understand what's going on.

监测器：危险！波动已严重超过阈值！危险！
Monitor: Warning! Energy fluctuations are now exceeding safety thresholds!

含章鼎：通讯信号被干扰了，她没有回复！
Han Zhang: There's too much interference in the signal. We've got no response!

基金会职员在屏幕上敲下另一串密码，试图切入新的线路。
Name Day types in another string of passwords, trying to break into a new channel.

第一次，第二次。闪烁的红光依旧刺目。
The first time, the second time. The blinking red light remains blinding.

冷周六：立刻尝试远程连接监测器。
Hissabeth: Connect to the monitor directly.

她注意到自己和玩偶之间有一根绳索。就像她练习时常用的那样。
She notices a rope between her and the doll. It's a familiar style, like the ones she used to practice on.

在确认状况之前，视野里闪过的亮色先吸引了她的注意。
She tries to orient herself, only for a flash of brightness to grab her attention first.

库珀花环：这是……星球。
Kiperina: This is a planet.

库珀花环：简直可以看清地表起伏，多精致的道具……
Kiperina: I can see the rise and fall of the landscape. It's so strange here.

玩偶：‘@#%￥！&#%!
Doll:‘@#%￥！&#%!

库珀花环：别往前跑，还没确认这里的安全！
Kiperina: Come back. I need to record what I'm seeing here.

她拽住了那条绳索，紧接着，她不得不站在原地。
She grabs the rope, but she's forced to stop in her tracks.

像碰翻了弹珠盒子，星球在几次震颤后崩毁，声音清脆。它爆发出绚烂但短暂的亮光。
Like knocking over a box of marbles, planets shatter after a few tremors, bursting into radiant, fleeting flashes of light.

库珀花环： 周围是不是变得更暗了……？
Kiperina: Are those lights getting dimmer?

库珀花环： 我得往前走才行。
Kiperina: I need to keep going.

她踢到了什么东西。
She kicks something.

库珀花环： 一个小雕像？
Kiperina: A figurine?

它很重，也很粗糙，陷在地面的黑暗之中。
It's heavy and rough, embedded in the darkness of the ground.

带上它对前进并无助益。
Bringing it along would only slow her down.

库珀花环： 我能带上它，我还有力气。
Kiperina: I think I need to take this with me.

她伸出手，试图把这条小蛇从未知的暗处抢过来。
She reaches out, trying to snatch the figurine from whatever darkness it's caught in.

库珀花环： 光线在逐渐消失。我得走快些。
Kiperina: The lights are fading out. I need to move faster.

她没有需要切割的东西，也无需对谁挥动刀刃。
She has nothing she needs to cut, no one to swing the blade at.

但她还是弯下腰。周围依旧寂静，似乎自亘古以来就是如此。
Even so, she bends down to pick it up. The silence around her feels ancient, as if it's always been there.

库珀花环： 只有这条路了。
Kiperina: The only path left.

库珀花环： 我知道怎么保持平衡，这应该是我最擅长的事。
Kiperina: This won't be a problem. I've lived my whole life keeping balanced on a thin wire.

一小炉香灰。
A small burner of incense ash.

生锈的尺规。
A rusted calibrator.

被抱在怀里的东西越来越多，她的脚步也跟着变慢。
绳索还牵在她的右手里，但玩偶已经隐没在几乎贴近鼻尖的黑暗中。
Her arms are filling up, and her steps slowing under the weight. The rope is still in her right hand, but the doll has vanished into the darkness, inches from her nose.

库珀花环： ……
Kiperina: ...

她腾不出手来，只能勉强捏住小人的帽子，试图把它们也捎带上。
She has no free hand left, barely able to pinch the circus figurines' hats, trying to take them along too.

这已经是她能做的最大努力。
This is the most she can manage.

命名日：还有七分钟。监测器远程连接稳定。
Name Day: Seven minutes left. The connection to the monitor is stable.

冷周六：进行倒计时播送，重复三次后启动监测器的自动程序。
Hissabeth: Start the countdown. We'll try it another three times. If we still don't get a response after that, we'll need to activate the monitor's auto return program.

冷周六：虽然那玩意基本上只会闷头往前冲，但总得试试。
Hissabeth: I don't have a lot of hope in that basket case of a monitor, but if it's our only option ...

冷周六：继续尝试联系她。我不相信库珀花环会在这时候就失败。
Hissabeth: Just keep hailing her. We have to put our trust in Kiperina.

玩偶：‘@#%￥！&#%！
Doll:‘@#%￥！&#%!

库珀花环：你要去哪里？那很危险！
Kiperina: Where are you going? It's dangerous there!

绳索瞬间绷紧，将她往远处拉扯。她不得不使出全身的力气，双手将笨拙的玩偶往回拽。
The rope goes taut, yanking her backward. She has to use every ounce of strength, hauling the strange doll back with both hands.

想要兼顾所有事是不可能的。
Trying to hold onto everything at once is impossible.

库珀花环：——！不、我没想这样！
Kiperina: No! Not like this!

她怀抱的东西都轻易地消散了，像坠入海面的几滴水珠。
The objects in her arms scatter outwards, drifting like mist before vanishing into the sea.

宇宙诞生之初，一切都是尘埃。往后也是如此。
At the dawn of the universe, all things were dust. So it remains.

任何东西在宇宙的尺度都会变得微不足道，去探究它又有什么意义？
All things become insignificant when examined on a cosmic scale. What meaning is there in chasing it?

时间或许是只对人起作用的概念。
Maybe time is a concept that only holds meaning for humanity.

一生二，二生三，三生万物。
Out of one, two is born; out of two, three; out of three, everything.

从一粒原子开始。
It all started from an atom.

你一生的故事都在其中。
Your entire life story is in there.

她感到四周忽然安静了下来，耳边只能听到头盔内自己的呼吸声。
There's no sound anymore. Just her breathing inside the helmet and the beat of her heart in her ears.

库珀花环：我的确是渺小的、短暂的存在。
有许许多多像我这样渺小而短暂的存在，始终在向这个世界寻求一个答案。
Kiperina: My existence will be small and short. There are many, many others like me, searching for answers from the universe.

库珀花环： 但我们没有发现……宇宙并没有为我们准备好那个答案。
是我们自己赋予了万物意义。
Kiperina: But there is no answer to be found. No answers but the ones we choose for ourselves.

库珀花环： 一直都是我们自己。
Kiperina: It's been our choice the whole time.

库珀花环： 我不想否认已经度过的日子，也不想去揣测未来会变成什么样。没时间用来遗憾。
Kiperina: The past is in the past, and the future will wait for us. There is no time to be spared on regrets in the moment.

库珀花环： 无论消失的事物会不会回来，我都要往前走，去确认存在于远方的一切。
Kiperina: I must keep going, venture further into this world to uncover what's in the distance, to know whether things that vanish come back or not.

库珀花环： 直到我一生的结束。
Kiperina: I must keep going or die trying.

监测器： 成功到达指定坐标。
Monitor: We have reached our designated coordinates.

你并不孤单
You Are Not Alone CO-19

库珀花环： 我成功了吗……?
Kiperina: I made it?

耳机里没有传来任何声音。电子设备在一些时候远比肉体脆弱。
No sound comes through the headset. Electronic devices can sometimes be more fragile than flesh.

库珀花环： 监测装置亮着灯，看上去和之前训练里一样。
Kiperina: The indicator light is on, just like in my training.

库珀花环： 坐标也没有太大误差。好……
Kiperina: The coordinates are, well, close enough. Good.

库珀花环： 就只是这样。
Kiperina: The rest is simple.

旅行者一号在离开太阳系之前调转镜头，最后注视了一次自己的来处。
Before leaving the solar system, Voyager 1 turns its camera around, taking one final look at where it came from,

一枚 0.12 像素大小的光点。
a 0.12-pixel speck of light,

使其上的生命明白了天地广袤。
letting the life contained within it know just how vast the heavens truly are.

返回舱内之前，宇航员最后望了一眼漫无边际的星空。
Before returning to the cabin, the little astronaut takes one last look at the boundless stars.

组成万物的每颗原子都诞生于这片黑暗。
Every atom of everything was born in this darkness.

连接自己与地球的只是肉眼无法看到的信号，连接自己与监测器的只是一根绳索。
All that links her to Earth is a signal invisible to the naked eye. All that links her to the monitor is a single rope.

如果松开手，就会永远地漂浮在庞大的宇宙中，被它包围。
这无声息的、近乎永恒的沉默。
If she lets go, she'll drift forever through the vastness of the universe, surrounded by it. Soundless, eternal silence.

曾踏出的一步，我们再也无法重现。
永恒的花朵，完整的天空。
前方空无一物，仅有一句承诺。

——曼德尔施塔姆 《给娜塔雅·施坦碧尔》
That which was movement once shall be removed ...
Flowers are immortal, the sky is all-embracing,
And what will be is no more than a promise.

Poems to Natalya Shtempel
—Osip Mandelstam

她知道眼前所见会被抹去。自己的国家、故乡，曾拥有的身份、尝过的食物、结识的友人，最终都只会刻在记忆里。
She knows what she sees will be wiped away. Her country, her home, her past identity, the food she's tasted, the friends she's known—eventually they'll only live in memory.

然而记忆的保质期可称短暂。群星回馈给这些短暂之物的也只有寂静。
And memory, too, has a notoriously short shelf life. The stars remember nothing.

恒星的消亡尚且无声，一片土地，抑或一个词语的离去又怎么可能足够响亮呢?
The universe does not mourn the death of a star. How could the loss of a country, a person, or a single word be truly remembered?

对于一位年轻宇航员的消失，宇宙自然也应当无动于衷。
The disappearance of a young astronaut deserves no more reaction from the universe than that.

库珀花环：我该抓紧时间，回到地面……
Kiperina: I need to get back. I need to get back to Earth.

库珀花环：我……
Kiperina: I ...

幻觉带来的影响尚未完全消退，她耳后的血管仍然一阵阵抽动着发痛。
The aftereffects of the hallucination haven't completely faded. The veins behind her ears pulse with pain.

死亡是一粒果核。她怀揣的小小的死亡，此刻无限地贴近皮肤表面。
Death is a fruit pit. The small death she carries is now pressed close to the surface of her skin.

她松开手掌，在脑海里勾勒出那道笔迹。它可能已经被汗水融成了模糊的红色。
She opens her palm and sketches the pattern into her mind. It's likely it's already been blurred by her sweat.

库珀花环：我能应对一切……只要先……
Kiperina: I can have this handled. First, I need to ...

先站稳。在一根纤细的钢丝上找到立足之地。
Steady yourself. Find your footing on a strand-thin wire.

它真的存在吗?
Is it even there?

库珀花环：……
Kiperina: ...

含章鼎：信号彻底中断了！
Han Zhang: We lost the signal!

命名日：切了第二条线路，再试。
Name Day: Switch to line two and try again.

含章鼎：备用线路测试。二号失联。三号失联……四号……失联。
Han Zhang: Testing comm backup line. Line two, lost. Line three, lost. Line four, lost.

操作台上亮起四盏红灯，显示屏提醒着最后的四分钟倒计时。
Four red lights blink on the console. The display shows the final four-minute countdown.

冷周六：再次尝试通讯。
Hissabeth: Keep trying to reconnect.

库珀花环：……
Kiperina: ...

库珀花环：再次尝试通讯……
Kiperina: Reconnecting ...

库珀花环：通讯失败。
Kiperina: Connection lost.

她无法及时回到舱内，安全绳上的卡扣锁死了。
She won't be able to get back inside the cabin in time. The buckle on the safety tether has locked in place.

检测到超标的神秘术波动或者特殊环境，卡扣自动锁紧避免滑脱。
这本来是贴心的防护措施，但设计者没有预料到有人使用它就是为了更好地解开。
When detecting excess arcane fluctuations or hazardous environment, the buckle will automatically lock to prevent slippage. It was meant to be a thoughtful safety feature, but its designer never imagined someone would want to unlock it on purpose.

库珀花环：我应该想到的！这不是我在马戏团用的普通的绳索……
Kiperina: I should have thought this through! This isn't like the rope I used in the circus.

库珀花环：不行，这样下去监测装置会被拖离轨道。
Kiperina: No, if I do that, the monitor will be pulled out of sync.

还有多久？还能做些什么？松开手，面对失败？
How much longer do I have? What else can I do? Should I just let go and accept my failure?

为了近在眼前的成就牺牲？他们会在墓碑上称我为英雄？
Has what I've done so far been enough? Will they call me a hero when they write my name over an empty tomb?

会吗？更可能是乌特恩亚亚的孩子，拉普拉斯编外成员，理线学学徒……
Face it. I won't die a hero. I'll just be a circus girl from Utrennyaya, a temporary Laplace Employee, or an apprentice Ley Line Hunter.

近乎静止的几分钟后，冷周六敲下了按键。
After a few minutes near motionless, Hissabeth presses the button.

冷周六：停止测试，保持主线路通讯。
Hissabeth: Okay, forget the backups. Switch to the main connection.

冷周六：立刻做撤离准备。五十秒之后我会启动返航程序。
Hissabeth: Start evacuation preparations now. I'll activate the return program in fifty seconds.

命名日：我们怎么确认她已经进了返回舱?!
Name Day: But how will we know if she's in the return capsule?

冷周六： 四十秒。不追上时间，她就没有一点希望。
Hissabeth: Forty seconds—We won't. Either she makes it, or she doesn't. It's out of our hands.

冷周六： 只有在“暴雨”降临的临界线上，神秘术才能得到足够的增幅，才能实现这么远距离的定点传送。
Hissabeth: The teleportation ritual won't have enough energy if it isn't at the exact critical moment of the "Storm."

冷周六： 我相信她一定会尽最大的努力准时回家。
Hissabeth: I have faith in her. She'll come home.

阿涅娅。回家。
Alia. Come home.

库珀花环： 我必须回去。还有人在地面等着我。
Kiperina: I have to go home. People are waiting for me down there.

库珀花环： 时间应该不多了……我需要……
Kiperina: But I don't have much time. I need something.

冷周六： 如果你能帮我把这些文件变成一把刀，我会很感激你。
Hissabeth: Maybe you can turn them into a knife or something.

冷周六： 虽然派不上大用场，至少它们还能拿来切切水果。
Hissabeth: A knife would be more useful at this point. You know, to cut fruit or whatever.

命名日： 这个不行。你桌上废弃的名片可以。
Name Day: Actually, that card there on the table would work better for that.

冷周六： 有什么特别的?
Hissabeth: Why is that?

命名日： 材质。金属名片不算常见，它们做武器会比用于自我介绍更好。
Name Day: It's all about the material. Metal makes a better edge than paper. Never quite understood why you made them like that.

冷周六： 那是我之前研制的新型材料。北方哨歌和指针的名片也都是我做的，受热就会变锋利，在手里捏一会儿能当拆信刀用……
Hissabeth: Oh. I was testing out the new alloy. I used it to make Windsong's and Pointer's cards. It gets harder and sharper when heated. Give it a rub with your hands, and you can use it as a letter opener.

拆信刀。
A letter opener.

她习惯性地把那张来自北方哨歌的名片贴身携带，现在它也在宇航服的口袋里。
She always keeps that name card from Windsong close at hand. It's in her space suit pocket now.

她也知道怎么穿着这身衣服使用自己的神秘术。这是她主要的训练任务。
She learned how to cast her arcane skill while suited up. It had been a core part of her training.

库珀花环： ——理线学万岁！
Kiperina: Ley Lines, of course! Thank you, Ms. Windsong!

感谢新型材料的锋利，感谢安全绳没有坚不可摧，感谢理线学。
Thanks to the sharpness of the new material, thanks to the safety tether not being unbreakable, thanks to the study of ley lines.

三十秒。
Thirty seconds.

基金会职员最后确认了输入的坐标。
Name Day confirms the final coordinates.

二十秒。
Twenty seconds.

含章鼎：虽然我一直不想说但现在应该抓紧机会认识你们还是很荣幸的如果活下来找我进货可以打折！
Han Zhang: It was a pleasure working with all of you. If we survive this, I'm giving you permanent discounts at my store. Provided we survive.

冷周六：任何材料都打折?！我死也会记住！
Hissabeth: How big are these discounts? Tell me now. I need to know how much I will live!

她没忘记抓住旁边还在好奇地端详设备的女孩儿。
She doesn't forget to grab Voyager beside her, who would otherwise have stayed there examining the equipment.

冷周六：收起来，小提琴是易碎物品——
Hissabeth: Stay away, please. Your violin is fragile.

十秒。
Ten seconds.

命名日：我希望死后的世界有双休！
Name Day: I hope there will still be weekends in the afterlife.

冷周六：三倍加班费！！
Hissabeth: If there is anything after this, then we deserve overtime pay for all eternity.

含章鼎：我真的讨厌工作狂！！！
Han Zhang: How can you be thinking of work right now!

一秒。
One second.

舱门在她身后关闭。
The hatch seals shut behind her.

系统提示音 I：返回舱分离准备已完毕。坐标校验完毕。
Notification I: The return capsule is ready to detach. Coordinate calibration complete.

系统提示音 I：请及时回到座位。
Notification I: Please return to your seat.

库珀花环：看来大家的进展很顺利。
Kiperina: It looks like everything worked out smoothly.

陷在座椅里，捏紧软盘，她闭上眼睛。
She sinks into the seat, grips the disk tightly, and shuts her eyes.

库珀花环：我会成功的。这是最后的、最简单的一步了。
Kiperina: Yes, I will make it. This is the last step. The simplest one.

库珀花环：……回家。
Kiperina: Take me home.

拉普拉斯职员 III：——！
Laplace Staff Member III: ...!

拉普拉斯职员 II：我听错了吗？这是——
Laplace Staff Member II: Is it me, or?

系统提示音 II： 成像数据回传结束。
Notification II: Imaging data transmission complete.

系统提示音 II： 二次确认坐标，赤经：14h，49m，09.55s……
Notification II: Reconfirming coordinates. RA: 14h, 49m, 09.55s ...

比起突然出现在地板上倒作一堆的人，电子播报音先吸引了研究员们的注意。
More fascinating than the figures who suddenly collapsed in a heap on their floor, it's the voice of the system that first grabs the staff members' attention.

实验事故在拉普拉斯算不上稀奇事。但惊人的成果总能赢得掌声。
Experimental accidents aren't unusual at Laplace. But astonishing results always earn attention.

拉普拉斯职员 III： 你瞧，那是冷周六。我说过她头上的蛇的确有独立意识，有一条没有晕过去。
Laplace Staff Member III: Look, that's Hissabeth. See the snakes on her head? Seems like one of them's still awake. Told you they have independent minds.

拉普拉斯职员 II： 和她一起的怎么像那群灰白格子……我们已经沦落到要去仓库抢材料了么？
Laplace Staff Member II: Hold on. Those two work with the Foundation.

指针： 别挡在这里！去申请紧急医疗援助，快点！
Pointer: Out of the way! Go get medical support now!

拉普拉斯职员 II： 哦哦，指针这家伙我倒认识。她这么着急，这群家伙……那个航天小组，对。他们又失败了？
Laplace Staff Member II: That's Miss Pointer, isn't it? So then this must be the team from the Space Monitor Project. Have they failed again?

拉普拉斯职员 III： 不，他们……如果这真的是从太空回传的数据……
Laplace Staff Member III: Hold on. Check it out! If this data is really from the space monitor ...

系统提示音 II： 赤纬：-102°，05'，45.82"。
Notification II: DEC: –102°, 05m, 45.82s.

拉普拉斯广播： “暴雨”降临。请注意避险。
重复，“暴雨”降临……
Laplace Broadcast: The "Storm" is here. Please take precautions. Repeat, the "Storm" is here.

拉普拉斯职员 II： 他们成功了……他们成功了！
Laplace Staff Member II: It's all here. They really did it. They did it!

……

...

……

...

播报声毫无准备地灌入耳中。
The voice of a broadcast floods into her awareness.

电台节目： “工程师们正寻找有效手段，以缓解高压、高温的极端环境带来的影响……”
Radio: "Our engineers are currently developing measures to minimize the effects of the high pressure and temperature ..."

库珀花环： ……？我……
Kiperina: I ...

库珀花环： 我回到了……地面。
Kiperina: I'm on Earth.

电台节目：“1970 年至今，钻探工作已持续七年，即将超越伯沙罗杰斯钻洞的 9583 米深度纪录……”
Radio: "Beginning in 1970, the current drilling project has been a labor of the past seven years. Its depth is predicted to soon surpass that of the Bertha Rogers Hole at 9583 meters ..."

库珀花环：这时候……科兹洛夫先生刚收养我。
Kiperina: 1977, that was the year that Mr. Kozlov found me.

库珀花环：我是不是还能见到他们?
Kiperina: Could that mean that I will be able to see them again?

有许多人怀揣着同样的疑问。也有许多事在这场雨之后改变了。
Many people had the same questions she did as they awoke. Many things changed after that "Storm."

一只手轻轻拍了拍她的肩膀。
A hand grips her shoulder.

维拉：你要先照顾好自己，孩子。
Vila: You'll need to take care of yourself first, little astronaut.

维拉：想重建生活，需要足够健康的身体。那些关心你的人，一定希望见面时你看起来过得很好。
Vila: Rebuilding a life requires a healthy body first. But I'm certain you are in good hands here.

库珀花环：谢谢您。您是……
Kiperina: Thank you, but who are ...

北方哨歌：维拉，我的朋友。一位最亲切的同志。
Windsong: This is my friend, Vila. My dearest, bravest comrade.

北方哨歌：这是库珀花环，我的学生。我能这样介绍吗?
Windsong: And this is Kiperina. Would you mind if I introduced you as my apprentice?

库珀花环：当然……我已经做好了决定。
Kiperina: Not at all. I've made up my mind.

库珀花环：我想继续学习理线学。
Kiperina: I want to keep learning The Study of Ley Lines.

北方哨歌：这是我今天听到的第二个好消息。
Windsong: That's the second-best news I've heard today.

北方哨歌：冷周六、命名日和含章鼎也都还在病房里躺着，指针急得够呛，刚才还说要等他们彻底康复再把他们挨个揍进急诊室……
Windsong: Hissabeth, Name Day, and Han Zhang are all still recovering in bed. You should've seen Pointer. She was mad as all hell. Claimed she'd be waiting for them to recover so she could whoop them back into the recovery ward.

北方哨歌：我就从那边溜了，来看看自己的学生。
Windsong: Anyways, I thought I'd best avoid that scene and pay a visit to my new apprentice.

库珀花环：第一个好消息是我们成功了，对不对?
Kiperina: So, then the best news you had today—we did it, right?

北方哨歌：我想这算是件好事，但没有那么重要。
Windsong: That's good news for sure. But still not the best.

隔着病床柔软的被单，另一只手捉住了库珀花环的手掌。
Beneath the soft sheets of the hospital bed, another hand clasps Kiperina's.

远旅：……
Voyager: ...

这是最好的消息。
This is the best news.

欢迎回家。
Welcome home.

宇宙无事发生
As If Nothing Happened up There CO-20

基金会庭院
Yard, Foundation

白色石墙将世界分隔成里侧与外侧，同时也带来了长久的寂静。
A white stonewall divides the world into inside and outside.

逐渐靠近的脚步声与说话声令这份寂静骤然消散。
Footsteps and voices draw closer, abruptly breaking the silence of the courtyard.

基金会职员 I： 拉普拉斯说要研究的那东西怎么样了？
Foundation Staff Member I: Did we get that progress report on the Laplace teleportation project?

基金会职员 II： 你说传送软盘吗？上次会议里提到过，它很快就会登上外勤物资申请单。
Foundation Staff Member II: The teleport disk? Yeah, I guess it was a big success. They're already working on the field mission applications.

基金会职员 II： 如果它能彻底普及开，让我每天下班直接传送回宿舍，我愿意称它是最伟大的发明。
Foundation Staff Member II: Imagine if they could put it into mass production. I'd use it to commute straight to work. No more traffic.

基金会职员 I： 算了吧，万一反过来缩短我们的集合时间呢？真这样方便，你不就得随叫随到了吗？
Foundation Staff Member I: You'd better hope not. They'll start using it to summon us straight from home. It'll be like being on-call 24/7.

基金会职员 II： 天哪，你说得对！我受不了了，拉普拉斯那群工作狂——
Foundation Staff Member II: Holy moly! I didn't think of that. Worse still, those Laplace workaholics would probably enjoy it.

基金会职员 I： 起码他们真搞到了“暴雨”相关的数据，这可是件大活儿。
Foundation Staff Member I: Well, it's not all bad. We got the data—real-time observation of the universe during the "Storm" from outer space. That's huge.

基金会职员 I： 全宇宙都会被回溯，还挺公平嘛……至少不是只有地球倒霉。
Foundation Staff Member I: I'll say, looks like the whole universe is getting reversed, though. I mean, at least it's nice to know we aren't alone.

基金会职员 II： 哈，兄弟，我就欣赏你这份乐观。
Foundation Staff Member II: That's the spirit, man. Look for the silver lining.

基金会职员 II： 为什么那个航天小队不是公开招募？谁不想去宇宙里瞧瞧呢？换成我，我恨不得在宿舍门口拉上横幅，到时候还要把这事迹刻在墓碑上！
Foundation Staff Member II: Why on earth wasn't that project an open volunteer call? Who wouldn't want to go to space? If I got the chance to spacewalk, I'd never let anyone forget it. You'd see it on my tombstone.

基金会职员 I： 万一有下次机会呢？说起来，拉普拉斯的人我不熟，但我认识他们队里基金会的小子。可惜命名日好像又去跑外勤了，到时候可以约他喝酒，打探点新鲜消息。
Foundation Staff Member I: I know someone on their team, Name Day. I'll ask him about it next time we're out for a drink. Too bad he is already out on another field mission.

基金会职员 I： 他还是航天小队的成员，意味着他要打两份工，哇哦。
Foundation Staff Member I: He's working for Laplace now too. Working two jobs at once, wow!

基金会职员 II： 你怎么认识那么多工作狂？我要重新审视你了！
Foundation Staff Member II: Is that admiration I hear? I thought you didn't like workaholics.

基金会职员 II： 但日子确实好起来了。我们会解决“暴雨”，我相信这不过是眨眼的事……
Foundation Staff Member II: I just don't want to be one. Still, things are going better now. We'll have this little "Storm" problem solved soon enough.

基金会职员 I： 嘘……阿尔文，你听到没有？
Foundation Staff Member I: Shh, Alvin, did you hear that?

基金会职员 II： 你说啥……哦。
Foundation Staff Member II: What? Oh.

这里不常有琴声。忙碌的职员们最近才重新拾起一些过去的爱好。
Music is rare in this place. But recently the ever-busy staff have felt in the right spirit to revisit old hobbies.

这是一支相当有名的曲子，它曾与另外二十六支歌曲共同穿越茫茫群星，至今也仍在途中。
This is a well-known piece, one that once traveled with 26 other songs across the star fields, and still drifts there today.

远旅： ……
Voyager: ...

当陈旧的岁月淹没了这一代人，
你仍将栖息在人群之中，为人的朋友。
When old age shall this generation waste,
Thou shalt remain, in midst of other woe.

冷周六： 我知道这支曲子，指针经常在办公室播那盘录音带。她说是金唱片母带的翻录。
Hissabeth: I know the piece. Pointer often plays that record in her office. She said it's a track from the Golden Record.

冷周六： 就是旅行者一号带着的那张。
Hissabeth: The same record that Voyager 1 carries.

命名日： 1987 年它在哪儿呢？已经到太阳系边缘了吗？
Name Day: Where would it have been in 1987? At the edge of the solar system?

冷周六： 它的动力要到 2025 年才耗尽，我说的是没有发生“暴雨”的那个 2025。
Hissabeth: Its power won't run out until 2025, so long as there's no "Storm" to stop it.

库珀花环： 耗尽动力会怎么样？它会停下？或者损坏？
Kiperina: What will happen to it when it runs out? Will it stop? Or be destroyed?

冷周六： 没那么严重，只是我们不会再得知它的下落。
Hissabeth: No, nothing quite so bad. It just won't be able to send signals back to us.

冷周六： 它会一直在宇宙中前行，继续它的旅程。如果真有外星文明，也许会在什么时候发现它。
Hissabeth: It will keep flying forward in space, continuing its endless journey. And if there is some alien life out there in the universe, they might find it some day.

冷周六：可能那时候地球已经不复存在。
Hissabeth: Perhaps many millions of years after the Earth is gone, swallowed up by the Sun or the "Storm."

冷周六：等得太久了，花了太多时间和资源，又无法得到回应。听上去比我们这群人的神秘术还要没用。
Hissabeth: To spend so much time and resources on something that won't respond to us after such a short time on a universal scale. It sounds even more useless than our arcane skills.

在注视头顶闪烁的光点时，人们很难想象自己脚下的星球也不过是宇宙中的一个小点。
When staring at the flickering lights above, it's hard to imagine that the planet beneath our feet is nothing more than a speck in the universe.

你会遇上另一些哀愁，并对人说起
真实的美丽。
Than ours, a friend to man, to whom thou say'st,
"Beauty is truth, truth beauty."

含章鼎：这本就是一封并不期待回应的信件。
Han Zhang: They didn't send it out expecting to get a quick response.

冷周六：啊，我想是的。我觉得它只是一个招呼，一句问候。
Hissabeth: You're right. I suppose it's just like a friendly greeting.

一种象征。
A symbol.

冷周六：“嗨，你们好。这里是地球，这里有过文明。我们尝试活着，或许会成功地战胜时间。”
Hissabeth: "Hi there. This is a gift from Earth, a place where life existed. We're trying to survive, but we may be defeated in time."

冷周六：或许等不到结果，但我个人相信会有谁听见这句问候。
Hissabeth: Aliens or not, it's likely that it will just drift in space forever, but personally, I want to believe that someone's going to listen to that record one day.

命名日：库珀花环小姐说不定能带回答案。如果你在宇宙里见到了上帝，帮我问问他最喜欢什么音乐。
Name Day: Maybe Ms. Kiperina can help us. If you see God up there in space, be sure to ask him what's his favorite piece on the record.

库珀花环：我想这该算是付费服务，请考虑把你的骨碟收藏分给我。
Kiperina: That kind of service is going to cost you. You'll have to pay up with your rib collection.

含章鼎：总之我们要先抵达九九年之后的世界，才有机会搞清楚金唱片的下落。
Han Zhang: Before we start thinking about that, we will still need to cross the year 1999, then we can figure out where that record will end up.

远旅认真地听着每一句话，有些她能理解，有些她还无法完全弄清。
Voyager listens intently to every word. Some she understands; many others lie beyond her reach.

但她也有想要与朋友们分享的东西。
But she has something she wants to share with her friends.

这是为小队的友人们奏响的曲调，是为勇敢的小宇航员送去的祝福与鼓励。
A melody played for her teammates. A blessing and encouragement for a brave little astronaut.

是来自 64 亿光年外的回答。
A reply from 6.4 billion light-years away.

信件送达了。收件人是一颗会唱歌的星星。
The message has been delivered. The recipient: a star that sings.

这就是全部。
你们在尘世所知晓，且应知晓的事物。

——济慈《希腊古瓮颂》

That is all.
Ye know on earth, and all ye need to know.

Ode on a Grecian Urn
—John Keats

众人：三。
All: Three.

众人：二。
All: Two.

众人：一。
All: One.

她的种族并不具备地球生物理解中的“听觉”。但她有自己的方式理解其上承载的信息。
Her species lacks what earth creatures call "hearing." But she has her own way of interpreting auditory information.

那是她从未想象过，从未感受过的……旋律。
It's a melody unlike anything she's ever imagined—never felt before.

它来自那个黯淡的蓝色光点。
It comes from that faint blue dot:

地球。
Earth.

Невероятно.
不可思议的。
Невероятно.
Unbelievable.

Вечный.
永恒的。
Вечный.
Eternal.

Красивая.
美丽的。
Красивая.
Beautiful.

基金会职员 I：这首歌还挺好听。
Foundation Staff Member I: Hmm, it sounds nice.

基金会职员 II：那就多听一会儿——等等，你要去哪儿?
Foundation Staff Member II: Then keep listening. Wait, where are you going?

基金会职员 I：我们走吧，别打扰其他人。
Foundation Staff Member I: Just let them do their thing. We should go now. We've got more work waiting for us.

基金会职员 I：手上还有活儿要干呢，你之前说的传送软盘领用申请，要怎么提交来着?
Foundation Staff Member I: By the way, you were talking about those disks being prepared for field service, right?

基金会职员 II： 具体事项还不清楚，过几天指针女士应该会进行相关内容的宣讲……
Foundation Staff Member II: Yeah, but I told you everything I know. Ms. Pointer should give us the details in a few days.

基金会职员 I： 冷周六小姐这么忙吗？怪不得那天的庆祝会她只派几条蛇露了个面。北方哨歌女士和维拉女士倒是留到了最后，噢，还有被那群孩子包围的库珀花环小姐……
Foundation Staff Member I: Not Ms. Hissabeth, huh? She seems real busy. I guess that's why she only sent one of her snakes to the victory party? I saw Windsong and Vila, though. Oh, and Kiperina was there surrounded by a bunch of kids, and they all stuck around right till the end.

基金会职员 I： 芝诺的家伙听见有酒喝就肯定到场，那位年轻飞行员和一条蝾螈划拳拼酒……
Foundation Staff Member I: There were a few Zeno guys there too. Whenever there's booze, you can count on them showing up. I think I saw one of their pilots having a drinking contest with a newt. Crazy!

基金会职员 I： 后来乌尔里希先生也过去看，再后来我听到命名日在劝兔毛手袋别站在桌上发表总统就任演讲。
Foundation Staff Member I: They even roped in Mr. Ulrich. I caught Name Day desperately stopping Medicine Pocket from climbing up on a table to recite a speech.

基金会职员 I： 虽然最后合影时那上头挤满了人。
Foundation Staff Member I: It was good fun. They even snapped a picture of it by the end.

基金会职员 II： 我错过得太多了！不是说路德维希先生很关注职员的心理状态，鼓励他们放松吗？下次活动到底在什么时候——一定还有下次吧?!
Foundation Staff Member II: It's a shame I missed it. I heard Mr. Ludwig values employees' mental health, so at least he'll be hosting more of those parties soon, right? RIGHT?

脚步声与话语声逐渐远去，琴声也随之止息。
The footsteps and voices fade away, and the sound of the violin comes to an end.

星星用好奇的闪烁打量着这片土地。遥远的蓝色星球。京兆分之一的奇迹。
The star looks down on this land with curious twinkles. This distant blue planet. A one-in-ten-quadrillion miracle.

她得到了金色的、珍贵的声音，于是也在这儿留下自己的声音。
She has received golden, precious sounds and now leaves behind a voice of her own.

远旅： *一段轻快的哼唱*
Voyager: *humming*

她学会的第一首歌。
The first song she learned.

为那些在普列谢茨克的日子，为今后的岁月，为她所认识与铭记的。
For the days at Plesetsk. For the days to come. For those she knew and remembers.

为文明的遥远回声。
For the distant echoes of civilization.

远旅： 请……听。
Voyager: Please listen.

在这颗星球上，她目睹了前所未见的景象。
On this planet, she has witnessed sights she never knew existed.

朋友。
Friends

勇敢的访客。
Brave visitors.

四季的更替，海岸线的蜿蜒，温暖或寒冷，和平或纷争。
The changing seasons, winding coastlines, warmth and cold, peace and conflict.

贫穷与富裕，卑劣与高尚。文明的衰落与崛起，雨燕划过天空的轨迹。
Poverty and wealth, cruelty and nobility. The rise and fall of civilizations, the birds slicing through the sky.

在银河系中的一粒微尘之上。
All on a single speck of dust in the Milky Way.

远旅：　多美丽啊……群星。
Voyager:　How beautiful ... the stars are.

看似无用的探索改变了一切。
正如遥远的星星改变了你。
One seemingly useless exploration changes everything.
Just as a star from afar changes you.

1987 宇宙组曲
1987 Cosmic Overture

派对花絮
Party Highlights　小径

派对花絮
Party Highlights

简中
几位好，请问你们哪位才是冷周六小姐？我带来了康斯坦丁女士的问候。我刚才听到你们在用语言交流了，请不要集体扮蛇糊弄我。
……
尊敬的北方哨歌女士，基金会也听闻了理线学在这次航天实验中的突出作用。拨款？不，我来送出的是康斯坦丁女士隆重的慰问，这远胜于任何物质上的支持。这位就是您那位学徒么？这次航天实验的第一大功臣，康斯坦丁女士叮嘱过我要为库珀花环小姐送上最隆重的问候，同时祝她今后在拉普拉斯科算中心的前途光明。
……
您好啊，指针女士，传送软盘真是一项跨世纪的发明，康斯坦丁女士也认为其中具有无与伦比的战略价值。您的几位同僚都埋怨我破坏了派对氛围，希望您不会觉得康斯坦丁女士的问候唠叨。您说我可以站在高处演讲？那我就占用各位五分钟了。
……
救命！谁都好！快把兔毛手袋研究员拉开，我不知道这张桌子是它的领地！它还在咬我！是谁在这时候伴奏?！发发善心吧！帮帮我！
English
Excuse me, ladies and gentlemen. May I ask which one of you is Miss Hissabeth? I bring greetings from Constantine. I heard you speaking just now—please don't all play dumb and pretend to be snakes.

...

Greetings, Miss Windsong. The Foundation has heard about the outstanding role that Ley Line Theory played in this aerospace experiment. Am I here to grant you Funding? No, I'm here to deliver Constantine's formal commendations, which surpass any material support. Is this your

apprentice? The greatest contributor to the success of this space experiment! Constantine specially instructed me to offer Kiperina the highest congratulations, and to wish her a brilliant future at the LSCC.

...

Hello, Ms. Pointer. This teleport disk really is a miraculous once-in-a-century invention. Constantine sees it as having immense strategic value.

Your colleagues are already grumbling that I've ruined the party atmosphere—I hope you won't mind my delivering her greetings. Are you offering me the stage to speak? Then I'll take just five minutes.

...

Help! Anyone! Save me from Medicine Pocket!

I didn't know this table was their turf! They're still biting me! Hey, who's playing music at a time like this?! Somebody, help!

传送术式宣讲会

Teleportation Ritual Seminar 小径

传送术式宣讲会
Teleportation Ritual Seminar

简中
……
相信各位都在各种学术期刊上读到过，传送术式的理论可行范围并非由空间距离上的远近决定。但实际执行时，距离越远，干扰要素就越多。且迄今为止都没有被判明具体因素为何。因此超视距的传送术式一直被认为是天方夜谭。
但这次，藉由在“暴雨”前极端环境下进行的超远距离实验，我们一次性收集了从外太空到地表的大量神秘术能量波动反应记录，并经过反复比对，终于找出了一段能切实吸引传送术式定位锚点的神秘术能量波形，我的组员给了它一个容易引起误会的名字——脉冲星波形。我想这是她表现浪漫的形式。
……
是的，我已经听到台下的几位在说这是纯粹的经验论，没有理论支持，也无法再次验证。确实如此，但事实是这几周内我和我的组员们已经测试了多次，只要在目的地附近人工模拟这种波形，就能在神秘术能量足够的情况下，完成准确率高达 95% 的定位。
……
这就是本次我想说的，相信在遥远的未来，我们能够在完整理论的支持下让传送技术成为凌驾于航天技术之上的新研究领域。而在目所能及的现在，我们已经得到了一个稳定且安全的外卖技术。
English
...

As many of you have read in academic journals, the theoretical feasibility of teleportation incantations is not determined by distance.

However, the farther the distance, the more interference factors there are, and to this day, we still don't know exactly why. Thus, long-distance teleportation has always been considered the realm of pure fantasy.

However, during the extreme conditions just before the "Storm," we gathered a vast amount of arcane energy fluctuation data from outer space to the Earth's surface.

After repeated cross-analysis, we finally discovered a stable arcanum waveform capable of anchoring teleportation incantations. My teammate, she gave it a misleading name—"Pulsar Waveform." I suppose that was her way of being poetic or something.

…

Yes, I hear some of you murmuring that this is purely experimental, lacking theoretical proof and impossible to replicate. That's true. But the fact is, over the past few weeks, we've tested it repeatedly. As long as you simulate this waveform near the destination and there's enough arcane energy, you can achieve teleportation with up to 95% accuracy.

…

That's all I wanted to share today. I believe that one day in the distant future, with a complete theoretical framework, teleportation could become a field that outpaces aerospace itself. But even now, what we've uncovered is a stable, practical technology—perfect for food delivery.